

# Cohort C

# Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Transportation, Distribution, Warehousing and Procurement, CERT

## Reflection and Mission

### PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

#### Narrative:

No changes to previous APR recommendations.

This is the program's first APR. This program started in 2019. As a result, there are no recommendations, actions needed, and no implications or challenges at this point. Learning outcomes were started in 2016 and 2015 for the courses that were offered at that time. It appears that at the time learning outcomes were not assessed for the classes. There was an exit assessment used at the time to assess learning outcomes. There is very little to no data from the exit exam that was used at the time to assess students. The course numbers were changed in 2019 as the logistics technical certificate was started. Learning outcomes were officially assigned to classes in 2020. An academic audit was completed in 2018 prior to the change in LO and course numbers.

#### Evidence:

- LGM & SCM\_Academic Audit\_Self Study\_021218
- VSCC Logistics Academic Auditor Report 2018

### Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### Narrative:

There are no changes or updates to the mission statement.

The Logistics Management Technical Certificate is still in its infant stage. Program was started in 2019 and is designed to prepare students for the growing need for logistic expertise. Additionally, the program allows certificate credits to be applied toward AAS in Business Administration, and Logistics and Supply Chain Management Concentration. There are no plans to change the curriculum and program offerings. Oct 2022 there were proposed changes to the Logistics certificate name.

#### Mission Statement

"This technical certificate program offers the opportunity for formal study in the growing field of Logistics, Transportation and Distribution Center/Warehouse Management, Sourcing &

Procurement, and Supply Chain Management. Study in the program is designed to provide career growth. Students completing the Certificate Program may apply the coursework toward the Associate of Applied Science, General Business Administration Option, and Logistics and Supply Chain Management Concentration. "

**Evidence:**

- Logistics and Supply Chain Management Technical Certificate 10-27-22
- TBR Side by Side Comparison

**Alignment to Institution Mission**

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

**Narrative:**

The program mission statement is still in line with the college mission statement.

The program helps to answer the communities growing need for workers with a logistics background. Answering the need for workers in logistics builds on our community partnerships and provides labor resources for local and national economy. Our students graduate understanding the role of logistics in a global society.

Industry experts and local companies are concerned that the labor market lack trained and experienced working in logistics to support growing supply chain management concerns. The concern is that there is a lack of understanding for warehouse, distribution, transportation and supply chain. The courses offer students an indebt understanding of all aspect of logistics. Real world case studies in all classes give students the opportunity to analyze and discuss the problems. Students can address these issues by applying learned content and personal experience to resolving supply chain issues.

## **Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment**

### **Curriculum Map**

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

**Narrative:**

Case studies are still being used to assess program learning outcomes in each course as a part of the certificate.

PLO 1 and 2 are assessed in LOGI 1010 using a case study. A rubric is used to assess students' ability to demonstrate understanding of Content, writing mechanics (organization, spelling, grammar), use of references, citations, and sources. Score range from 3.5 to 5 on each section of the rubric.

PLO 3 is assessed in LOGI 1030 using a case study.

A rubric is used to assess students' ability to demonstrate understanding of Content, writing mechanics (organization, spelling, grammar), use of references, citations, and sources. Score range from 3.5 to 5 on each section of the rubric.

PLO 4 is assessed in LOGI 2040 using a case study.

A rubric is used to assess students' ability to demonstrate understanding of Content, writing mechanics (organization, spelling, grammar), use of references, citations, and sources. Score range from 3.5 to 5 on each section of the rubric.

All courses are not offered each semester since 2019. Therefore all PLO have not been assessed due to course offerings .

**Evidence:**

- LOGI TC Curriculum Map 2022
- Optional Action Plan Matrix[1]

**EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING**

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

**Narrative:**

Data still being collected for the Technical Certificate

1. Summary of most recent assessment results

Key assessment courses for the Logistics Certification are:

- LOGI1000 Supply Chain Management with learning outcomes.
- LOGI1010 Transportation
- LOGI1030 Distribution and Warehouse Management
- LOGI2040 Sourcing and Procurement

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

1. There is very little to no data or past review of institutional effectiveness for the Logistics Certification. Assessments and learning outcomes for the courses were finalized Spring of 2021. Assessments and learning outcomes were not officially applied to courses until 2022. Therefore, all learning outcomes have not been assessed. Additionally, the lack of data has been impacted by the course offering schedule as well as the application of the learning outcomes.
2. Analysis of trends are also affected by the lack of data and the infancy of the program. Assessments and learning outcomes were not officially applied to courses until 2022. Therefore, all learning outcomes have not been assessed. Additionally, the lack of data has been impacted by the course offering schedule as well as the application of the learning outcomes.
3. In the future as more assessments are applied to the logistics courses, the results should be used to tailor course models and make corrections to courses based on data from the assessments and learning outcomes.

**Evidence:**

- AY2021-2022 LOGI TC Assessment Results

## Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information

### STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

#### Narrative:

2021 Surveys LOGI 1000, 1010

Student surveys were completed by 57 to 74% of the students with an overall average that met VSCC and division survey averages.

Fall 2021 64% of students completed surveys with an average rating at or above VSCC and division.

Spring 2021 70% of students completed surveys with an average at or above VSCC and division

Spring 2022 50% of students completed surveys with an average at or above VSCC and Division average.

summer 2020 50% of students complete surveys with an average at or above the VSCC and division average.

I had out administrative associate pull Logistics TC graduates and enrollment on Nov 14 after I submitted the report for peer review. Here are numbers.

| Semester | Logistics TC # graduates | Logistics TC # enrolled |
|----------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
| 201880   | 4                        | 3                       |
| 201910   | 2                        | 4                       |
| 201950   | 5                        | 1                       |
| 201980   | 6                        | 9                       |
| 202010   | 8                        | 5                       |
| 202050   | 2                        | 1                       |
| 202080   | 4                        | 8                       |
| 202110   | 5                        | 5                       |
| 202150   | 2                        | 1                       |
| 202180   | 12                       | 1                       |
| 202210   | 5                        | 2                       |
| 202250   | 1                        | 1                       |
| 202280   | 3*                       | 7                       |
|          |                          |                         |

#### Evidence:

- 18145.202210LOGI-1000-C01-IntrotoLogisticsManagementBinghamTyrone\_TyroneBingham
- 18148.202210LOGI-1010-C01-TransportationBinghamTyrone\_TyroneBingham
- 87769.202180LOGI-1000-C01-IntrotoLogisticsManagementBinghamTyrone\_TyroneBingham
- 88441.202180LOGI-1000-H01-IntrotoLogisticsManagementBinghamTyrone\_TyroneBingham
- 88442.202180LOGI-1010-C01-TransportationBinghamTyrone\_TyroneBingham
- Fall\_2017
- Fall\_21
- MergedReport
- MergedReport (1)
- MergedReport (2)
- MergedReport (3)
- Spring\_22
- Summer 21
- Summer 22

## RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

### Narrative:

**3.5** The Logistics Technical Certificate continues to have steady enrollment with a very good graduation rate [\[DE1\]](#) [DE1].

|                 | 2013 | 2014 | 2015 | 2016 | 2017 | 2018 |
|-----------------|------|------|------|------|------|------|
| Fall Enrollment | 15   | 14   | 34   | 22   | 8    | 1    |
| Graduates       | 15   | 17   | 28   | 18   | 32   | 33   |

Here is the data for Fall 2017 & Spring 2018 graduation.

Fall 2017 graduates; 2- AAS degrees; 3 certificates

|           |         |          |                                |      |        |
|-----------|---------|----------|--------------------------------|------|--------|
| V00640761 | Jill    | Curtis   | B & T Logistics Mgt C1         | CRT1 | 201750 |
| V00587056 | Dianna  | Harrison | B & T Logistics Mgt C1         | CRT1 | 201750 |
| V00224084 | Phillip | Stafford | B & T Logistics Mgt C1         | CRT1 | 201780 |
| V00640032 | Angel   | Figuroa  | B & T Logistics Management AAS | AAS  | 201750 |

|           |        |        |       |                          |     |        |
|-----------|--------|--------|-------|--------------------------|-----|--------|
| V00218306 | Teresa | Rumble | B & T | Logistics Management AAS | AAS | 201750 |
|-----------|--------|--------|-------|--------------------------|-----|--------|

Spring 2018 graduates; 4- AAS degrees; 1 certificate

|           |        |          |     |                                |      |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----|--------------------------------|------|
| V00646059 | Adam   | Mamula   | B&T | Logistics Management AAS       | AAS  |
| V00613434 | Kelly  | Dean     | B&T | Logistics Management AAS       | AAS  |
| V00649526 | Joshua | Green    | B&T | Logistics Management AAS       | AAS  |
| V00198918 | Rhonda | Mitchell | B&T | Logistics Management AAS       | AAS  |
| V00219949 | Marcus | Townsend | B&T | Logistics Mgt C1 (certificate) | CRT1 |

In 2022 new brochures were completed. A grant was received to complete student, faculty, and classroom commercials. Commercials were completed Fall of 2022 in conjunction with public affairs. Placement % has decreased since 2019 from 57% to 33% this was at the heart of the pandemic and in the coming years placement numbers should increase. Graduate numbers have increased since 2019. Retention rate for 2019 was 33%, and there is no data for any other years.

#### **Evidence:**

- 2022 Logistics Fact Sheet
- Number of LGM grads Fall17 and Sprg18

## **Supporting Program Information**

### **FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)**

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

#### **Narrative:**

There is nothing to provide on faculty usage and development as this section is optional.

### **CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)**

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

#### **Narrative:**

This section is optional and there is no evidence to report for class and course offerings.

### **CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

#### **Narrative:**

Guest speakers provide real-world logistics knowledge and challenges for the LOGI 1000 in-person classes. Don Ellis has been the logistics community resource for guest speakers used for the on ground LOGI 1000 class starting Fall 2022. Chariot Logistics visited the LOGI 1000 course Fall of 2022. Joe Delio is the president and graduate of UT Knoxville with a degree in Logistics. Joe runs a Million Dollar company in the Nashville and provided lots of insight for students taking the class and those working on the certification. The goal is to offer students in the in person classes an opportunity to take field trips to the near by Gap distribution center to talk with those currently working in warehousing, distribution, and transportation.

## **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from creditable industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

### **Narrative:**

There is no industry data and information to provide for this APR. This section of the APR is optional.

## **EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

### **Narrative:**

There is no data available from the start of the program addressing employment and transfer forecast. This section is optional.

## **Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback**

### **SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS**

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

### **Narrative:**

Progress has been made on the 2022 plans. Faculty advisors are assigned to help streamline the advising process and decrease response time. Faculty advisors are no longer forced to advise students. This maintains faculty advisors in the advising role that want to advise students. Faculty advisors are better trained at advising which improves the experience for students. Training sessions are held multiple times each semester for faculty advisors. The advising send emails to students throughout the semester as a way to maintain a connection between faculty advisors and students.

Plans for improvement 2022

Improve teamwork and process discipline between Completion Advisers and Business Department faculty members. Improve the frequency and substance of communication between advisers and



students by providing faculty members with additional training and through regular review and attention from the director, chair and dean. Improve response times and the quality of support and follow up provided by faculty advisers when the alert system notifies them of student performance issues. Improve student enthusiasm for the field by increasing significantly the number and quality of work-based learning experiences in every CIT class and creating assignments and other learning experiences to enhance student understanding of the career and income opportunities provided by their course of study. Restructure degree requirements and suggested course sequencing to encourage students to earn a certificate enroute to their degrees, establishing stackable credentials to reward progress and encourage retention and completion. Systematically review the syllabus for each course to add assignments and instruction that increases student awareness of college resources available for their support and to increase student engagement with one another and with division and campus personnel. The director, chair and dean will work with IERPA to review student success trends in Logistics and Supply Chain courses. They will identify any bottlenecks and barriers and develop and lead any response plans that may be needed.

To inspire student performance, faculty members will revise their courses to increase work-based learning in all LOG courses and to increase student understanding of career and income opportunities associated with CIT credentials and the importance of pursuing career-relevant work opportunities and internships while in college. Faculty members will review the syllabus of their programs to develop assignments and learning experiences that teach and strengthen student skills in the eight NACE competencies.

Continue to advocate and push for the requirement for more Full-Time faculty members to teach in person Logistics and Supply Chain courses and manage the Logistics and Supply Chain programs. Successfully execute initiatives to increase the number of business students earning the Logistics certificate to demonstrate the focus and productivity of the department. Build and leverage strong partnerships with supported employers. Systematically expand work-based learning experiences in logistics. In 2022 work was completed via a grant to Publicize logistics opportunities. Work was done in 2022 to work with the VSCC Office of Public Relations to improve and expand marketing and promotion of logistics programs. Include content promoting partnerships with career and technical education (CTE) programs of area school systems. Team with colleagues to develop a multi-year plan for strategic engagement and partnerships with school districts and employers across the service area. Students and faculty were involved in a campaign and commercial for the department and the logistics TC. Commercials included interviews with students and faculty. Students were highlighted in the classroom environment showcasing student and faculty engagement.

## **TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN**

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

### **Narrative:**

No changes to program recommendations.

### Recommendation based on student learning

1. LOGI 1000 is the only course that has been offered in person all other courses in the program are only offered online. I recommend advocating for more classes within the certificate be offered in-person. More faculty will be needed in order to offer other logistics courses in person. It is recommended that more in person logistics classes are offered in the next two years based on the ability to hire new faculty.

2. Review all current textbooks within the logistics program and update materials as necessary to stay in line with industry changes over the last five years. Courses should be reviewed in the next year with time to work with publishers to implement new course materials.

#### Student success recommendation

1. Incorporate more guest speakers from the industry to offer insight on the career field for in person courses. Local field trips and tours of companies to expose students to warehousing, distribution, and transportation.

#### **Evidence:**

- Optional Action Plan Matrix[1]

#### **DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.**

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

#### **Narrative:**

I have analyzed the program review and agree with the evidence provided and am supportive of the action plan moving forward.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the lead faculty member as well as the rest of the department in completing this review and designing thoughtful initiatives for continuous improvement. The action plan is appropriate and will help improve student learning as well having the potential to increase retention and job placement. In addition to these actions, I encourage the department to think more about how recruitment efforts could be expanded, particularly through the use of dual enrollment pathways and other partnerships. Many of the students who receive the certificate are enrolled in the AAS program, and providing this certificate as a stackable credential is a great feature of the program. At the same time, there may be opportunity to recruit potential students to the certificate program specifically - either students who do not plan to pursue a degree at this time or students who already have a degree but are looking to increase their skills in this specific area.

#### **AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback**

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

#### **Narrative:**

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

#### **PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

**Narrative:**

APR Cohort C conducted a Peer Review rather than a presentation.

The Logistic APR was reviewed by an Assessment Fellow.

## **Action Plan Status Reports**

### **YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

**Narrative:**

## **TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN**

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

**Narrative:**

Recommendation based on student learning

1. LOGI 1000 is the only course that has been offered in person all other courses in the program are only offered online. I recommend advocating for more classes within the certificate be offered in-person. More faculty will be needed in order to offer other logistics courses in person. It is recommended that more in person logistics classes are offered in the next two years based on the ability to hire new faculty.
2. Review all current textbooks within the logistics program and update materials as necessary to stay in line with industry changes over the last five years. Courses should be reviewed in the next year with time to work with publishers to implement new course materials.

Student success recommendation

1. Incorporate more guest speakers from the industry to offer insight on the career field for in person courses. Local field trips and tours of companies to expose students to warehousing, distribution, and transportation.

## YEAR 2

|     | Initiative                                                                                                                                          | Achieved Milestones                                                                                                             | Challenges                                                                                                   | Changes if applicable       | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)                                                            |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EX. | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections. | Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. | No changes to the timeline. | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83% |
| 1   |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                              |                             |                                                                                                     |
| 2   |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                              |                             |                                                                                                     |
| 3   |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                              |                             |                                                                                                     |
| 4   |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                              |                             |                                                                                                     |

1. Additional Business full-time faculty have been added to the staff that can instruct more in-person logistics courses. There are now two full-time and two part-time faculty teaching logistics courses. The logistics certificate name change was approved by TBR and is now "Supply Chain Management" this is more in line with local and national industry standards. Logistics courses and textbooks are continuously being updated each year. The most recent update was for the LOGI 2030 and 1000 courses update Fall of 2023.

2. Industry guest speakers have been incorporated into the Curriculum. Part-time faculty are able to serve as industry speakers as well as instructors for the logistics program. Chariot Logistics from Gallatin are used as a guest speaker to offer industry insight and logistics challenges.

### Evidence:

- Action Plan Matrix[1]

## YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

### Narrative:

## TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on

student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

## Narrative:

### Recommendation based on student learning

1. LOGI 1000 is the only course that has been offered in person all other courses in the program are only offered online. I recommend advocating for more classes within the certificate be offered in-person. More faculty will be needed in order to offer other logistics courses in person. It is recommended that more in person logistics classes are offered in the next two years based on the ability to hire new faculty.

2. Review all current textbooks within the logistics program and update materials as necessary to stay in line with industry changes over the last five years. Courses should be reviewed in the next year with time to work with publishers to implement new course materials.

### Student success recommendation

1. Incorporate more guest speakers from the industry to offer insight on the career field for in person courses. Local field trips and tours of companies to expose students to warehousing, distribution, and transportation.

| YEAR 3 Progress |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                |            |                                                                                                        |                             |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                 | Initiative                                                                                                                                          | Achieved Milestones                                                                                                                                                            | Challenges | Performance Indicator Result                                                                           | Initiative Achieved? Yes/No |
| EX.             | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | The tutorial video was launched in the model shell.<br>Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool<br>The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections | None       | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86% | YES                         |
| 1               |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                |            |                                                                                                        |                             |
| 2               |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                |            |                                                                                                        |                             |
| 3               |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                |            |                                                                                                        |                             |
| 4               |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                |            |                                                                                                        |                             |

| YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                        |                                                                             |                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | Initiative                                                                                                                                          | How has this initiative supported student learning or student success? | Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain. | How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?                                       |
| EX.                        | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 |                                                                        | None                                                                        | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86% |
| 1                          |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                        |                                                                             |                                                                                                        |
| 2                          |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                        |                                                                             |                                                                                                        |
| 3                          |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                        |                                                                             |                                                                                                        |
| 4                          |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                        |                                                                             |                                                                                                        |

# **Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1**

Health Information Management AAS

## **Reflection and Mission**

### **PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW**

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

#### **Narrative:**

This is the first cycle of the APR. Previous program reviews were executed by IE report.

### **Program Mission Statement**

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### **Narrative:**

The Applied Science degree in Health Information Management prepares competent entry-level health information management technicians with the knowledge, technical skills and professional attributes to enter the workforce with nationally recognized credentials that would afford our graduates an opportunity in any healthcare setting nationwide.

No changes have been made to the VSCC HIM Program mission statement, and no revisions are planned.

Revisions may be made once the CAHIIM HIM 2026 Standards, Competence Assessment Statements, and Performance Indicators (PIs) have been fully implemented.

### **Alignment to Institution Mission**

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

#### **Narrative:**

The Health Information Management Program is highly central to the VSCC mission, vision, and core values. The Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management prepares competent entry-level health information technicians with the knowledge, technical skills, and professional attributes to enter the workforce with nationally recognized credentials that afford graduates an opportunity in any healthcare setting nationwide.

## **Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment**

### **Curriculum Map**

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

**Narrative:**

**HIM, A.A.S. Program Learning Outcomes**

1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance.
2. Apply privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security.
3. Manage standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use.
4. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management.
5. Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance.
6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership.
7. Apply knowledge of pathophysiology, pharmacology, anatomy and physiology, medical terminology, computer concepts and computer applications as they relate to health information management.

**Assessment Method and Target Level of Outcome**

PLO #1 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, is assessed utilizing Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping.

In this assignment, students create a table to map the data element “patient race” to Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7 data requirements. Students must use the appropriate date definitions for each organization to create the table data requirements.

No achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #2 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #2. Identify and apply privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security, is assessed utilizing EHR Go ROI and Accounting of Disclosure.

This assignment provides an introduction to the issues surrounding the release of information (ROI) and a patient's right to an accounting of disclosures of their protected health information (PHI). Students must apply privacy and security strategies to health information, identify compliance requirements, manage data within a database system, apply legal processes impacting health information, and demonstrate compliance with external forces by answering questions regarding the ROI scenario given and the items on file in the EHR.

No achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #3. Manage standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use, is assessed utilizing EHR Go



Query Basic Orientation.

In this assignment, students create and run queries to gather needed data, apply health informatics concepts to the management of health information, utilize technologies for health information management, and manage data within a database system.

No achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #4. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.

In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient's hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #5 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #5 Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.

In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine the present on admission (POA) status indicator for each.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #6 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.

In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and, if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA's Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

### **Additional Information**

The HIM PLOs were assessed during the spring 2022 semester however, as noted above, no achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24. The best history we currently have is the results of the Registered Health Information Management (RHIT) certification exam. The Registered Health Information Technology (RHIT) certification exam also assesses the PLOs which are based on the required 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies. On our Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) to our accrediting body, the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM), our Student and Graduate goal is:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies.

One of the measured target outcomes for meeting this goal is:

The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students who test early and graduate will have an RHIT first-time exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.

Results of the RHIT School Score Report for the academic years from August 1<sup>st</sup>, 2020, to July 31<sup>st</sup>, 2021 were reviewed and students who tested early and graduated had an RHIT first-time exam pass rate of 76.92% which exceeds our measured target outcome.

**Evidence:**

- APAR with Results 8.1.2020 to 7.31.2021
- HIMT AAS Curriculum Map 2022
- HIMT, AAS Assessment Tool

**EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING**

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

**Narrative:**

The VSCC Associate of Applied Science in Health Information Management program is designed to teach students the 38 entry-level 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies, including the Data Management (DM) and Revenue Management (RM) specialty tracks, developed by the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) and the Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) and approved by the Commission on Accreditation of Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). These 38 competencies can be aggregated into the broad HIM PLOs assessed in Via.

The HIM PLOs listed below were assessed during the spring 2022 semester using Via however, no achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24. An analysis of the spring 2022 results was conducted.

**Notations and summary of most recent assessments, AY21-22 Assessment Results:**

HIM Program Students and MCTC Students are assessed in the HIMT 2305 and HIMT 2303 classes. In AY21-22 we also had students from the MPM major in the HIMT 2305 class, in spring 2022. The MPM major is no longer offered at VSCC so in the future, we will not have MPM students in this class. MCTC students will continue to be in both classes. Assessing the data based on the students' majors will be necessary for analyzing accurate statistical data in the HIM APR and the MCTC APR. The attached AY21-22 Assessment Results only include assessments of HIM students.

**Analysis of trends for HIM PLOs assessed:**

- PLO #1 HIM Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping 86% met; 14% not met
- \*PLO #2 EHR Go ROI and Accounting of Disclosure 91% met; 9% not met
- PLO #3 EHR Go Query Basic Orientation 85% met; 15% not met
- PLO #4 HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission 100% met; 0% not met

- PLO #5 HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis 98% met; 2% not met
- PLO #6 HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making 80% met; 20% not met

#### **Ideas to improve student learning:**

- To increase the HIM student learning and scores we believe two of the assignments should be moved to courses that better align with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competencies associated with these PLOs. We will move the following PLOs for AY23-24:

1. Move PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, from HIMT 2305 to HIMT 1305 Computer Applications in HI, and ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing this assignment.
2. Move PLO #3. Manage standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use from HIMT 2303 to HIMT 2309 Data Analysis and Statistics, and ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing this assignment.
3. Provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for PLO #6 Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership.

\*We will also move PLO #2. Apply privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security from HIMT 2305 to HIMT 1202 HIM Legal Aspects better align with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competencies associated with this PLO. This PLO was 91% met, 9% not met.

#### **HIM PLOs:**

- PLO #1 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping. In this assignment, students create a table to map the data element “patient race” to Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7 data requirements.

Students must use the appropriate date definitions for each organization to create the table data requirements.

- PLO #2 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #2. Identify and apply privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security, is assessed utilizing EHR Go ROI and Accounting of Disclosure.

This assignment provides an introduction to the issues surrounding the release of information (ROI) and a patient's right to an accounting of disclosures of their protected health information (PHI). Students must apply privacy and security strategies to health information, identify compliance requirements, manage data within a database system, apply legal processes impacting health information, and demonstrate compliance with external forces by answering questions regarding the ROI scenario given and the items on file in the EHR.

- PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #3. Manage standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use, is assessed utilizing EHR Go Query Basic Orientation.

In this assignment, students create and run queries to gather needed data, apply health informatics concepts to the management of health information, utilize technologies for health information management, and manage data within a database system.

- PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #4. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.

In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient's hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.

- PLO #5 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #5 Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.

In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine what the Present on Admission (POA) status is for each scenario.

- PLO #6 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.

In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and, if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA's Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.

### **Historical Assessments, Analysis, Summary of Results, and Trends**

Historically we can look at the Annual Program Assessment Reports (APAR) to our accrediting body, the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) as evidence of student learning and the HIM Program's effectiveness in reaching both PLOs and the learning outcomes/curriculum competencies in the HIM courses.

#### **8/1/2020 - 7/31/2021 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR)**

Our Student and Graduate goal on the 8/1/2020 - 7/31/2021 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) was:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies.

The measured target outcomes for meeting this goal were:

1. The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students who test early and graduate will have an RHIT first-time exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.
2. 100 percent of students will receive "Satisfactory" or above ratings in all areas from their Professional Practice Manager/Supervisor on their Professional Practice Experience (clinical) Student Performance Evaluation.

The steps to achieve this goal were:

1. Using results of the RHIT School Score Report, students who test early and graduates will have an RHIT first-time exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%
2. Using results of the PPE Student Performance Evaluation, 100% of students will receive "Satisfactory" or above ratings in all areas from their Professional Practice Site Manager/Supervisor.

Results/Analysis/Trends/Actions:

1. Results of the RHIT School Score Report for the academic year from August 1st, 2020, to July 31st, 2021 were reviewed and students who tested early and graduates had an RHIT first-time exam pass rate of 76.92%
2. Results of the PPE Student Performance Evaluations were reviewed and 100% of students received above Satisfactory ratings in all areas from their Professional Practice Site Manager.

**8/1/2019 - 7/31/2020 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR)**

Our Student and Graduate goal on the 8/1/2019 - 7/31/2020 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) was:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies

The measured target outcomes for meeting this goal were:

1. Students will recognize basic Health Information concepts and practices. Using results from the RHIT National Exam, graduates will meet or exceed the national average score for Domains 1-6 on the first attempt.
2. Graduates will demonstrate entry-level competency in the skill required in the position- students will apply and demonstrate critical, problem-solving, and decision-making skills within the parameters of Health Information Management Technology.
3. Students will apply and demonstrate knowledge of health record principles, management principles, classification systems, design principles, and legal and statistical information as acquired over the course of the Health Information Management Technology program as a whole.

The steps to achieve this goal were:

1. Due to the changes in the RHIT School Score Reports provided by AHIMA we were not able to assess this target outcome from August 1st, 2019, to July 31st, 2020. The national average score for Domains 1-6 was no longer provided in the RHIT School Score Reports. We developed a new target outcome for our action plan: The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students will have an RHIT exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.
2. Using returned Employer Satisfaction Surveys, 75% or more of employers will answer "yes" that the VSCC HIM graduates they hired had the HIM skills and knowledge they expected.
3. 80% of the HIM students will pass the mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM.

Results/Analysis/Trends/Actions:

1. There were no results for this time period due to the changes in the RHIT School Score Reports that no longer provided the national average score for Domains 1-6. Due to this change in the reports, we developed a new target outcome for our action plan:
  1. The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students will have an RHIT exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.
2. Results of the PPE Student Performance Evaluations were reviewed for the academic year August 1st, 2019, to July 31st, 2020, and 100% of students received above Satisfactory ratings in all areas from their Professional Practice Site Manager.

3. 100% of employees rated the VSCC HIM graduates they hired as having the skills and knowledge they expected.
4. 100% of the HIM students passed the mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM.

### **8/1/2018 - 7/31/2019 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR)**

Our Student and Graduate goal on the 8/1/2018 - 7/31/2019 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) was:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies

The measured target outcomes for meeting this goal were:

1. Students will recognize basic Health Information concepts and practices. Using results from the RHIT National Exam, graduates will meet or exceed the national average score for Domains 1-6 on the first attempt.
2. Graduates will demonstrate entry-level competency in the skill required in the position – students will apply and demonstrate critical, problem-solving, and decision-making skills within the parameters of Health Information Management Technology.
3. Students will apply and demonstrate knowledge of health record principles, management principles, classification systems, design principles, and legal and statistical information as acquired over the course of the Health Information Management Technology program as a whole.

The steps to achieve this goal were:

1. Using results of the RHIT National Exam, graduates will meet or exceed the national average score for Domains 1- 6 on the first attempt. Domains 1-6:
  1. Data, Content, Structure, and Information Governance
  2. Access, Disclosure, Privacy, and Security
  3. Data Analytics and Use
  4. Revenue Cycle Management
  5. Compliance
  6. Leadership
2. Using returned Employer Satisfaction Surveys, 75% or more of employers will answer "yes" that the VSCC HIM graduates they hired had the HIM skills and knowledge they expected.
3. 80% of the HIM students will pass the mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM

Results/Analysis/Trends/Actions:

1. Scores from August 1, 2018, through July 31, 2019, Domains 1- 6 for the first attempt:
  - Domain 1 – 18.30 below Nat'l score of 19.47
  - Domain 2 – 11.60 below Nat'l score of 11.74
  - Domain 3 – 12.80 below Nat'l score of 12.89
  - Domain 4 – 11.80 below Nat'l score of 13.36
  - Domain 5 – 9.80 below Nat'l score of 10.47
  - Domain 6 – 10.20 below Nat'l score of 11.15

The results were reviewed and the scores that fell below the national average were not considered significant. We continued to monitor, and we did the following for improvements:

- Provided students with the following detailed information on basic Health Information concepts and practices/ Domains 1-6:
  - PowerPoint presentations
  - Lecture notes
  - Terms to know and understand

- Information from the Annual THIMA meeting and we encouraged student attendance at the Annual THIMA meeting
  - Used Discussion boards
- We also did the following:
  - Added exams for each domain in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM.
  - Provided students with a fundamental and comprehensive review of program content.
  - Provided students with materials for further study.
  - Students were required to register and sit for the RHIT Exam during their last semester, prior to graduation.
  - Added additional assignments and discussion boards from the AHIMA Case Studies in HIM textbook to the Seminar in HIM, Introduction to HIM, and Revenue Cycle Management courses; added additional assignments to meet AHIMA Curriculum Competencies for Data Analysis & Statistics, Quality Improvement, and HIM Management Principles courses.

2. 100% of employees rated the VSCC HIM graduates they hired as having the skills and knowledge they expected.

3. 100% of the HIM students passed the mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212

### **Ideas to improve student success:**

Our Student and Graduate goal on the 8/1/2020 - 7/31/2021 Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR) was:

The program will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies.

One of the measured target outcomes for meeting this goal was:

The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the RHIT School Score Report, students who test early and graduate will have an RHIT first-time exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%

To improve student success we will increase the RHIT first-time exam pass rate from 72% to 75%. The following steps will be initiated to improve the RHIT first-time exam pass rates:

- Extend the study time by 1 week by allowing students to sit for the RHIT exam 1 week after graduation instead of sitting for the RHIT exam 2 weeks before graduation.
- Allow students to take the Mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM as many times as they need to make a 75%.

### **Evidence of Student Learning:**

Based on the assessment results in Via and the Annual Program Assessment results the HIM Program is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results however, to increase the HIM student learning and scores we believe two of the assignments should be moved to courses that better align with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competencies associated with these PLOs; we will also ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing these two assignments. We will also provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for another assignment. To improve student success we will increase the RHIT first-time exam pass rate from 72% to 75%.

**Evidence:**

- AY21-22 HIM, AAS Assessment Results 11.8.22
- HIMT Scores 18-19
- HIMT Scores 19-20
- HIMT Scores 19-20 Amended received 2022
- HIMT Scores 20-21

## **Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information**

### **STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION**

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

**Narrative:**

#### **Advisory Board and Alumni**

52% of the VSCC HIM Advisory Board are VSCC Alumni. The VSCC HIM Advisory Board provides feedback each year in the following areas:

- HIM curriculum
- Graduate placement data
- Employer satisfaction survey results
- Graduate licensure/certification results
- Student PPE (clinical) results

The HIM Advisory Board also shares any new opportunities in HIM and ways we could better train our students so they are prepared to take advantage of any new opportunities.

Perceptions of the HIM Program, students, and graduates are positive.

#### **HIM Employer Surveys**

100% of Employer Surveys rate the overall quality of graduates they have hired from the VSCC HIM Program as excellent or good.

#### **HIM Graduate Surveys**

99% of the HIM Graduates agreed that the VSCC HIM Program helped them acquire the knowledge necessary for a job in the Health Information Management field, and trained them to use sound judgment in the Health Information Management work setting. 1% of the Graduates were neutral on these survey questions.



**Summary/Trends/Identified Strengths**

To increase the number of Employer Surveys and Graduate Surveys received, CAHIIM suggested the following ideas regarding surveys in their review of the 08/01/2018 - 07/31/2019 APAR:

- As an option to graduate surveys and employer surveys, some programs have graduating students fill out a survey in class near the end of their last term, with the protocol that results will not be given to HIM faculty until after the term ends.
- Also, some programs send employer surveys to all of the PPE supervisors while the students are still engaged in PPE, and use these responses to assess the student's performance levels as potential employees.

We inquired about the possibility of implementing both of these and were told by IERPA we could not implement these to use as survey results.

The perception of the VSCC HIM Program is favorable as noted by the Advisory Board Members, Alumni, Graduates, and Employers. We will continue to monitor the results.

**Evidence:**

- 2019 HIM Employer Survey
- 2019 HIM Graduate Survey
- 2020 HIM Employer Survey
- 2020 HIM Graduate Survey
- 2021 HIM Employer Survey
- 2021 HIM Graduate Survey
- APAR with Results 8.1.2018 to 7.31.2019

**RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA**

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

**Narrative:****Recruitment/Enrollment**

The attached VSCC HIM Program Annual Program Assessment Reports (APAR) submitted to the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) show the HIM Program enrollment, retention, and graduation results for the last three years. There was an increase in enrollment for AY20-21 with fifteen full-time students and seven part-time students. We would like to see an increase in enrollment to full capacity, 25 students. We are listed as a CAHIIM accredited Associate Level HIM Program on the CAHIIM website as well as the Tennessee Health Information Management Association website, allowing our program to be recognized nationally, and on a state level. We will continue to participate in the Health Science Discovery Days, and host area high school students to share information about the HIM Program and professional field. We are also working with an Entertainment Media Production student to create a promotional video of the HIM Program for use on our VSCC webpage and possibly on social media platforms to increase awareness of the HIM Program and field.

**Evidence:**

- 2022 HIM Fact Sheet
- APAR with Results 8.1.2018 to 7.31.2019
- APAR with Results 8.1.2019 to 7.31.2020
- APAR with Results 8.1.2020 to 7.31.2021

## **Supporting Program Information**

### **FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)**

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

**Narrative:**

CAHIIM requires the following faculty development goal which is assessed annually on the Annual Program Assessment Report (APAR):

**Faculty Development Goal:** The program will provide a plan for faculty that establishes or assesses the knowledge, skills, qualifications, and experience pertinent to the professional curriculum content that they are assigned to teach.

This includes efforts to keep current in health information management and/or other relevant professional content and practice, as well as other components of advanced formal education.

**Measured target outcome:** All HIM faculty will obtain CEUs annually to improve faculty knowledge and expertise, and keep current in the health information management areas in which they teach. All HIM faculty will turn in proof of their AHIMA membership and continued certification annually

**Steps to achieve:** Faculty will attend CAHIIM Townhall Meetings, THIMA Annual Meeting, pertinent webinars, local MTHIMA meetings, and professional development meetings to stay current in the topics they teach. One faculty member will attend AOE.

**Results/Analysis/Actions:** 100% of the HIM faculty are in compliance. Both faculty members attended the CAHIIM Townhall Meetings, the THIMA Annual Meeting, pertinent webinars, local MTHIMA meetings, professional development meetings, and AOE for AY20-21. We will continue to monitor.

## **CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)**

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

### **Narrative:**

The VSCC HIM Program is accredited by the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). We underwent a comprehensive review including a self-study and site visit 2017- 2018 and received continuing accreditation from the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) on February 27, 2019.

The HIM courses at VSCC were recently updated to be in compliance with the AHIMA 2018 Curriculum Competencies. These include the Data Management and Revenue Management Specialty Tracks. The American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA), our professional organization, guides the health information profession with academic curricula that outline key domain areas for mastery. The AHIMA Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) establishes curricula for HIM programs at the associate, baccalaureate, and graduate levels. The CEE approved the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies for implementation in the CAHIIM accreditation process. Accredited programs had to have the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies implemented in all courses by September 1, 2021 All programs were notified in 2020. We submitted our Self-Assessment documentation to CAHIIM in 2021 to show we were in compliance with these competencies.

## **CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

### **Narrative:**

The HIM Students are Student AHIMA Members, <https://www.ahima.org/ahima-membership/membership-types-and-benefits/>

Professional Practicum Experience (PPE) is an essential part of the HIM curriculum. According to the Commission on the Accreditation of Health Informatics and Information Management (CAHIIM), the professional practice experiences must be designed and supervised to reinforce didactic instruction and must include program-coordinated experience at professional practice sites. The VSCC HIM Program students complete 45 hours of PPE during their fall semester.

We encourage the HIM students to attend the Annual THIMA Meeting and local Middle Tennessee Health Information Management Association (MTHIMA) Meetings.

The HIM students are encouraged to sign up for the THIMA Mentor Program, <https://www.thima.org/members/mentor-program/>

The HIM Students attend the AHIMA Student Open House during the fall semester. This complimentary virtual event offers the following:

- AHIMA Foundation scholarship opportunities
- How to transition from health information student to health information professional
- The top five emerging issues impacting health information management
- Building their personal brand on LinkedIn
- AHIMA credentials— options and where to get started
- Optimizing AHIMA student membership

Students also get a virtual tour of the new AHIMA Student Resources portal, with content and tools to help navigate their professional journey.

## **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

### **Narrative:**

The VSCC HIM Program is accredited by the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). We underwent a comprehensive review including a self-study and site visit 2017- 2018 and received continuing accreditation from the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) on February 27, 2019.

The Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) strives to provide the public with effective and consistent quality monitoring of health informatics and health information management programs through maintenance of accreditation processes. CAHIIM is recognized by the Council for Higher Education Accreditation (CHEA).

Additional information about the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) including its mission, vision, core values, and strategic goals may be found on its website, [CAHIIM.org](http://CAHIIM.org)

The HIM courses at VSCC were recently updated to be in compliance with the AHIMA 2018 Curriculum Competencies. These include the Data Management and Revenue Management Specialty Tracks. The American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA), our professional organization, guides the health information profession with academic curricula that outline key domain areas for mastery. The AHIMA Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) establishes curricula for HIM programs at the associate, baccalaureate, and graduate levels. The CEE approved the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies for implementation in the CAHIIM accreditation process. Accredited programs had to have the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies implemented in all

courses by September 1, 2021 All programs were notified in 2020. We submitted our Self-Assessment documentation to CAHIIM in 2021 to show we were in compliance with these competencies.

**Evidence:**

- 2-27-19 Certificate of Accreditation

**EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

**Narrative:**

HIM professionals serve the healthcare industry wherever health information is collected, organized, and analyzed. HIM professionals work in a variety of healthcare settings, education, payer organizations, research and policy agencies, consulting, and legal firms.

According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) employment of medical records and health information technicians (those with a certificate and/or associate degree) is expected to increase by 9% from 2020-2030, much faster than the national average. The demand exceeds the number of qualified professionals.

The VSCC Associate of Applied Science in Health Information Management program is designed to teach students the 38 entry-level 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies developed by the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) and the Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) and approved by the Commission on Accreditation of Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). Our curriculum includes both of AHIMA's specialty tracks: revenue management (RM) and data management (DM), as recommended by our HIM Advisory Board. Our curriculum prepares the student to sit for and pass the RHIT and begin their HIM professional careers.

The 2021 HIM graduates have found employment as:

- Medical Coders
- ROI Specialists
- Registrars
- HIM Specialist
- Record Content Specialist
- QA Specialist
- ROI Quality Analyst

They have been employed by the following organizations:

- Parallon Shared Service Center
- Xtend Healthcare
- Mayo Clinic, HIMS Department
- QTC (Quality, Timeliness, Customer Service)
- MediCopy
- Davita

# **Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback**

## **SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS**

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

### **Narrative:**

#### **What went right**

- **Advisory Board**

The VSCC HIM Advisory Board provides feedback regarding the HIM curriculum, graduate placement data, employer satisfaction survey results, and graduate licensure/certification results. The HIM Advisory Board also shares any new opportunities in HIM and ways we could better train our students so they are prepared to take advantage of any new opportunities. The HIM Advisory Board also provides feedback about the VSCC HIM students they may have hosted at their facilities for their PPEs (clinical). Their feedback is always positive with examples of how well-prepared our students are.

- **HIM Employee Surveys and Trends**

The general response rate for the HIM Employer Surveys has been low for the past three years as noted in the evidence. In order to increase the number of HIM Employer Survey results received we will send email reminders the first week after the survey has been sent, that include the importance of their feedback and the value we place in the information they share with us as well as how we use their feedback to improve the HIM Program.

- **HIM Graduate Surveys and Trends**

The HIM Graduate Survey results had a low response rate for AY18-19 and AY19-20, with improvement seen in AY20-21. We began reminding the HIM Program Students of the importance of returning these surveys and explaining how we use the survey results to improve the HIM Program during the spring semester Orientation, via email towards the end of the spring semester, and again via email after Graduation. We will continue to provide this information to the HIM Program students.

The attached VSCC HIM Program Annual Program Assessment Reports (APAR) submitted to the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) show the HIM Program enrollment, retention, and graduation results for the last three years. There was an increase in enrollment for AY20-21 with fifteen full-time students and seven part-time students. We will continue to participate in the Health Science Discovery Days, and host area high school students to share information about the HIM Program and professional field. We are also working with an Entertainment Media Production student to create a promotional video of the HIM Program for use on our VSCC webpage and possibly on social media platforms to increase awareness of the HIM Program and field.

- **Recruitment/Enrollment**

The attached VSCC HIM Program Annual Program Assessment Reports (APAR) submitted to the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) show the HIM Program enrollment, retention, and graduation results for the last three years. There was an increase in enrollment for AY20-21 with fifteen full-time students and seven part-time students. We would like to see an increase in enrollment to full capacity, 25 students. We are listed as a CAHIIM accredited Associate Level HIM Program on the CAHIIM website as well as the Tennessee Health Information Management Association website, allowing our program to be recognized nationally, and on a state level. We will continue to participate in the Health Science Discovery Days, and host area high school students to share information about the HIM Program and professional field. We are also working with an Entertainment Media Production student to create a promotional video of the HIM Program for use on our VSCC webpage and possibly on social media platforms to increase awareness of the HIM Program and field.

## What went wrong and plans to improve

- **Assessments**

Based on the assessment results in Via and the Annual Program Assessment results the HIM Program is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results however, to increase the HIM student learning and scores we believe two of the assignments should be moved to courses that better align with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competencies associated with these PLOs; we will also ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing these two assignments. We will provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for another assignment. To improve student success we will increase the RHIT first-time exam pass rate from 72% to 75%.

We will continue to analyze the assessments and results, update our curriculum to meet the needs of the students, and improve the student's learning of the HIM curriculum competencies to provide competent, successful students that pass the RHIT certification exam and become HIM professionals with a comprehensive entry-level HIM knowledge base. The HIM field changes rapidly due to changes in EHRs, technology, software, government quality initiatives, laws, regulations, and incentive programs, as well as other industry changes; we will continue to update and change the HIM curriculum as needed and required by CAHIIM, and the rapid changes in the HIM field.

## TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

### Narrative:

|     | <i>Initiative</i>        | <i>Objective</i>         | <i>Who</i>       | <i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i> | <i>Timeline**</i> | <i>Baseline Data</i> |
|-----|--------------------------|--------------------------|------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------|
| Ex. | Increase the achievement | To provide students with | Program Director | (1) Increase of XYZ              | AY2023-2024       | (1) 76% pass         |

|    |                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                      |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                |                                      |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
|    | of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements                                                                                                                                             | and VSCC1234 faculty                 | assignment pass rate to 82%.<br><br>(2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88%<br><br>(3) Reach 120 views | - Develop tutorial<br>- Faculty review of the tutorial.<br>- Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections.<br><br>AY2024-2025<br>- Launch video in the model shell | rate.<br>(2) PLO #1 82% met outcome. |
| 1. | Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #1                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Move SLO #1 to the HIMT 1305 course which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO</li> <li>• Ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing this assignment</li> </ul> | HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty | Increase the percentage met to 90%                                                                    | AY22-23                                                                                                                                                        | 86% met AY21-22                      |
| 2. | Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #3                                                      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Move SLO #3 to the HIMT 2309 course which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO</li> </ul>                                                                                                     | HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty | Increase the percentage met to 89%                                                                    | AY22-23                                                                                                                                                        | 85% met AY21-22                      |



|    |                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                      |                                           |         |                          |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|---------|--------------------------|
|    |                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Ensure the students are aware of any additional resources for completing this assignment</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                      |                                           |         |                          |
| 3. | Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #6 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty | Increase the percentage met to 84%        | AY22-23 | 80% met AY21-22          |
| 4. | Increase RHIT first-time pass rates to 75%                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Extend the study time by 1 week by allowing students to sit for the RHIT exam 1 week after graduation instead of sitting for the RHIT exam 2 weeks before graduation.</li> <li>• Allow students to take the Mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM as many times as they need to make a 75%.</li> </ul> | HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty | Increase RHIT first-time pass rate to 75% | AY22-23 | 72% first-time pass rate |

#### **DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.**

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

**Narrative:**

It is evident that a detailed evaluation of the Health Information Management program was conducted. Program faculty provided detailed plans for learning outcomes and student success. Some of the initiatives consist of curriculum revisions that should yield positive outcomes for students. I am most interested in Initiative #4: Increase RHIT first-time pass rates to 75% and look forward to seeing the results.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Director and the program faculty on this analysis and action plan. The program has shown marked improvement in persistence and retention rates in recent years, which is all the more impressive given the challenges of the pandemic. I agree with the dean that the plans to revise curriculum are thoughtful and thorough, and I also look forward to seeing the results for initiative #4. Another area the program may want to monitor and consider for future initiatives is placement. It may be that the dip in 2020 was due to the pandemic and will recover back to 2019 levels soon, but this could be a potential area for focus in years 2 or 3 if it does not.

**AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback**

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

**Narrative:**

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

**PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

**Narrative:**

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

**Action Plan Status Reports****YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

**Narrative:**

| YEAR 2 |                             |                                                                |                       |                       |                                          |
|--------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|
|        | Initiative                  | Achieved Milestones                                            | Challenges            | Changes if applicable | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s) |
| EX.    | Increase the achievement of | The tutorial video created.<br>Tutorial video presented at the | Delays in development | No changes            | The assignment                           |

|   |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                        |                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. | to the timeline. | success rate for pilot sections was 78%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1 | Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #1                                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course for Summer 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this SLO</li> <li>• Ensured the students were aware of additional resources for completing this assignment by adding the following resources to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>◦ AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52.</li> <li>◦ AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52.</li> <li>◦ HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf. (data element "patient race" is on page 35)</li> <li>◦ Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019. Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1).</li> <li>◦ Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | No challenges.                                                                         | N/A              | <p>The assignment for SLO #1 success rate was 100% met:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 14 of 16 students made a final grade of A, scoring 97-100%:</li> <li>• 2 of 16 students made a B, scoring 91%.</li> </ul> <p>Continue to monitor.</p> |

|   |                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                     |     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                       | SAS and CSV Datasets.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                     |     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 2 | Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #3 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Requested that SLO #3 be moved to the HIMT 2309 course for Fall 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this SLO,</li> <li>The following resource was added: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>AHIMA Informatics Toolkit</li> </ul> </li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | There were no challenges.                                                                                                                           | N/A | <p>The assignment for SLO #3 success rate was 100% with all students scoring 100%.</p> <p>Continue to monitor.</p>                                                                                                                                     |
| 3 | Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #6 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for SLO #6 Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership. The following resource articles were added: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><i>What are AHIMA Standards of Ethical Coding?</i></li> <li><i>AHIMA Ethical Coding Guidelines</i></li> <li><i>AHIMA Body of Knowledge Code of Ethics</i></li> <li><i>Is Medical Coding a Risky Job?</i></li> <li><i>Making Ethical Decisions: Process</i></li> <li><i>Steps of the Ethical Decision-Making Process</i></li> </ul> </li> </ul> | There were no challenges.                                                                                                                           | N/A | <p>The assignment for SLO #6 success rate was 100% met:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>15 of 17 students made a final grade of A, scoring 97-100%:</li> <li>2 of 17 students made a C, scoring 83%.</li> </ul> <p>Continue to monitor.</p> |
| 4 | Increase RHIT first-time pass rates to 75%                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Extended the study time by 1 week by allowing students to sit for the RHIT exam 1 week after graduation instead of sitting for the RHIT exam 2 weeks before graduation.</li> <li>Allowed students to take the Mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM as</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Students appreciated the additional study time, but still felt the added stress of taking the RHIT Exam 1 week after graduation, and hoped we would |     | <p>RHIT first-time exam pass rate of 94%.</p> <p>Results of the RHIT School Score Report for the academic year</p>                                                                                                                                     |

|  |  |                                        |                                                                                                                             |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--|--|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  |  | many times as they need to make a 75%. | increase that time for the next cohort.<br><br>We will discuss and possibly increase study time for the 2023 - 2024 Cohort. |  | from August 1st, 2022, to July 31st, 2023 were reviewed and students who test early and graduates had an RHIT first-time exam pass rate of 94%. We will continue to monitor<br><br>The HIM Program is effective in meeting student learning outcomes and curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results.<br><br>Continue to monitor. |
|  |  |                                        |                                                                                                                             |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

**Evidence:**

- AHIMA APAR Q4 RHIT School Score Report for August 1 2022 through July 31 2023
- Annual Program Assessment Report with Results August 1 2021 through July 31 2022

**YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

**Narrative:**

| YEAR 3 Progress |                                       |                                                                  |            |                              |                             |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                 | Initiative                            | Achieved Milestones                                              | Challenges | Performance Indicator Result | Initiative Achieved? Yes/No |
| EX.             | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by | The tutorial video was launched in the model shell.<br>Full-time | None       | The assignment success rate  | YES                         |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                              |     |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
|   | developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234                                                  | faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool<br>The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                   | for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%                                                                                                                   |     |
| 1 | Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #1. The assignment for SLO #1 success rate was 100% met in Year 2; we continued to monitor. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course, and continued to provide additional resources for completing the assignment.</li> <li>Reminded students of the additional resources for completing this assignment to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52.</li> <li>AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52.</li> <li>HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf . (data element "patient race" is on page 35)</li> <li>Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019.</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | Requested that SLO #1 be moved to HIMT 1305 class in Via, but found it had not been moved. Will request again for Summer 2024 semester HIM 1305 course, for 2024-2025 HIM Cohort. | The assignment for SLO #1 success rate was 72% met: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>8 of 11 students passed this activity.</li> <li>3 of 11 students failed this activity.</li> </ul> | No. |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |     |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
|   |                                                                                                                                                                                        | <p>Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1).</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for SAS and CSV Datasets.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |     |
| 2 | <p>Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #3. The assignment for SLO #3 success rate was 100% with all students scoring 100%; we continued to monitor.</p> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Requested that SLO #3 be moved to the HIMT 2309 course for Fall 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this SLO</li> <li>Provided the AHIMA Informatics Toolkit as an additional resource.</li> <li>Reminded students of the resource within the activity that provides the Structured Query Language (SQL), terms and concepts used to create queries.</li> </ul> | <p>Requested that SLO #3 be moved to HIMT 2309 class in Via, but found it had not been moved. Will request again for Fall 2024 semester HIM 2309 course, for 2024-2025 HIM Cohort.</p> | <p>The assignment for SLO #3 success rate was 90% met:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>8 of 9 students made an A scoring 100%</li> <li>1 of 9 students made an F scoring 75%</li> </ul> <p>Continue to monitor</p> | No  |
| 3 | <p>Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #6</p>                                                                                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for SLO #6 Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership. The</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                | None.                                                                                                                                                                                  | <p>The assignment for SLO #6 success rate was 100% met:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>7 of 9 students made an A scoring 100%</li> </ul>                                                                          | Yes |

|   |                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                            | <p>following resource articles were added:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>◦ <i>What are AHIMA Standards of Ethical Coding?</i></li> <li>◦ <i>AHIMA Ethical Coding Guidelines</i></li> <li>◦ <i>AHIMA Body of Knowledge Code of Ethics</i></li> <li>◦ <i>Is Medical Coding a Risky Job?</i></li> <li>◦ <i>Making Ethical Decisions: Process</i></li> <li>◦ <i>Steps of the Ethical Decision-Making Process</i></li> </ul> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 2 of 9 students made a C scoring 83%</li> </ul> <p>Continue to monitor.</p>                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 4 | Increase RHIT first-time pass rates to 75% | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Extended the study time by 2 weeks by allowing students to sit for the RHIT exam 1 week after graduation instead of sitting for the RHIT exam 2 weeks before graduation.</li> <li>• Allowed students to take the Mock RHIT exam in HIMT 2212 Seminar in HIM as many times as they need to make a 75%.</li> </ul>                                                                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• We will not receive the RHIT School Score Report for the academic year from August 1st, 2023, to July 31st, 2024 for review, until October 2024 at the earliest.</li> <li>• We have only received the APAR Q2 RHIT School Score Report: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>◦ None of our students had sat for the RHIT Exam as evident on the APAR Q2 RHIT School</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | <p>5 of 9 students have sat for the RHIT and sent us copies of their RHIT results:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 3 passed on first attempt</li> <li>• 1 passed on second attempt</li> <li>• 1 failed on first attempt</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• We will not receive the RHIT School Score Report for the academic year from August 1st, 2023, to July 31st, 2024 for review, until October 2024 at the earliest.</li> <li>• Final analysis of this initiative will be conducted at that time.</li> </ul> |



|  |  |  |              |  |  |
|--|--|--|--------------|--|--|
|  |  |  | Score Report |  |  |
|--|--|--|--------------|--|--|

| YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | Initiative                                                                                                                                          | How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.                                                                                                                                | How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| EX.                        | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | None                                                                                                                                                                                                       | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 1                          | Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #1.                                                                              | <p>The 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies align HIM education with the skills and knowledge required to meet long-term future HIM workforce needs.</p> <p>This initiative supports the required 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competency I.6DM Evaluate data dictionaries and data sets for compliance with governance standards:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• This assignment assist the students in Identifying and applying privacy and security strategies throughout the health information life cycle as they relate to information protection, access, use, disclosure, privacy, and security, is assessed utilizing EHR Go ROI and Accounting of Disclosure.</li> <li>• This assignment provides an introduction to the issues surrounding the release of information (ROI) and a patient's right to an accounting of disclosures of</li> </ul> | Yes, requested that SLO #1 be moved in Via to Summer Semester 2023 HIMT 1305 class which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency, associated with this SLO, however it has not been moved. | <p>The assignment for SLO #1 success rate was 72% met:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 8 of 11 students passed this activity.</li> <li>• 3 of 11 students failed this activity.</li> </ul> <p>Continue to monitor and follow-up on moving to the Summer Semester 2025 HIMT 1305 class within Via.</p> |

|   |                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                              | <p>their protected health information (PHI). Students must apply privacy and security strategies to health information, identify compliance requirements, manage data within a database system, apply legal processes impacting health information, and demonstrate compliance with external forces by answering questions regarding the ROI scenario given and the items on file in the EHR.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 2 | <p>Increase the percentage of HIM student learning and scores for SLO #3</p> | <p>The 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies align HIM education with the skills and knowledge required to meet long-term future HIM workforce needs.</p> <p>This initiative supports the following required 2018 AHIMA HIM Curriculum Competencies:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• III.1 Apply health informatics concepts to the management of health information.</li> <li>• III.2 Utilize technologies for health information management.</li> <li>• III.6 DM Manage data within a database system.</li> </ul> <p>This assignment assists students in Managing standards and data for exchange of health information as they relate to informatics, analytics, and data use, is assessed utilizing EHR Go Query Basic Orientation.</p> <p>In this assignment, students create and run queries to gather needed data, apply health informatics concepts to the management of health information, utilize technologies for health information management, and manage data within a database system.</p> | <p>Yes, requested that SLO #3 be moved in Via to Fall Semester 2023 HIMT 2309 class which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency, associated with this SLO, however it has not been moved.</p> | <p>The assignment for SLO #3 success rate was 90% met:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• 8 of 9 students made an A scoring 100%</li> <li>• 1 of 9 students made an F scoring 75%</li> </ul> <p>Continue to monitor and follow-up on moving to the Fall Semester 2025 HIMT 2309 class.</p> |
| 3 | <p>Increase RHIT first-time pass</p>                                         | <p>We increased the study time for the students by allowing them to</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <p>Yes, we will require the Academic Year</p>                                                                                                                                                                   | <p>The results of the RHIT Exam assist</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

|   |              |                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | rates to 75% | register and sit for the RHIT certification exam 2 weeks after graduation, reducing their stress. | 2025-26 Cohort of HIM students to register and sit for the RHIT certification exam before Graduation, as studies show that students that sit for the RHIT Exam early, before Graduation, do better on the exam. | in ensuring the HIM program provides the educational needs of students and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies.<br><br>Continue to monitor. |
| 4 |              |                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                           |

**Evidence:**

- AHIMA APAR Q4 RHIT School Score Report for August 1 2022 through July 31 2023
- Annual Program Assessment Report with Results August 1 2021 through July 31 2022

# **Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1**

Medical Coding CERT

## **Reflection and Mission**

### **PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW**

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

#### **Narrative:**

This is the first cycle of the APR. There have been no previous reviews or data collected for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate.

**Add start date of tracking the data for historical purposes such as:**

**AY 2022-23 was the first cycle of the MCTC APR. There have been no previous reviews or data collected for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate.**

### **Program Mission Statement**

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### **Narrative:**

The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management

The Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management prepares competent entry-level health information management technicians with the knowledge, technical skills, and professional attributes to enter the workforce with nationally recognized credentials that would afford our graduates an opportunity in any healthcare setting nationwide.

No changes have been made to the VSCC HIM Program mission statement and no revisions are planned.

### **Alignment to Institution Mission**

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

#### **Narrative:**

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management for those students who wish to continue their studies. Students obtaining the HIM degree after completing the Medical

Coding Technical Certificate must update their coding knowledge prior to sitting for the national Registered Health Information Technology (RHIT) Exam. All courses in the Medical Coding Certificate apply toward the HIM degree requirements. The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate students sit for the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) Certified Coding Associate (CCA) exam during their last semester in school.

The Health Information Management Program is highly central to the VSCC mission, vision, and core values. The Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management prepares competent entry-level health information technicians with the knowledge, technical skills, and professional attributes to enter the workforce with nationally recognized credentials that afford graduates an opportunity in any healthcare setting nationwide.

## **Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment**

### **Curriculum Map**

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

#### **Narrative:**

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification. A thorough knowledge and understanding of human anatomy and physiology are needed to pursue this certificate. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management for those students who wish to continue their studies. Students obtaining the Health Information Management degree after completing the Medical Coding Technical Certificate must update their coding knowledge prior to sitting for the national Registered Health Information Technology (RHIT) Exam. All courses in the Medical Coding Certificate apply toward the Health Information Management degree requirements. This is a three-semester certificate that only begins in the summer semester of each year. Courses must be taken in sequence.

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate students sit for the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) Certified Coding Associate (CCA) exam, during their last semester, just before graduation. Coding professionals who hold the CCA credential have demonstrated coding competency across all settings, including hospitals and physician practices. Since 2002, the CCA designation has been a nationally recognized standard of achievement in the health information management (HIM) field.

CCAs:

- Exhibit a level of commitment, competency, and professional capability that is valued by employers.
- Demonstrate a commitment to the coding profession.
- Distinguish themselves from others as having passed AHIMA's rigorous CCA exam.

### **Medical Coding Technical Certificate Program Learning Outcomes**

1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance.
2. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management.
3. Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance.
4. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership.
5. Apply knowledge of pathophysiology, pharmacology, anatomy and physiology, medical terminology, computer concepts and computer applications as they relate to health information management.

## **Assessment Method and Target Level of Outcome**

PLO #1 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, is assessed utilizing Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping.

In this assignment, students create a table to map the data element “patient race” to Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7 data requirements. Students must use the appropriate date definitions for each organization to create the table data requirements.

No achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #2 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #2. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.

In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient’s hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #3 Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.

In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine the present on admission (POA) status indicator for each.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #4. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.

In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and, if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA’s Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.

No achievement target has been identified due to lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24.

## **Additional Information**

The Medical Coding Technical Certificate PLOs were assessed during the spring 2022 semester however, as noted above, no achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24. There is no historical data to review for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate .

We require the Medical Coding Technical Certificate students to register and pay for the CCA exam during their last semester of school. We also book a week with the VSCC Pearson Vue Testing Center for the VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate and Health Information Management students to test for their CCA and RHIT certification exams.

AHIMA does not provide a CCA School Score Report so data is not readily available. For AY 22-23 we will ask the Medical Coding Technical Certificate students to email us with their test date and their CCA certification results, and explain the importance of sharing that information with us.

**Evidence:**

- MC, CERT Assessment Tool

**EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING**

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

**Narrative:**

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification. A thorough knowledge and understanding of human anatomy and physiology are needed to pursue this certificate. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management for those students who wish to continue their studies. Students obtaining the HIM degree after completing the Medical Coding Technical Certificate must update their coding knowledge prior to sitting for the national Registered Health Information Technology (RHIT) Exam. All courses in the Medical Coding Certificate apply toward the HIM degree requirements. This is a three-semester certificate that only begins in the summer semester of each year. Courses must be taken in sequence.

The VSCC Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) students sit for the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) Certified Coding Associate (CCA) exam, during their last semester, before graduation. Coding professionals who hold the CCA credential have demonstrated coding competency across all settings, including hospitals and physician practices. Since 2002, the CCA designation has been a nationally recognized standard of achievement in the health information management (HIM) field.

CCAs:

- Exhibit a level of commitment, competency, and professional capability that is valued by employers.
- Demonstrate a commitment to the coding profession.
- Distinguish themselves from others as having passed AHIMA's rigorous CCA exam.

The MCTC PLOs listed below were assessed during the spring 2022 semester using Via however, no achievement target has been identified due to a lack of historical data. Targets will be identified in AY23-24. An analysis of the spring 2022 results was conducted.

**Notations and summary of most recent assessments, AY21-22 Assessment Results:**

HIM Program Students and MCTC Students are assessed in the HIMT 2305 and HIMT 2303 classes. In AY21-22 we also had students from the MPM major in the HIMT 2305 class, in spring 2022. The MPM major is no longer offered at VSCC so in the future, we will not have MPM students in this class. HIM students will continue to be in both classes. Assessing the data based on the students' majors will be necessary for analyzing accurate statistical data in the MCTC APR and the HIM APR. The attached AY21-22 Assessment Results for MCTC only reflect the results of the MCTC students.

**Analysis of trends for Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) PLOs assessed:**

- PLO #1 HIM Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping 95% met; 5% not met
- PLO #2 HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission 100% met; 0% not met

- PLO #3 HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis 92% met; 8% not met
- PLO #4 HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making 78% met; 22% not met

#### **Ideas to improve student learning:**

- To increase the MCTC students learning and scores we will do the following:
  1. Delete PLO #1 Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, from HIMT 2305. This assignment will be moved to HIMT 1305 Computer Applications in HI, which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO, 1.6 DM (Data Management). This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies.
  2. Provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for PLO #4 Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership.

#### **Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) PLOs**

- PLO #1 - In HIMT 2305 Revenue Cycle Management PLO #1. Evaluate policies, regulations, and standards to the management of Health Information Management as they relate to data structure, content, and information governance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 1.29 Data Dictionary Mapping. In this assignment, students create a table to map the data element “patient race” to Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7 data requirements.

Students must use the appropriate date definitions for each organization to create the table data requirements.

- PLO #2 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #4. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.

In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient’s hospital stay. Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.

- PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #5 Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.

In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine what the Present on Admission (POA) status is for each scenario.

- PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.

In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and, if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA’s Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.

#### **Historical Assessments, Analysis, Summary of Results, and Trends**

There is no historical data for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate. We require the CCA students to register and pay for the CCA exam during their last semester of school. We also book a week with the VSCC Pearson Vue Testing Center for the VSCC MCTC students to test for their CCA certification exams.



AHIMA does not provide a CCA School Score Report so results data is not readily available. For AY 22-23 we will ask the MCTC students to email us with their test date and their CCA certification results, and explain the importance of sharing that information with us for improving the MCTC.

**We created the following Student and Graduate Goal for AY23-24:**

The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam.

**We created the following measured target outcome for meeting this goal:**

The curriculum meets the needs of our students, enabling them to graduate with entry-level competency. Using the student results of their CCA exam, students who test for the CCA exam will have an exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.

**Evidence of Student Learning:**

Based on the assessment results in Via the MCTC is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results however, to increase the MCTC student learning we will delete PLO #1 from the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet the Data Management Specialty Track competency associated with this PLO. We will also provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for the assignment associated with PLO #4. We have also created an MCTC Student and Graduate Goal to assess for AY23-24.

**Evidence:**

- AY21-22 Medical Coding Assessment Results

## **Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information**

### **STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION**

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

**Narrative:**

#### **Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Graduate Numbers**

- AY18-19 1 MCTC Graduate
- AY 19-20 8 MCTC Graduates
- AY 20-21 5 MCTC Graduates
- AY 21-22 1 MCTC Graduate

#### **Advisory Board and Alumni**

There is not an Advisory Board for the MCTC, however, we share any updates about the coding classes as well as the number of graduates. AHIMA does not provide a School Score Report for the CCA Exam so we

do not have pass rates. We ask the MCTC students to email and let us know when they sit for the CCA and to email us their results, but this method is not very effective.

52% of the VSCC HIM Advisory Board are VSCC Alumni. The VSCC HIM Advisory Board provides feedback each year on the HIM curriculum, which includes the MCTC curriculum.

The HIM Advisory Board also shares any new opportunities in HIM, including medical coding, and ways we could better train our students so they are prepared to take advantage of any new opportunities.

Perceptions of the Medical Coding Technical Certificate, students, and graduates are positive.

### **Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Graduate Surveys and Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Employer Surveys**

Survey data is inconclusive of evidence because these surveys aggregate the HIM and MCTC students.

### **Summary/Trends/Identified Strengths**

We will discuss with RASI the possibility of separating MCTC Employer Surveys and MCTC Graduate Surveys from HIM for future analysis.

## **RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA**

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

### **Narrative:**

#### **Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Retention**

- **AY18-19 50%**
  - 4 students began the MCTC summer 2018
    - 1 graduated spring 2019
    - 1 graduated spring 2020 (also obtained MPM)
    - 1 never took all the required MCTC courses. This student did graduate with an MPM degree spring 2019.
    - 1 never returned after her summer MCTC courses
- **AY 19-20 71%**

- 14 MCTC students began summer 2019
    - 7 graduated spring 2020
    - 2 graduated spring 2021 (also obtained MPM)
    - 1 graduated spring 2022 (also obtained MPM)
    - 1 failed summer 2019 classes
    - 3 withdrew fall 2019
- **AY 20-21 63%**
  - 8 MCTC students began summer 2020
    - 5 graduated spring 2021
    - 1 student never returned after summer 2020
    - 2 withdrew fall 2020
- **AY 21-22 33%**
  - 3 MCTC students began summer 2021
    - 1 graduated spring 2022
    - 1 failed summer 2021 courses
    - 1 never returned fall 2021

### **Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Graduation**

- AY18-19 1 MCTC Graduate
- AY 19-20 8 MCTC Graduates
- AY 20-21 5 MCTC Graduates
- AY 21-22 1 MCTC Graduate

### **Retention and Graduation Trends**

The MCTC retention rates have varied for the last three years from 77% to 33%.

The MCTC graduation results for the last four years have also varied. There was an increase in graduation for AY19-20 with eight MCTC graduates and a decrease in graduation for AY 20-21 and AY 21-22.

### **Plans for improvement:**

- Ensure all potential students have met with an HIM advisor prior to registration to ensure the student understands the following:
  - The MCTC is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification.
  - A thorough knowledge and understanding of human anatomy and physiology are needed to pursue this certificate. The curriculum will be difficult for any student who does not have this knowledge and understanding.
  - The MCTC curriculum is rigorous and students should expect to spend time working on course material and activities each day.
  - Most hospitals require medical coders to have at a minimum a two-year degree in Health Information Management (HIM) and pass the Registered Health Information Technician (RHIT) exam, and then obtain the Certified Coding Specialist (CCS) credential.
  - Graduates who successfully sit for the CCA may find employment as a medical coder at a physician's office, or working as a billing specialist.
  - MCTC graduates rarely are afforded an opportunity to work from home.

### **Evidence:**

- 2022 Medical Coding Fact Sheet

## Supporting Program Information

### FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

#### **Narrative:**

**Faculty Development Goal:** The program will provide a plan for faculty that establishes or assesses the knowledge, skills, qualifications, and experience pertinent to the professional curriculum content that they are assigned to teach.

This includes efforts to keep current in health information management, including medical coding and reimbursement, and/or other relevant professional content and practice, as well as other components of advanced formal education.

**Measured target outcome:** All HIM faculty will obtain CEUs annually to improve faculty knowledge and expertise, and keep current in the health information management areas in which they teach. All HIM faculty will turn in proof of their AHIMA membership and continued certification annually

**Steps to achieve:** Faculty will attend CAHIIM Townhall Meetings, THIMA Annual Meeting, pertinent webinars, local MTHIMA meetings, and professional development meetings to stay current in the topics they teach. One faculty member will attend AOE.

**Results/Analysis/Actions:** 100% of the HIM faculty are in compliance. Both faculty members attended the CAHIIM Townhall Meetings, the THIMA Annual Meeting, pertinent webinars, local MTHIMA meetings, professional development meetings, and AOE for AY20-21. We will continue to monitor.

### CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

#### **Narrative:**

The VSCC Health Information Management (HIM) Program is accredited by the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). We underwent a comprehensive review including a self-study and site visit 2017- 2018 and received continuing accreditation from the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) on February 27, 2019. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management.

The HIM courses at VSCC were recently updated to be in compliance with the AHIMA 2018 Curriculum Competencies. These include the Data Management and Revenue Management Specialty Tracks. The American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA), our professional organization, guides the health information profession with academic curricula that outline key domain areas for mastery. The AHIMA Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) establishes curricula for HIM programs at the associate, baccalaureate, and graduate levels. The CEE approved the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies for implementation in the CAHIIM accreditation process. Accredited programs had to have the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies implemented in all courses by September 1, 2021 All programs were notified in 2020. We submitted our Self-Assessment documentation to CAHIIM in 2021 to show we were in compliance with these competencies.

### CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

**Narrative:**

The Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) Students are Student AHIMA Members, <https://www.ahima.org/ahima-membership/membership-types-and-benefits/>

We encourage the MCTC students to attend the Annual THIMA Meeting and local Middle Tennessee Health Information Management Association (MTHIMA) Meetings.

The MCTC students are encouraged to sign up for the THIMA Mentor Program, <https://www.thima.org/members/mentor-program/>

The MCTC Students are encouraged to attend the AHIMA Student Open House during the fall semester. This complimentary virtual event offers the following:

- AHIMA Foundation scholarship opportunities
- How to transition from health information student to health information professional
- The top five emerging issues impacting health information management
- Building their personal brand on LinkedIn
- AHIMA credentials— options and where to get started
- Optimizing AHIMA student membership

Students also get a virtual tour of the new AHIMA Student Resources portal, with content and tools to help navigate their professional journey.

## **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

**Narrative:**

The VSCC Health Information Management (HIM) Program is accredited by the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). We underwent a comprehensive review including a self-study and site visit 2017- 2018 and received continuing accreditation from the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) on February 27, 2019. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management.

The Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) strives to provide the public with effective and consistent quality monitoring of health informatics and health information management programs through maintenance of accreditation processes. CAHIIM is recognized by the Council for Higher Education Accreditation (CHEA).

Additional information about the Commission on Accreditation for Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM) including its mission, vision, core values, and strategic goals may be found on its website, [CAHIIM.org](https://www.cahiim.org)

The HIM courses at VSCC were recently updated to be in compliance with the AHIMA 2018 Curriculum Competencies. These include the Data Management and Revenue Management Specialty Tracks. The American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA), our professional organization, guides the health information profession with academic curricula that outline key domain areas for mastery. The

AHIMA Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) establishes curricula for HIM programs at the associate, baccalaureate, and graduate levels. The CEE approved the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies for implementation in the CAHIIM accreditation process. Accredited programs had to have the 2018 AHIMA HIM Curricula Competencies implemented in all courses by September 1, 2021. All programs were notified in 2020. We submitted our Self-Assessment documentation to CAHIIM in 2021 to show we were in compliance with these competencies.

## **EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

### **Narrative:**

Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC) graduates that obtain their CCA are considered Health Information Management (HIM) professionals, as entry-level coders. HIM professionals serve the healthcare industry wherever health information is collected, organized, and analyzed. HIM professionals work in a variety of healthcare settings, education, payer organizations, research and policy agencies, consulting, and legal firms.

According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) employment of medical records and health information technicians (those with a certificate and/or associate degree) is expected to increase by 9% from 2020-2030, much faster than the national average. The demand exceeds the number of qualified professionals.

The VSCC Associate of Applied Science in Health Information Management program is designed to teach students the 38 entry-level 2018 AHIMA Health Information Management Curricula Competencies developed by the American Health Information Management Association (AHIMA) and the Council for Excellence in Education (CEE) and approved by the Commission on Accreditation of Health Informatics and Information Management Education (CAHIIM). Our curriculum includes both of AHIMA's specialty tracks: revenue management (RM) and data management (DM), as recommended by our HIM Advisory Board. The Medical Coding Technical Certificate is fully integrated into the Volunteer State Community College Associate of Applied Science degree in Health Information Management. Our MCTC curriculum prepares the MCTC student to sit for and pass the CCA and begin their HIM professional careers as entry-level medical coders.

## **Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback**

### **SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS**

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

### **Narrative:**

### **Results**

#### **Advisory Board**

There is not a separate Advisory Board for the Medical Coding Technical Certificate (MCTC), however, we share any updates and information about the coding classes as well as the number of graduates with the VSCC Health Information Management (HIM) Advisory Board. AHIMA does not provide a School Score Report for the CCA Exam so we do not have pass rates. We ask the MCTC students to email and let us know when they sit for the CCA and to email us their results, but this method is not very effective.

52% of the VSCC HIM Advisory Board are VSCC Alumni. The VSCC HIM Advisory Board provides feedback each year on the HIM curriculum, which includes the MCTC curriculum.

The HIM Advisory Board also shares any new opportunities in HIM, including medical coding, and ways we could better train our students so they are prepared to take advantage of any new opportunities.

Perceptions of the Medical Coding Technical Certificate, students, and graduates are positive.

### **MCTC Graduate Surveys and MCTC Employer Surveys**

Survey data is inconclusive of evidence because these surveys aggregate the HIM and MCTC students.

### **Summary/Trends/Identified Strengths**

We will discuss with RASI the possibility of separating MCTC Employer Surveys and MCTC Graduate Surveys from HIM for future analysis.

### **Retention/Graduation**

The MCTC retention rates have varied for the last three years from 77% to 33%.

The MCTC graduation results for the last four years have also varied. There was an increase in graduation for AY19-20 with eight MCTC graduates and a decrease in graduation for AY 20-21 and AY 21-22.

### **Plans for improvement:**

- Ensure all potential students have met with an HIM advisor prior to registration to ensure the student understands the following:
  - The MCTC is designed to meet the needs of individuals currently working in health care or related fields who need to obtain or upgrade their coding skills for career advancement or certification.
  - A thorough knowledge and understanding of human anatomy and physiology are needed to pursue this certificate. The curriculum will be difficult for any student who does not have this knowledge and understanding.
  - The MCTC curriculum is rigorous and students should expect to spend time working on course material and activities each day.
  - Most hospitals require medical coders to have at a minimum a two-year degree in Health Information Management (HIM) and pass the Registered Health Information Technician (RHIT) exam, and then obtain the Certified Coding Specialist (CCS) credential.
  - Graduates who successfully sit for the CCA may find employment as a medical coder at a physician's office, or working as a billing specialist.
  - MCTC graduates rarely are afforded an opportunity to work from home.

### **Assessments**

Based on the assessment results in Via the MCTC is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies. Student learning is evident in the overall results however, to increase the MCTC student learning we will delete PLO #1 from the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet the Data Management Specialty Track competency associated with this PLO. We will also provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge for the assignments associated with PLO #3 and PLO #4. We have also created an MCTC Student and Graduate Goal to assess for AY23-24.

We will continue to analyze the assessments and results, update our curriculum to meet the needs of the students, and improve the student's learning of the MCTC curriculum competencies to provide competent, successful students that pass the CCA certification exam and become Certified Coding Associates with a comprehensive entry-level medical coding knowledge base. The HIM field, including medical coding and reimbursement, changes rapidly due to changes in EHRs, technology, software, government quality initiatives, laws, regulations, and incentive programs, as well as other industry changes; we will continue to update and change the MCTC and HIM curriculum as needed and required by CAHIIM, and the rapid changes in the HIM field.

## **TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN**

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

**Narrative:**

|     | <i>Initiative</i>                                                                                                                                   | <i>Objective</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <i>Who</i>                            | <i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>                                                                                          | <i>Timeline **</i>                                                                                                                                                            | <i>Baseline Data</i>                                  |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Ex. | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty | (1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%.<br><br>(2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88%<br><br>(3) Reach 120 views | AY2023-2024<br>- Develop tutorial<br>- Faculty review of the tutorial.<br>- Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections.<br><br>AY2024-2025<br>- Launch video in the model shell | (1) 76% pass rate.<br><br>(2) PLO #1 82% met outcome. |
| 1.  | Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #1                                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Delete this PLO and move PLO #1 to the HIMT 1305 course which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO</li> <li>This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies</li> </ul> | HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty  | N/A                                                                                                                       | AY22-23                                                                                                                                                                       | 95% met AY21-22                                       |
| 2.  | Increase the percentage of                                                                                                                          | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Provide additional</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | HIM Program                           | Increase the percentage                                                                                                   | AY 22-23                                                                                                                                                                      | 92% met AY21-22                                       |



|    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                      |                                       |         |                          |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------|--------------------------|
|    | MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge                                                                                                                                                  | Director and HIM Faculty             | met to 96%                            |         |                          |
| 3. | Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Provide additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge</li> </ul>                                                                             | HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty | Increase the percentage met to 82%    | AY22-23 | 78% met AY21-22          |
| 4. | <p>Created Student and Graduate Goal for AY23-24:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam.</li> </ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Using the student results of their CCA exam, students who test for the CCA exam will have an exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.</li> </ul> | HIM Program Director and HIM Faculty | Baseline data not established for PI. | AY23-24 | 72% first-time pass rate |

### DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

#### Narrative:

Program faculty provided a detailed 2-year recommendation plan for Medical Coding technical certificate program. Program learning outcomes will be reassigned into appropriate courses, along with removing outcomes that are not required for the program. The curricular changes in addition to additional resources, may have positive impacts on the student access goal of increasing first-time passage rates to at least 72%

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Director and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. The curricular changes proposed here make sense and should improve the quality of the program. I encourage the program to consider adding additional actions related to recruitment and retention given the low number of students participating in and completing the program.

#### AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

**Narrative:**

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

**PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

**Narrative:**

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

**Action Plan Status Reports**

**YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

**Narrative:**

| YEAR 2 |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                              |                                            |                                                                                                        |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|        | Initiative                                                                                                                                          | Achieved Milestones                                                                                                                                                                              | Challenges                                                                                                   | Changes if applicable                      | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)                                                               |
| EX.    | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | The tutorial video created. Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting. Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.                                                                  | Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. | No changes to the timeline.                | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83% |
| 1      | Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #1                                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course for Summer 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum</li> </ul> | No challenges.                                                                                               | This is no longer an outcome for the MCTC. | N/A                                                                                                    |

Competency associated with this SLO

- Ensured the students were aware of additional resources for completing this assignment by adding the following resources to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7:
  - AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52.
  - AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52.
  - HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix\_A.pdf. (data element "patient race" is on page 35)
  - Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019. Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1).
  - Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for SAS and CSV Datasets.

**This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies**

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                           |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2 | <p>PLO #2 - Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.</p> | <p>Student was successful in meeting this.</p>                                                                                                   | <p>Student was assessed in eLearn, but student was not listed in Watermark for PLO #2 Case Study 4.17.</p>                               | <p>No changes to timeline.</p>                                                           | <p>The assignment for PLO #2 success rate was 100% with the one MCTC student scoring 100%.</p> <p>Continue to monitor.</p>                                |
| 3 | <p>Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #3</p>                                                                                                                                   | <p>Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge. Student was successful in meeting this.</p>                                   | <p>Student was assessed in eLearn, but student was not listed in Watermark for PLO #3 Case Study 5.4</p>                                 | <p>No changes to timeline.</p>                                                           | <p>The assignment for PLO #3 success rate was 94% with the one MCTC student scoring 94%.</p> <p>Continue to monitor.</p>                                  |
| 4 | <p>Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #4</p>                                                                                                                                   | <p>Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge. Student was successful in meeting this.</p>                                   | <p>Student was assessed in eLearn, but student was not listed in Watermark for PLO #4 Case Study 6.6</p>                                 | <p>Previously we Increased the percentage met to 82%.</p> <p>No changes to timeline.</p> | <p>The assignment for PLO #4 success rate was 92% with the one MCTC student scoring 92%.</p> <p>Continue to monitor.</p>                                  |
| 5 | <p>Created Student and Graduate Goal for AY23-24:</p> <p>The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met</p>                                     | <p>Using the student results of their CCA exam, students who test for the CCA exam will have an exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%.</p> | <p>The student works for Spheris Health and they wanted her to obtain the AAPC CPC Exam instead of the AHIMA CCA Exam for promotion.</p> | <p>No changes to timeline.</p>                                                           | <p>The MCTC student did not sit for the AHIMA CCA Exam as employer wanted her to sit for the AAPC CPC Exam for promotion; Student passed the AAPC CPC</p> |

|                                                                                                                                              |  |  |  |                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|--|----------------------------------------------------|
| and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam. |  |  |  | Exam on first attempt.<br><br>Continue to monitor. |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|--|----------------------------------------------------|

### YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

#### Narrative:

| YEAR 3 Progress |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |            |                                                                                                        |                             |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                 | Initiative                                                                                                                                          | Achieved Milestones                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Challenges | Performance Indicator Result                                                                           | Initiative Achieved? Yes/No |
| EX.             | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool. The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | None       | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86% | YES                         |
| 1               | Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #1                                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course for Summer 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this PLO</li> <li>Ensured the students were aware of additional resources for completing this assignment by adding the following resources to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint</li> </ul> | None.      | This is no longer an outcome for the MCTC.                                                             | N/A                         |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |              |                                                                                                                             |             |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <p>Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>o AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52.</li> <li>o AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52.</li> <li>o HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf. (data element "patient race" is on page 35)</li> <li>o Joint Commission on Accreditation of Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019. Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1).</li> <li>o Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for SAS and CSV Datasets.</li> </ul> <p><b>This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies.</b></p> |              |                                                                                                                             |             |
| 2 | <p>PLO #2 - Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.</p> | <p>Students were successful in meeting this.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <p>None.</p> | <p>The assignment for PLO #2 success rate was 100% with the two MCTC students scoring 100%.</p> <p>Continue to monitor.</p> | <p>Yes.</p> |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                           |       |                                                                                                                                                    |      |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| 3 | Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge. Student was successful in meeting this.                                   | None. | The assignment for PLO #3 success rate was 72% with the one MCTC student scoring 63% and one MCTC student scoring 81%.<br><br>Continue to monitor. | Yes. |
| 4 | Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Provided additional resources from the AHIMA Body of Knowledge. Student was successful in meeting this.                                   | None. | The assignment for PLO #4 success rate was 83% with each of the MCTC students scoring 83%.<br><br>Continue to monitor.                             | Yes. |
| 5 | Created Student and Graduate Goal for AY23-24:<br><br>The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam. | Using the student results of their CCA exam, students who test for the CCA exam will have an exam pass rate equal to or greater than 72%. | None. | Both of the MCTC students sat for and passed their CCA Exams.                                                                                      | Yes. |

| YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis |                                           |                                                |                                 |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Initiative                 | How has this initiative supported student | Will there be any further action taken on this | How will this initiative inform |

|     |                                                                                                                                                     | learning or student success?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | initiative? If yes, explain.               | program decisions in the future?                                                                       |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EX. | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | None                                       | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86% |
|     | Increase the percentage of MCTC student learning and scores for PLO #1                                                                              | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Requested that SLO #1 be moved to the HIMT 1305 course for Summer 2023 for 2023-2024 Cohort which better aligns with the 2018 AHIMA Curriculum Competency associated with this SLO</li> <li>• Ensured the students were aware of additional resources for completing this assignment by adding the following resources to determine the data element "patient race" from the data requirements for Joint Commission, MEDPAR, and HL7: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>◦ AHIMA. 2012. Managing a data dictionary. Journal of AHIMA 83(1):48–52.</li> <li>◦ AHIMA. 2011. Data mapping best practices. Journal of AHIMA 82(4):46–52.</li> <li>◦ HL7. 2016. Appendix A. Data Definition Tables. Appendix_A.pdf. (data element "patient race" is on page 35)</li> <li>◦ Joint Commission on Accreditation of</li> </ul> </li> </ul> | The other PLOs will need to be renumbered. | This is no longer an outcome for the MCTC.                                                             |



|   |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                                                | <p>Healthcare Organizations (Joint Commission). 2019. Specifications Manual for Joint Commission National Quality Measures (v2018A1).</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Research Data Distribution Center Medicare Provider Analysis and Review (MEDPAR) Record. 2019. Dictionary for SAS and CSV Datasets.</li> </ul> <p><b>This will remain a PLO for the HIM Program, but not for the MCTC as the MCTC students do not need to meet this Data Management Specialty Track competencies</b></p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 1 | For Year 2, PLO #s 2-5 Student was assessed in eLearn, but student was not listed in Watermark for PLO #s 2-5. | N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p>In the future, if students are in eLearn but not in Watermark, faculty will notify the VSCC Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment Officer so that those students may be added to Watermark. Investigated and found student registered for these classes in November, so further investigation by RASI Department may reveal the cause of this student not being in Watermark to help prevent this from happening again.</p> | <p>In the future, if students are in eLearn but not in Watermark, faculty will notify the VSCC Institutional Effectiveness and Assessment Officer so that those students may be added to Watermark.</p> |
| 2 | PLO #2 - Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they relate to revenue cycle                    | PLO #2 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding. Evaluate revenue cycle processes and methodologies as they                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | This PLO needs to be renumbered as PLO #1 due to deleting previous PLO #1.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | The assignment for SLO #2 success rate was 100% met.                                                                                                                                                    |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                         |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.                                                                         | <p>relate to revenue cycle management, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 4.17 Hospital-acquired Conditions and Present on Admission.</p> <p>In this assignment, students must take on the role of auditor and evaluate the present on admission status, code assignment, and DRG assignment for a patient's hospital stay.</p> <p>Students must evaluate the error, what impact the error has on reimbursement, and the action that might need to be taken to justify their conclusion of the coding error.</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Continue to monitor.                                                                                                    |
| 3 | PLO #3 - Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis. | <p>PLO #3 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding. Apply legal processes in health information management as they relate to health law and compliance, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 5.4 Present on Admission Analysis.</p> <p>In this assignment, students must evaluate different scenarios and determine what the Present on Admission (POA) status is for each scenario.</p>                                                                                                                                     | <p>This PLO needs to be renumbered as PLO #2 due to deleting previous PLO #1.</p> <p>Provide the following additional resources for students to use with this assignment:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <a href="#">Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality, Healthcare Cost and Utilization Project (HICUP) Present on Admission (POA) Indicator Toolkit</a></li> <li>• <a href="#">Centers for Medicare &amp; Medicaid Services Hospital-Acquired Conditions Present on Admission Indicator</a></li> </ul> | <p>The assignment for PLO #3 success rate was 94% with the one MCTC student scoring 94%.</p> <p>Continue to monitor</p> |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                 |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <a href="#">DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES Centers for Medicare &amp; Medicaid Services, Hospital-Acquired Conditions and Present on Admission Indicator Reporting Provision</a></li> <li>• <a href="#">US Department of Health and Human Services, Hospital-Acquired Conditions (Present on Admission Indicator): Coding. Guidance for identifying Present on Admission (POA) indicators for all diagnoses reported on claims involving inpatient admissions to general acute care hospitals.</a></li> </ul> |                                                                                 |
| 4 | <p>PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.</p> | <p>PLO #4 - In HIMT 2303 Advanced Coding, PLO #6. Assess management and leadership including cultural diversity and ethical standards of practice as they relate to organizational management and leadership, is assessed utilizing HIM Case Study 6.6 Ethical Decision Making.</p> <p>In this assignment, students must evaluate a situation and then use the ethical decision-making process to determine if this is an unethical situation and,</p> | <p>This PLO needs to be renumbered as PLO #3 due to deleting previous PLO #1.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <p>The assignment for SLO #4 success rate was 86% met. Continue to monitor.</p> |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | if so, provide what principle of the AHIMA Code of Ethics or AHIMA's Standards of Ethical Coding it violates, and what the implications of this violation might be to the coder, coding supervisor, the HIM Director and the organization.                  |                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 5 | PLO #5 - The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam. | The Medical Coding Technical Certificate will provide assurance that the educational needs of students are met and that graduates demonstrate at least the AHIMA entry-level curriculum competencies for the Certified Coding Associate certification exam. | This PLO needs to be renumbered as PLO #4 due to deleting previous PLO #1. | <p>One MCTC student did not sit for the AHIMA CCA Exam as employer wanted her to sit for the AAPC CPC Exam for promotion; Student passed the AAPC CPC Exam on first attempt.</p> <p>The other two MCTC graduates sat for and passed their AHIMA CCA certification exams.</p> <p>Continue to monitor.</p> |
|   | <p>Based on the assessment results in Via and the Annual Program Assessment results the MCTC is effective in reaching PLOs and course learning outcomes/curriculum competencies.</p> <p>We will continue to analyze the assessments and</p>                          | N/A                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | N/A                                                                        | continue to analyze the assessments and results, update our curriculum to meet the needs of the students, and improve the student's learning of the                                                                                                                                                      |

|  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | <p>results, update our curriculum to meet the needs of the students, and improve the student's learning of the MCTC curriculum competencies to provide competent, successful students that pass the CCA certification exam and become MCTC professionals with a comprehensive entry-level MCTC knowledge base. The MCTC field changes rapidly due to changes in EHRs, technology, software, government quality initiatives, laws, regulations, and incentive programs, as well as other industry changes; we will continue to update and change the MCTC curriculum as needed and required by CAHIIM, and the rapid changes in the HIM and MCTC fields.</p> |  | <p>MCTC curriculum competencies to provide competent, successful students that pass the CCA certification exam and become MCTC professionals with a comprehensive entry-level MCTC knowledge base.</p> |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

# Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Radiologic Technology AAS

## Reflection and Mission

### PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

#### Narrative:

No previous APRs have been completed. Prior reporting was executed on IE reports.

### Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### Narrative:

#### MISSION STATEMENT:

The mission of the Radiologic Technology Program at Volunteer State Community College is to produce entry-level graduates that are competent technologists, registry eligible, and demonstrate a professional concern for their patients.

*What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?*

The program did not make any changes to the mission statement over the course of this cycle. We review our mission statement annually with our Radiologic Technology Advisory Board. We will continue to present this to our advisory board and make changes as necessary.

### Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

#### Narrative:

Graduates from the radiologic technology program will support the college's mission by providing skilled radiographers to the imaging community. Graduates will utilize their education and skills in hospital settings, outpatient imaging centers, and various types of clinics and imaging centers throughout the country. The radiologic technology program enrolls both traditional and non-traditional students to achieve a degree in a medical imaging that will be in high demand for years to come. The radiologic technology program also prepares graduates to pursue credentials in many other imaging modalities as well as bridging their A.A.S. degree into a B.S.R.S. degree through East Tennessee State University.

## Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

### Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

**Narrative:**

The Radiologic Technology Program has a comprehensive assessment process to ensure continuous improvement and accountability. The assessment plan identifies benchmarks for the measurement of outcomes in relation to its mission statement, philosophy, and goals. Assessment plans are evaluated annually and adjustments are made according to technical changes or program advisement from the radiology advisory board, the Dean of Health Sciences, the Vice President of Academic Affairs.

**Evidence:**

- Assessment Plan 2020-2021
- RADT AAS Curriculum Map 2022
- RADT, AAS Assessment Tool

**EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING**

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

**Narrative:**

The program faculty analyzes student learning outcomes and program effectiveness data twice a year during planned assessment review meetings. The team reviews the criteria used in projects and assessments which effect student learning outcomes. The results of student learning outcomes and program effectiveness data are shared at the fall advisory meeting. Advisory committee members are encouraged to provide input regarding student learning outcomes and their effectiveness. The program processes changes based on the findings of the analysis. Advisory board meetings are held annually. The program uses analysis of employer and graduate exit surveys to highlight areas for program improvement. The information is used to determine if program updates are needed.

In support of the program's mission statement, the following have been developed. Upon completion of the radiography program our students / graduates will have successfully completed a number of goals and student learning outcomes:

**Program Goal-Clinical Competency.**

Students will demonstrate competency in the skills required of entry level radiologic technologists.

**Student Learning Outcome(s):**

1. Students will demonstrate proper patient positioning.
2. Students will properly determine technical factors to be used for radiographic procedures.
3. Students will apply knowledge of anatomy to accurately demonstrate desired anatomical structures on a patient diagnostic procedure.

**Program Goal-Problem Solving and Critical Thinking**

Students will demonstrate effective problem solving and critical thinking skills.

**Student Learning Outcome(s):**

1. Students will be able to evaluate radiographic images.
2. Students will be able to exercise judgment in the technical performance of medical imaging procedures.
3. Students adapt appropriately to changing needs of patients.

**Program Goal-Professionalism**

Students will exhibit professionalism for the patients by delivering high quality care with concern and compassion.

**Student Learning Outcome(s):**

1. Students will demonstrate professionalism.
2. Students will practice desirable customer service skills.
3. Students will show compassion and concern towards the patient.
4. Students present a professional appearance in the clinical setting.

**Program Goal-Communication Skills**

Students will establish effective communication skills.

**Student Learning Outcome(s):**

1. Students will use acceptable communication with patients and other professionals.
2. Students will use effective oral and written communication.

**Evidence:**

- 2019 Test Scores
- 2020 Test Scores
- 2021 Test Scores
- AY2021-2022 RADT, AAS Assessment Results
- vscc\_rad\_program\_data 2022

## **Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information**

### **STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION**

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

**Narrative:**

**Best practices:**

- Preparing the next teaching activity before the current one finishes, therefore creating continuity
- Involving students in classroom activities, to improve their communication, interpersonal and collaboration skills



- Creating a teaching activity by first defining its end goal and then determining the steps to get there
- Using resources such as lesson plans to have a benchmark that can improve teaching techniques
- Motivating students in the radiologic technology program to have a demeanor, appearance and character that they can use as examples.

### **Graduate Surveys**

Graduates surveys completed for students graduating in the spring of 2019, 2020, and 2021 yielded positive results. These surveys are the latest set of surveys available to the program. The average mean score on the overall quality of preparation as an entry-level radiologic technologist surveys for 2018, 2019, and 2020 revealed a mean score of 4.18 out of 5.00. The lowest section score on the survey was a 4.00 out of 5.00 on program quality.

The radiologic technology program has endured a lot of faculty turnover in the past 5 years. These changes required faculty teaching overload and teaching courses that they had not previously taught. These changes clearly had an impact on the quality of the program. The program has recently filled open positions and is fully staffed. The faculty will continue to implement and reinforce the learning methods and techniques used, and continue to improve on the quality of the courses.

Feedback received from students on graduate surveys reflected the students' desire to be have more experience in the operating room and the lab. Program faculty have incorporated lab exercises to acclimate students to the equipment and procedures in the operating room, as well as various other lab exercises to reinforce positioning skills.

### **Employer Surveys**

Response rate for employers is low, with an average of 53.3% response rate over the three years of employer satisfaction surveys. The employer surveys analysis reveals that employers responded that come students to their facilities with more, or less, or the exact level of entry skills with a mean score of 2.53 out of 5.00. Faculty will work with clinical affiliates to communicate when students are lacking in skills. In addition, faculty will reinforce skills with additional lab exercises. These areas for improvement should increase over time with the graduates' years of professional clinical experience

### **Evidence:**

- 2018 RADT AAS Employer Survey
- 2018 RADT AAS Graduate Survey
- 2019 RADT AAS Employer Survey
- 2019 RADT AAS Graduate Survey
- 2020 RADT AAS Employer Survey
- 2020 RADT AAS Graduate Survey

## **RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA**

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

**Narrative:**

The program publishes program effectiveness data on the VSCC website at [www.volstate.edu/radtech](http://www.volstate.edu/radtech). Program effectiveness data is also included in the annual report to the Joint Review Committee on education in Radiologic Technology (JRCERT).

Radiology program faculty market the program to high school students in various ways. Faculty participate annually in between 5-10 high school visits per year. High school visits give faculty an opportunity to discuss the profession of radiologic technology. Program faculty have also visited several local high schools to make potential students aware of the radiology technology program at VSCC.

The radiology program accepts 30 students annually. The retention rate over the past 5 years totals 84%. Program job placement over the past 5 years is 95%. First time credentialing exam rate for the past 5 years is 89%.

The faculty will incorporate tutoring for students that need additional course remediation to help improve retention. The program has consistently seen improvement in first time credentialing exam pass rate over the past 5 years. The most recent cohort graduating and achieved 100% first time pass rate.

**Evidence:**

- 2022 RAD Fact Sheet
- vscc\_rad\_program\_data 2022

## **Supporting Program Information**

### **FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)**

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

### **CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)**

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

## **CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

## **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

### **Evidence:**

- JRCERT Accreditation Letter 09-25-19

## **EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

## **Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback**

### **SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS**

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

### **Narrative:**

The Radiologic Technology Program will concentrate on enrollment, retention, AART licensure first-time pass rate over the next few years. Overall the program outcomes are very good but they could improve in the area retention. The retention rate averaged over three years (2020, 2021, 2022) is 84%.

The area that the program will concentrate on most heavily in the next few years is retention. Faculty will incorporate tutoring in courses and labs to help remediate students' grades in hopes of increasing retention.

### **TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN**

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

**Narrative:**

**Student Learning**

1. Students will score 70% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the ARRT credentialing exam (PLO 12)
2. Students will attend a two-day, onsite Kettering seminar licensure exam review course prior to taking the ARRT exam (PLO 12, PLO 13)

**Student Success**

Students will attend and participate in mandatory course and lab remediation sessions during the two-year program to help improve course grades and remain in the program. This will ensure that we are working to improve retention in the Radiologic Technology Program.

**DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.**

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

**Narrative:**

In the face of several changes in faculty over the past three years, the program has successfully been able to yield graduates with a 100% pass rate on the credentialing examination and obtainment of gainful employment. Nevertheless, focusing on retention is warranted. Successful completion of the student learning and success outcomes could improve their knowledge base and support their ability to remain in the program. Another area of focus should be on graduate perception of program quality as approximately 11% of the Graduate Survey respondents rated it as fair. A deeper dive into comments from student evaluations and recent graduate surveys will assist in identifying concerns which could potentially have an impact on retention.

**AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback**

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

**PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

**Action Plan Status Reports**

**YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the

results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

**Narrative:**

| YEAR 2 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                     |            |                       |                                          |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------|
|        | Initiative                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Achieved Milestones | Challenges | Changes if applicable | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s) |
| 1      | Students will score 70% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the ARRT credentialing exam (PLO 12)                                                                                                                                                                   |                     |            |                       |                                          |
| 2      | Students will attend a two-day, onsite Kettering seminar licensure exam review course prior to taking the ARRT exam (PLO 12, PLO 13)                                                                                                                                          |                     |            |                       |                                          |
| 3      | Students will attend and participate in mandatory course and lab remediation sessions during the two-year program to help improve course grades and remain in the program.<br>This will ensure that we are working to improve retention in the Radiologic Technology Program. |                     |            |                       |                                          |
| 4      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                     |            |                       |                                          |

**YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

**Narrative:**

| YEAR 3 Progress |                                                                                                             |                     |            |                              |                             |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                 | Initiative                                                                                                  | Achieved Milestones | Challenges | Performance Indicator Result | Initiative Achieved? Yes/No |
| 1               | Students will score 70% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the ARRT credentialing exam (PLO 12) |                     |            |                              |                             |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |  |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|--|
|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |  |
| 2 | Students will attend a two-day, onsite Kettering seminar licensure exam review course prior to taking the ARRT exam (PLO 12, PLO 13)                                                                                                                                       |  |  |  |
| 3 | Students will attend and participate in mandatory course and lab remediation sessions during the two-year program to help improve course grades and remain in the program. This will ensure that we are working to improve retention in the Radiologic Technology Program. |  |  |  |
| 4 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |  |

# Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Respiratory Care Technology AAS

## Reflection and Mission

### PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

#### **Narrative:**

This is Respiratory Care's first cycle participating in an Academic Program Review. There is not any previous data to review or report.

### Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### **Narrative:**

#### **Program Mission Statement**

The Respiratory Care Technology program at Volunteer State Community College provides a transferable degree created within a diverse educational environment which promotes the practice of critical thinking and problem solving, the development of clinical competence, and the advancement of the respiratory care profession through life-long learning.

No revisions have been made to the program's mission statement.

### Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

#### **Narrative:**

#### **Program Mission Statement**

The Respiratory Care Technology program at Volunteer State Community College provides a transferable degree created within a diverse educational environment which promotes the practice of critical thinking and problem solving, the development of clinical competence, and the advancement of the respiratory care profession through life-long learning.

Respiratory Care Technology graduates will support the college's mission statement by providing expert skills to care and treat pulmonary diseases in the respiratory care community. The program prepares the graduates to care for patients in many healthcare settings, including hospitals with acute care areas, intensive care units, critical care units, emergency departments, inpatient and outpatient rehabilitation, post anesthesia care units, outpatient clinics and home care. Vol State's Respiratory Care Technology Program foster's close relationships with clinical affiliates that provide students with a variety of different patient care experiences. The close relationships with community partnerships allows the students of all backgrounds to shape and mold skill sets learned during the course work of the program. The community partnerships promote diversity and cultural awareness while providing an educational environment allowing students of all backgrounds to utilize skills learned from the respiratory care technology program.

# Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

## Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

### Narrative:

The program's learning outcomes for the Respiratory Care Technology Program will be assessed in RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation I and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. The Respiratory Care Technology Program has four Student Learning Objectives.

- Demonstrate the ability to comprehend, apply, and evaluate clinical information relevant to their role as a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT).
- Demonstrate the technical proficiency in all skills necessary to fulfill the role as a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT).
- Demonstrate personal behaviors consistent with professional and employer expectations as a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT).
- Successfully meet employer expectations by competently performing skills required of a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT).

The program designated the first and second semester out of four to assess the student learning outcomes. Assessing the outcomes is being completed to monitor the progression of knowledge and skills during the semesters that require laboratory check-offs. The learning outcomes will assess the knowledge and skills required to become a registered respiratory therapist to pass two national board examinations and to be considered competent employees by respiratory therapy departments that will employ the graduate.

The learning outcomes will be assessed through laboratory check-offs during the first and second semesters. The course instructor will perform check-offs on each student for the required laboratory skills. Each student must successfully pass each laboratory check-off within four attempts. The student is being evaluated on effectiveness of communication, knowledge of check-off being performed, performance and safety of check-off, and thorough documentation of the check-off completed. The student demonstrates the skill being evaluated for the check-off step-by-step for the course instructor. The student is evaluated by one of the four levels identifying whether the student passes or fails the check-off attempt. The levels of evaluation for check-offs are:

- Done Correctly
- Not Done Correctly
- Not Done
- Not Applicable

To successfully pass the laboratory check-off the student must complete each step of the check-off with "Done Correctly. Once the student successfully completes the laboratory check-off the student is then allowed to complete the check-off and skill clinically. Program faculty demonstrate, observe, and remediate the students while practicing each laboratory check-off prior to the scheduled laboratory check-off date. Program faculty ensure the students are meeting successful completion of check-off within four attempts and continue to practice and improve their skills in the clinical setting.

Respiratory Care Technology Program [Check-off Forms](#) for viewing.

### Evidence:

- Laboratory and Clinical Check-off Forms
- Respiratory Care Technology AAS Curriculum Map



## EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

### Narrative:

The Respiratory Care Technology Program currently assesses student and program outcomes based on data from the Therapist Multiple Choice Examination (TMC) and the Clinical Simulation Examination (CSE) through the National Board for Respiratory Care (NBRC). Additionally, laboratory check-offs from the two key assessment courses (RESP 2440 and RESP 1420), course and graduate surveys are utilized for assessment. The data obtained from these items will be used to determine if the program's curriculum is effectively being taught.

The spring of 2022 is when respiratory care implemented two key assessment courses. The two courses the program has chosen is RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation (first semester) and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II (second semester). Currently, there is not enough data to report a trend or to implement any changes. The data from spring and summer 2022 show 100% of the assessment was met and 0% not met.

### Key Assessment Courses

RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation this course studies the techniques of mechanical ventilation including initiation and modification of settings. The assessment for this course will be how many students successfully completed a ventilatory check check-off and to evaluate how many attempts it takes the student to complete the check-off correctly.

RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II this course continues to build on respiratory care procedures and monitoring. The assessment for this course will be looking at how many students successfully complete an arteriotomy check-off and how many attempts does it take the student to complete the check-off correctly.

### National Board Examinations and Passage Rates

To become a Registered Respiratory Therapist (RRT) the graduates must pass both the Therapist Multiple Choice Examination (TMC) and the Clinical Simulation Examination (CSE). It is a requirement that the first examination will be the TMC. There are two scoring levels for this examination the high-cut score and the low-cut score. If the high-cut score is obtained the graduate is then eligible to take the CSE. If the graduates passed the CSE they are now an RRT. If the low-cut score is obtained on the TMC examination the graduate is not eligible to take the CSE, but the CRT credential is awarded becoming a Certified Respiratory Therapist (CRT). If the graduate desires to obtain the RRT credential. The graduate must retest starting with the TMC examination and must score at the high-cut score to be eligible for the CSE.

#### Passage Rates for Registered Respiratory Therapist

|      | Cohort Number | CSE            |
|------|---------------|----------------|
| 2019 | 13            | 12/13 – 92.31% |
| 2020 | 11            | 11/11 – 100%   |
| 2021 | 10            | 5/9 – 55.56%   |

The program has strong passage rates on the national board examinations in the 2019 and 2020 cohort to award the RRT credential. The focus is the CSE for the program obtaining the registry credential. The 2021 cohort has a significant decline in passage rates due to COVID-19. This cohort of students began the program in January 2020. The program is set-up for the didactic courses and laboratory courses to be synchronous. In March 2020, the program went completely online from face-to-face and laboratory courses were put on hold. Throughout the remaining program courses were moved from

different semesters to accommodate online learning. This was until the students could return to campus for laboratory courses while continuing didactic courses online. Additionally, the students did not get to begin clinical rotations until fall 2020, one full semester of clinical rotations were missed. Additionally, the fall 2020 clinical semester was limited on hands-on patient care and clinical experiences due to clinical affiliate restrictions. During the fall 2020 semester respiratory care students were not allowed to treat COVID-19 patients. As publicized, COVID-19 is a respiratory related illness causing which should have been the students second semester of clinical rotations as almost completely hands-off on patient care. This cohort of students truly had a disadvantage on caring for patients, developing their critical thinking, problem solving, and troubleshooting skills. The time the students were able to participate in clinical rotations was less than half for a standard cohort. The combination of the program becoming online, laboratory courses were no longer synchronous with didactic, and one semester of clinical rotations were missed lead to a significant decrease in passage rates.

The official CSE School Summary Reports from the National Board for Respiratory Care have been uploaded for evidence. The Respiratory Care Technology Program at Vol State consistently has higher than national average passage rates excluding the 2021 cohort from COVID. The 2021 cohort, academic year 2020 – 2021 is 0.36% from the national average passage rates. Although the program is happy with the passage rates on the national board examinations. There are always areas for improvement.

The examination report from the National Board for Respiratory Care breaks down the content areas aligning with a detailed content outline showing the matrix of material tested. Each year the program director evaluates the score reports for both TMC and CSE examinations. Any area(s) from the score report for the cohort that has scored <85% of national mean the program director creates an action plan. In 2020, section 2B which is Ensure Infection Prevention had a subscore of 72% of national mean. This section includes adhering to infection prevention policies and procedures, adhering to disinfection policies and procedures, and proper handling of biohazardous materials. All remaining subscores are greater than 85% of national mean on the New Candidate Summary (in evidence). Program faculty implemented the action plan of reviewing isolation procedures, donning and doffing of personal protective equipment, implemented hand hygiene video, and created a separate presentation covering the different levels of infection control. The extra efforts of implementing the action plan successfully increased the subscore by 19%. In 2021, section 2B increased to 91% on national mean. Program faculty continue to monitor subscores for each and implement action plans for areas that have a score less than 85% for the 2022 – 2023 academic year.

Starting with the 2022 – 2023 academic year, the Respiratory Care Technology Program will assess the course and program learning outcomes in its key assessment courses, RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. The program chose those two courses for assessment to provide evidence from the first semester to the second semester that the students are being effectively taught and can demonstrate proficiency in their skills required in becoming a Registered Respiratory Therapist. Program faculty hope all students achieve “Done Correctly” on all laboratory check-offs within two attempts. If areas of weakness are identified by assessment data indicating greater than two attempts to complete a laboratory check-off, program faculty will concentrate on strengthening areas of weakness to improve assessment outcomes.

**Evidence:**

- 2018-2019 RESP Test Scores, Cohort 2019
- 2019 Annual Report
- 2019-2020 RESP Test Scores, Cohort 2020
- 2020 Annual Report
- 2020-2021 RESP Test Scores, Cohort 2021
- 2021 Annual Report
- AY2021-2022 RESP, AAS Assessment Results

## **Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information**

## STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

### **Narrative:**

#### **Graduate Surveys**

[Graduate Surveys](#) completed for students graduating in spring of 2021 yielded positive scores. These survey results are the latest surveys available to the program. The three main categories on the survey average a mean score 4.88 out of 5.00. The score for Program Quality was 4.50 out of 5. The survey scores did not show any response less than 4.88. A comment was made on the area of the survey how to improve/strengthen the Respiratory Care Technology Program. The suggestion made was more hands-on care with neonatal patients in clinical rotations, especially deliveries of babies. The director of clinical education regularly schedules students for clinical rotations at two clinical affiliates that specialize in neonatal care each semester. The program director will continue to monitor survey results and comments to make adjustments where needed. The program director will ensure the students continue to have clinical rotations with neonatal experience. The Commission on Accreditation for Respiratory Care (CoARC) has a set threshold of 80% for Graduate Satisfaction. The 2021 graduate surveys met the threshold at 100%.

#### **Employer Surveys**

[Employer Surveys](#) were completed from employers that employee graduates from spring of 2021. Eight surveys were emailed out to the graduates current employers. This graduating class had 10 students. Two of the graduates were not employed. Seven out of the eight surveys sent out were returned. The overall response rating of the employer surveys were 3.71 out of 5.00. The Commission on Accreditation for Respiratory Care (CoARC) has set a threshold of 80% to be met for Employer Satisfaction. The 2021 survey results show the program's threshold was met with 86%.

Two areas scoring less than 4.00 on the surveys are the following:

- I. Knowledge Base: Initiate appropriate therapeutic interventions, monitor patient responses, and modify therapy to achieve goals.
  - Score indicated 3.86 out of 5.00.
- II. Clinical Proficiency: Apply problem-solving strategies in the patient care setting.
  - Score indicated 3.86 out of 5.00.

The first two sections Knowledge Base and Clinical Proficiency were significantly impacted due to the lack of clinical rotations during the pandemic of COVID-19. This cohort of students missed their first semester of clinical rotations. The students were able to participate in clinical rotations beginning in the fall 2020 semester. The clinical rotations were limited for hands-on patient care due to clinical affiliates limiting students to care for patients only that were not COVID-19 positive. During this cohort many patients across the state were COVID-19 positive. Also, with COVID-19 being heavily respiratory related students did not have adequate hands-on patient care experience to sharpen their critical thinking and problem solving skills. Additionally, some of the spring 2020 and summer 2020 laboratory check-offs were not complete for the fall 2020 clinical rotations limiting what the students could participate in clinically.

#### **Student Resource Surveys**

The student resource surveys were administered to the 16 students in the 2021 cohort with a 100% response rate. This cohort's data is for the 2021 - 2022 academic year. The overall response rate for the

resources of the program is a 4.69 out of 5.00. The resources include faculty, classroom, laboratory equipment, academic resources, and clinical resources. The surveys from this cohort do not reflect the clinical resources.

The lowest score on the student resource surveys were variety of equipment to perform required laboratory exercises. The pandemic affected students being able to participate in laboratory exercises and complete laboratory check-offs in a timely manner. Additionally, laboratory exercises were modified to accommodate The Centers of Disease Control guidelines for COVID-19. Program faculty modified how procedures were practiced and performed to reduce the spread of aerosol particles in hopes to maintain infection control which limited use of some equipment. These modifications restricted practicing laboratory check-offs with direct face to face, one-on-one, hands-on experiences. Program faculty worked with students to verbalize each step of the check-off to ensure understanding and demonstrate how the check-off is correctly performed. Additionally, to ensure proper technique and patient safety. If there were areas that the student verbalized or demonstrated incorrectly the students was remediated on the areas that were incorrect. Since these surveys were conducted the program has purchases five pieces of new equipment and laboratory practice is back to pre COVID-19 standards. The students are able to practice hands-on and participate one-on-one with each other to perfect their skills for their laboratory check-offs. Remediation is continued for students that do not pass their check-offs.

### **Program Resource Surveys**

[Program Resource Surveys](#) were completed by advisory committee members, Vol State program faculty, and the program's adjunct clinical instructors for the 2021 - 2022 academic year. The overall score from the resource surveys combining all categories is a 4.71 out of 5.00. The score for facilities and laboratory is a 4.72 out of 5.00. Academic support and financial resources score was a 4.68 out of 5.00. The clinical resources available to students scored a 4.68 out of 5.00.

Feedback provided on the resource surveys included:

- Laboratory Equipment needs updating and serviced.
  - The program director has been in contact with the mechanical ventilator service department for two mechanical ventilators that need servicing and new updated software installed. The program director is in process of getting the two mechanical ventilators scheduled for maintenance.
- Adjunct Laboratory Instructor:
  - The advisory committee members expressed the need for additional program faculty by adding an adjunct laboratory instructor. The program director has been in communication with Human Resources at Vol State to post a Pool Adjunct Instructor Position to see if there is interest for a laboratory instructor. The need for an adjunct instructor is heavy in the spring semester. The spring semester of the program is when there are two cohorts of students with didactic, laboratory, and clinical components. Both the program director and director of clinical education have heavy teaching and administrative roles during the spring semester. The program director will continue to advertise and seek out interest for the adjunct position.

### **Evidence:**

- 2018 RESP AAS Employer Survey
- 2018 RESP AAS Graduate Survey
- 2019 RESP AAS Employer Survey Results
- 2019 RESP AAS Graduate Survey
- 2020 RESP AAS Employer Survey
- 2020 RESP AAS Graduate Survey
- 2021 RESP AAS Employer Surveys
- 2021 RESP AAS Graduate Surveys
- 2021 RESP Program Resource Surveys

## **RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA**

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

### **Narrative:**

All statistic information for this section of the APR is based off of The Commission on Accreditation for Respiratory Care (CoARC) Annual Report. The data is the most accurate to the program's cohorts not academic years versus the Fact Book.

### **Enrollment, Retention, and Graduation**

The Respiratory Care Technology Program has consistent years of high number of program applicants, but has seen a decline in program applicants since 2014. The program is able to accept/enroll 22 students maximum for each cohort. A brief history to lay out when the program started to see a decline in program applicants. Prior to the 2014 cohort the number of program applicants ranged between 65 to 105 applicants for each cohort. In 2014, the program was restructured to begin in the summer semester instead of the fall semester to produce graduates at different times of year from other respiratory programs in the state. This change was made in hopes for all graduates to obtain employment beginning each fall after graduation. In 2016, the program had to restructure the layout of when classes/cohort(s) would start the program to accommodate the requirements for Tennessee Promise. As posted on page six of the 2022 CoARC's Annual Report the number of applicants have decreased since 2014 - 2015 cohort. The now enrollment of the spring semester for each starting cohort has limited students to one semester to complete the program's pre-requisites. In some cases, this change causes students to have to wait one-full year to apply to the program depending on when the student begins to take pre-requisite courses. If a student begins taking pre-requisites in the summer semester and finishes the pre-requisites in the fall semester they are eligible to apply and interview for the next starting spring cohort. All program applications are due by October 1st each year. Program interviews take place one week in November. Typically, the week before Thanksgiving. Final selection to the program is made after all final grades are posted in December.

In the 2022 - 2023 cohort the program received a total of 60 program applications. 33 interviews were scheduled and out of the scheduled interviews thirteen applicants were no call no shows. The program director reached out to those thirteen applicants via email and telephone to see if another interview date or time could be rescheduled. Only one applicant responded to rescheduling an interview. Due to the significant drop in scheduling and attending a program interview. The program director reached out to all of the Anatomy and Physiology Professors and the Medical Terminology Coordinator to see if they would be willing to share information about the Respiratory Care Technology Program with

their students. In response to this additional outreach the program was able to schedule one additional interview and that applicant was accepted into the 2022 - 2023 cohort. The program offered eighteen students seats in the 2022 - 2023 cohort. There were eighteen applicants that were eligible for enrollment. The 2022 - 2023 cohort started with fourteen students. During the first semester the cohort lost four students. The reason the four students left the program was due to personal health reasons or decided the field of respiratory care was not for them. The 2022 - 2023 cohort has 10 students and are scheduled to graduate in spring 2023.

CoARC's Annual Report shows the following statistics for retention. CoARC's threshold for retention is 70%. The program's threshold is an 87% or greater for retention according to CoARC's standards. Over the last three years the program has exceeded the set threshold for retention. Additionally, CoARC does not count students that withdraw from the program for personal reasons as a decline in the retention percentage. A student failing out of the program from academics is when the program's retention is negatively impacted.

| <b>2019 - 2021 Retention and Graduate Data</b> |          |                   |           |                                             |
|------------------------------------------------|----------|-------------------|-----------|---------------------------------------------|
|                                                | Enrolled | Percent Retention | Graduates | Number of Students Dropped Due to Academics |
| 2019                                           | 20       | 90%               | 11        | 2                                           |
| 2020                                           | 15       | 87%               | 10        | 2                                           |
| 2021                                           | 18       | 100%              | 16        | 0                                           |

As noted from the table above the 2019 and 2020 cohorts had two students that were dismissed from the program due to failing academics. The program's academic rigor is challenging and accelerated. It is difficult for students to work full-time and successfully complete this accelerated program. Many of the students that withdraw from the program it is due to needing to work full-time to support their family, the student(s) decide respiratory care is not the field for them, or a variety of personal reasons cause the student(s) to withdraw. Program faculty encourage students to develop study groups, practice laboratory check-offs outside of scheduled class times, apply for scholarships, apply for Workforce essentials to help financially with the program if one qualifies, and meet with their instructors for tutoring.

From CoARC's standards on retention the need is for the program director to continue to monitor the program's retention since the program exceeds the threshold. The program director plans to incorporate a remediation plan to the program's student policy and procedure manual. Currently, program faculty regularly provide remediation to students in need based on examination grades and/or laboratory check-offs. The program does not have an official benchmark set for remediation for the program faculty to utilize to determine set grades or standards when remediation should be initiated.

### **Recruitment**

Respiratory Care faculty participate regularly in high school visits for health sciences programs to promote the field of respiratory care and Vol State's Respiratory Care Technology Program. The only exception has been during the pandemic when schools did not have students face to face. Many students do not know what a respiratory therapist does or what patient populations respiratory therapist care for. Additionally, the program director started hosting monthly program information sessions in the fall of 2021 to increase awareness for the program. The clinical director host an annual smoking cessation event beginning fall 2021 on the Gallatin Campus. This event attracts many students on campus to learn about smoking cessation and about the field of respiratory care. As mentioned previously, the program director has reached out to the Anatomy and Physiology Faculty and the Medical Terminology Coordinator to showcase the field of respiratory care and the program at Vol State. The program director also works with Vol State's marketing department to post respiratory care related events, information sessions, and program application deadline. Program faculty have attended career expos and middle and high school events to promote the Respiratory Care Technology Program at Vol State. Program faculty will continue in their efforts in recruiting.

### **Evidence:**

- 2022 Annual Report

## **Supporting Program Information**

### **FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)**

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

### **CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)**

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

### **CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

### **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from creditable industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

#### **Evidence:**

- RPC Accreditation thru 2026

### **EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

## **Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback**

### **SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS**

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

#### **Narrative:**

The Respiratory Care Technology Program will concentrate on enrollment and retention over the next few years. The program will work to retain a greater number of students by implementing a remediation policy as mentioned in the academic program review. Additionally, the program will continue to work on increasing enrollment to the maximum amount. Program faculty will continue to work and dedicate on recruiting efforts through college and community involvement.

Program faculty will continue to use the most recent Therapist Multiple Choice Examination and Clinical Simulation Examination score reports to strengthen areas of the program curriculum. In addition, the program will utilize the assessment results of the program and student learning outcomes over the next two years to ensure program curriculum is effectively being taught.

## TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

### Narrative:

|     | <i>Initiative</i>                                                                                                                                                      | <i>Objective</i>                                                                                                                                                                            | <i>Who</i>                                          | <i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>                                                                                                                                  | <i>Timeline **</i>                                                                                                                                                                 | <i>Baseline Data</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ex. | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234                    | To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements                             | Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty               | (1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%.<br><br>(2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88%<br><br>(3) Reach 120 views                                         | AY2023-2024<br>- Develop tutorial<br>- Faculty review of the tutorial.<br>- Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections.<br><br>AY2024-2025<br>- Launch video in the model shell      | (1) 76% pass rate.<br><br>(2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1.  | Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO #1. | Improving the passage rates by the second attempt on these two laboratory check-offs Ventilator Check and Arteriotomy will help students gain competency quicker by tailoring their skills. | Program Director and Director of Clinical Education | 1). Increase laboratory check-off passage rates by the second attempt.<br>2). Each student has four attempts to successfully complete their laboratory check-off. | - AY 2023-2024<br>- Faculty will review check-off criteria and review expectations with students prior to laboratory check-off performance during the spring and summer semesters. | 1). 2022 - 2023 Cohort has a 100% on passage rate on the laboratory check-offs by the second attempt in RESP 2440 and a 80% passage rate in RESP 1420.<br>2). 100% of the students met the SLO #1 by the fourth attempt. |



|    |                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                     |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                   |
|----|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2. | Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.          | Clinical Simulation Examination score reports continue to be monitored for areas with a score less than 85% of national mean.                           | Program Director                                    | 1). Develop action plans to aid in improvement of scored areas less than 85%.                                | -AY 2023 - 2024.<br>The Program Director will implement needed changes on areas from the NBRC's Detailed Content Outline with a score of less than 85% of national means. | 1). 2021 - 2022 cohort 15/16 students passed the Clinical Simulation Examination and obtained the RRT credential. |
| 3. | Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than the current program average. | Increasing retention produces a higher number of graduates for employers to hire respiratory therapists and helps reduce the national shortage of RRTs. | Program Director and Director of Clinical Education | 1). Maximum enrollment is 22 students per cohort.<br>2). Retain 10% or more of enrolled students per cohort. | -AY 2023-2024<br>- Implement program remediation plan.                                                                                                                    | 1). Retention rate is 87% or greater.                                                                             |
|    |                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                     |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                   |

## DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

### Narrative:

The faculty of the Respiratory Care program submitted a thorough 1st-year APR. The two-year recommendation plan addresses learning outcomes, enrollment, and retention. I recommend unbundling enrollment and retention to focus on them as separate initiatives and assigning two performance indicators to each category. In addition to enrolling the maximum number of students in the next cohort, adding a recruiting effort that applies to the current population of general education students at the college could be helpful. It is mentioned that students who withdraw tend to do so due to personal issues such as work-life imbalances. Implementing a remediation plan is an excellent addition to aid in retention.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Director and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. I agree with the dean's suggestion to separate recruiting from retention in that initiative. Both are important, but they will require different strategies and so tracking them as separate initiatives would be better. I also agree that having earlier assessment will give the program more time to help assist students with remediation and should help improve passage rates.

### AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

**Narrative:**

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

**PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

**Narrative:**

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

**Action Plan Status Reports****YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

**Narrative:**

| YEAR 2 |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|        | Initiative                                                                                                                                          | Achieved Milestones                                                                                                                                         | Challenges                                                                                                       | Changes if applicable                                                                                                                                                                                            | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)                                                                                                                        |
| EX.    | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | The tutorial video created.<br>Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting.<br>Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.                       | Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.     | No changes to the timeline.                                                                                                                                                                                      | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%                                                          |
| 1      | Action Plan Number I: Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440                                          | RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation, Ventilator Check, Check-off the 2022-2023 cohort successfully completed the ventilator check-off in two attempts or less. | Arterial Blood Gas Analysis check-off is a challenging check-off to complete due to the complexity of the skill. | No changes needed for this check-off. The students are given two weeks to practice the Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off in lab prior to check-offs. If a student does not successfully pass their check-off | Achievement of each student successfully passing their check-offs by the fourth attempt meets the SLO# 1 with a 100% passage rate for check-off completion. The |

|   |                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                             |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | <p>Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO # 1.</p>               | <p>The ten students in the cohort during this spring semester completed the ventilator check, check-off successfully on the first attempt.</p> <p>RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II, Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off for the 2022-2023 cohort shows eight of the ten students successfully passed their check-off by the second attempt. Two out of the ten successfully completed their check-off by the third or fourth attempt.</p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <p>the student is remediated and has the opportunity to ask questions and to receive help.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <p>SLO #1 states students will successfully complete their check-offs by the fourth attempt.</p>                                            |
| 2 | <p>Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.</p> | <p>Ten students graduated in the 2022-2023 cohort. All ten students successfully completed the Clinical Simulation Examination on the first attempt.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <p>The Clinical Simulation Examination has eighteen content and section type subscores. The 2022-2023 cohort had three sections below the required national mean of 85% of greater.</p> <p>Content and section type subscores 2B. Ensure Infection Prevention, 3D. Administer Medications and Specialty Gases, and 3 G. Provide Respiratory Care in High-Risk Situations were the challenge areas with the 2022-2023 Clinical Simulation Examination.</p> | <p>The Program Director and Clinical Director reviewed the course curriculum for the three section subscores that scored an 85% or less than the national mean for 2022-2023. Subscore 2B: Ensure Infection Prevention. Program faculty added additional material to presentations and infection prevention charts and isolation precautions from the Center of Disease Control and Prevention. Subscore 3D. Administer Medications and</p> | <p>The new content implemented was monitored for progress on the 2023-2024 cohort passage rates on the Clinical Simulation Examination.</p> |

|   |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                               |
|---|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | <p>Specialty Gases. Program faculty added a cardiovascular drug unit with coordinating heart rhythms. Along with adding additional resources and material for administering specialty gases. Subscore 3G. Provide High-Risk situations. Program faculty have added more clinical experiences around student exposure to high-risk situations with physician contact in critical care areas.</p> |                                                                                                                               |
| 3 | <p>Action Plan Number 3: Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than current program average.</p> | <p>Enrolled fifteen students with the 2022-2023 cohort. Eighteen spots were offered to selected applicants.</p> | <p>Out of the eighteen students accepted to the Respiratory Care Technology Program three of those students decided not to pursue Respiratory Care at the present time. The three students made this decision prior to courses January 2022. Out of the fifteen students that enrolled and completed the program equaled a 67% retention rate, 10/15 graduated. The five students that did not graduate from program all made the choice to withdraw from respiratory care. There were various reasons why the five students elected to withdraw from health concerns, family obligations, and chose a different career path. None of the withdrawals were due to academics.</p> | <p>Program faculty will continue to offer remediation for lecture and laboratory components when students need additional help.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <p>Program faculty continued recruiting and remediation efforts in hopes of retaining 10% or more of the enrolled cohort.</p> |

|   |  |  |  |  |  |
|---|--|--|--|--|--|
| 4 |  |  |  |  |  |
|---|--|--|--|--|--|

| YEAR 2 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|        | Initiative                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Achieved Milestones                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Challenges                                                                                                       | Changes if applicable                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| EX.    | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234                                                                                                                                                         | The tutorial video created.<br>Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting.<br>Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality.     | No changes to the timeline.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%                                                                                                                                                    |
| 1      | <p>Action Plan Number 1: Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO # 1.</p> <p>Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates SLO #4.</p> | <p>RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation, Ventilator Check, Check-off the 2022-2023 cohort successfully completed the ventilator check-off in two attempts or less. The ten students in the cohort during this spring semester completed the ventilator check, check-off successfully on the first attempt.</p> <p>RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II, Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off for the 2022-2023 cohort shows eight of the ten students successfully passed their check-off by the second attempt. Two out of the ten successfully</p> | Arterial Blood Gas Analysis check-off is a challenging check-off to complete due to the complexity of the skill. | No changes needed for this check-off. The students are given two weeks to practice the Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off in lab prior to check-offs. If a student does not successfully pass their check-off the student is remediated and has the opportunity to ask questions and to receive help. | Achievement of each student successfully passing their check-offs by the fourth attempt meets the SLO# 1 with a 100% passage rate for check-off completion. The SLO #1 states students will successfully complete their check-offs by the fourth attempt. |

|   |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|--|
|   |                                                                                                       | completed their check-off by the third or fourth attempt.                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |
| 2 | Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.      | Ten students graduated in the 2022-2023 cohort. All ten students successfully completed the Clinical Simulation Examination on the first attempt. | The Clinical Simulation Examination has eighteen content and section type subscores. The 2022-2023 cohort had three sections below the required national mean of 85% of greater.<br><br>Content and section type subscores 2B. Ensure Infection Prevention, 3D. Administer Medications and Specialty Gases |  |  |
| 3 | Action Plan Number 3: Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than current program average. |                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |
| 4 |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |  |

### YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

#### Narrative:

| YEAR 3 Progress |                                                                                                  |                                                                                        |            |                                                                                                     |                             |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                 | Initiative                                                                                       | Achieved Milestones                                                                    | Challenges | Performance Indicator Result                                                                        | Initiative Achieved? Yes/No |
| EX.             | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to | The tutorial video was launched in the model shell.<br><br>Full-time faculty were also | None       | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86% | YES                         |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                   |
|---|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234                                                                                                                                            | encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                   |
| 1 | Action Plan Number I: Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO # 1. | RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation, Ventilator Check, Check-off for the 2023-2024 cohort had a 88% successful completion of the check-off by the second attempt.<br><br>RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off for the 2023-2024 cohort had a 93% successful completion by the second attempt. | Yes. RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation, Ventilator Check, Check-off two students did not pass their check-off until the third or fourth attempt. After remediation and mock check-off attempts the two students were successful in the check-off completion.<br><br>RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II, Arterial Blood Gas Analysis Check-off one student did not pass their check-off until the third attempt. With remediation and practice the student successfully completed the checkoff. | 100% of the cohort met the SLO #1 by completing the Ventilator Check and Arterial Blood Gas Analysis check-off by the fourth attempt. Majority of the 2023-2024 cohort successfully met the goal of check-off completion within two attempts.<br><br>The APR data for the 2022-2023 cohort in RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory II was an 80% check-off completion by the second attempt for Arterial Blood Gas Analysis. The 2023-2024 cohort increased by 13% for the goal of check-offs to be successfully completed by the second attempt. | No for a 100% completion of check-offs by the second attempt. The data does show an improvement in passage rates. |
| 2 | Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.                                                                                              | The 2023-2024 Cohort's Clinical Simulation Examination (CSE) score report shows all content and section subtypes are greater than the 85% of national mean.                                                                                                                                                                               | None                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Program faculty implemented four changes to course curriculum to improve the CSE scores. There were three categories that were < 85% of national mean and one category that was close to the 85% of national mean. The four subscore categories were: 1A. Evaluate Data in the Patient Record. 2B. Ensure Infection Prevention. 3D. Administer Medications                                                                                                                                                                                         | Yes                                                                                                               |

|   |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |    |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
|   |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                           | and Specialty Gases. 3G. Provide Respiratory Care in High-Risk Situations.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |    |
| 3 | Action Plan Number 3: Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than current program average. | The 2023-2024 Cohort started with the maximum acceptance of twenty-two students in January 2023. | Retaining 10% of more of enrolled students.<br><br>77% of the students that did not complete the program were reasons outside of the programs means to assist or control. | The 2023-2024 Cohort started with the maximum acceptance of twenty-two students in January 2023. The cohorts' retention rate was 59%. Thirteen students graduated in May 2024. Nine students from the twenty-two students did not complete the program. Two out of the nine students were not academically successful. Seven out of the nine students chose not to continue in the program due to various reasons: finances, health concerns, or decided the career choice of respiratory care was not for them. The two students that were not academically unsuccessful had multiple remediation meetings by both the Program Director and Director of Clinical Education. The remediation sessions were implemented to aid in student success. During the remediation sessions these students were worked with one-on-one reviewing course content, tutoring subject matter, practicing, and evaluating laboratory check-offs, and clinical related skills and issues. One student was academically unsuccessful in the first semester. One student was academically unsuccessful in the second semester. Both students had multiple absences and/or tardiness to class. The students that did not complete the program due to financial concerns were provided resources to the Foundation at Vol State to see if there was any additional financial | No |



|   |  |  |  |                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |
|---|--|--|--|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
|   |  |  |  | assistance available. One student was awarded monies to help them through the program. Unfortunately, the monies awarded still did not allow the student to continue in the program. |  |
| 4 |  |  |  |                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |

| YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis |                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | Initiative                                                                                                                                                              | How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.                                                                                  | How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| EX.                        | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | None                                                                                                                                                         | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| 1                          | Improve laboratory check-off passage rates for both Key Assessment Courses RESP 2440 Mechanical Ventilation and RESP 1420 Fundamentals of Respiratory Care II. SLO # 1. | <p>The completion of check-offs by the second attempt allows for quicker competency by tailing their skills. The quicker a student demonstrates laboratory competency the quicker the student can perform those skills clinically.</p> <p>The more exposure and practice students have in clinical rotations helps improve the student confidence and skills proficiency. Leading into stronger patient care.</p> | Yes. Program faculty will continue to monitor, review check-off criteria, and provide student remediation as needed.                                         | Based on the data reported there is still room for growth to improve laboratory completion of check-offs by the second attempt. Program faculty will continue to offer students open laboratory practice time outside of class days. Faculty members will continue to provide feedback after an unsuccessful check-off attempt and provide constructive remediation of the needed skill. |
| 2                          | Action Plan Number 2: Continue to monitor Clinical Simulation Examination Passage Rates. SLO #4.                                                                        | <p>The four content and section type subscores on the Clinical Simulation Examination that needed enhancing to ensure the subscores increased to 85% of national means or greater were successful.</p> <p>Subscore 1A: Evaluate</p>                                                                                                                                                                               | Yes, continue to monitor and implement changes to ensure content and section types by subscores remain 85% or greater than the national mean on the Clinical | The Program Director and Clinical Director will continue to monitor, review, and assess the content and section subtypes for the Clinical Simulation Examination. Improvement plans will be implemented on                                                                                                                                                                               |

|   |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                         |
|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                                       | <p>Data in the Patient Record. The Director of Clinical Education made sure to increase exposure to patient charts in the clinical setting. The students had the opportunity to read and study patient history, diagnosis, laboratory results, and diagnostic procedures.</p> <p>Subscore 2B. Ensure Infection Prevention. Throughout the course curriculum where infection control is taught. Program faculty have added additional material to presentations and infection prevention charts from the Center of Disease Control and Prevention.</p> <p>Subscore 3D. Administer Medications and Specialty Gases. Program faculty reviewed course material where medications and specialty gases are taught. Additional information about cardiovascular drugs and specialty gases administered have been incorporated in course material.</p> <p>Subscore 3G. Provide Respiratory Care in High-Risk Situations. Program Faculty have worked diligently to enhance clinical experiences to ensure student exposure to more high-risk situations. This exposure has been increased through more intensive care and emergency department scenarios.</p> | Simulation Examination.                                                                    | areas that score less than or close to 85% of the national mean.                                                                        |
| 3 | Action Plan Number 3: Enroll and retain a higher percentage of students than current program average. | A remediation plan was implemented for students that did not successfully pass laboratory check-offs on the first attempt and did not have a 75% average on                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Yes, program faculty will continue remediation efforts in hopes to aid in student success. | Program faculty will continue making efforts to improve program retention. The Program Director and Director of Clinical Education will |

|   |  |                                                                                                                                     |  |                                                                                                                                             |
|---|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |  | all course examinations.<br>The students were offered tutoring and additional help in lab with practicing check-offs of procedures. |  | review semester course evaluations and student feedback to see if there are areas of improvement that can be added to the remediation plan. |
| 4 |  |                                                                                                                                     |  |                                                                                                                                             |

# Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Physical Therapist Assistant AAS

## Reflection and Mission

### PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

#### **Narrative:**

This is the first Academic Program Review for this program.

### Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### **Narrative:**

The Physical Therapist Assistant Program offers an Associate Degree and seeks to graduate individuals who are competent and qualified to assume roles in the health care field as Physical Therapist Assistants. The program is committed to excellence in serving the ever-changing needs and interests of the Physical Therapy community of Middle Tennessee. The program supports the practice of Physical Therapy as a vocation to strengthen the healthcare workforce and economic development of Middle Tennessee.

***No mission statement revisions have been made.***

### Alignment to Institution Mission

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

#### **Narrative:**

The mission and philosophy of the Program are congruent with the mission and philosophy of the institution. The Program has the mission of providing competent and qualified physical therapist assistants at the associate degree level in serving the needs of the physical therapy community of Middle Tennessee. The Program enables the College to achieve its mission by preparing PTA students for employment in the community through successful completion of the curriculum and attainment of an associate degree.

## Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

### Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

**Narrative:**

The program learning outcomes for the Physical Therapist Assistant Program will be assessed in PTAT 2460 Patient Care Skills for the PTA and PTAT 2494 Terminal Clinical Education II. The Physical Therapist Assistant Program has three student learning outcomes.

1. Support the diverse physical therapy healthcare needs of Tennessee communities through employment as physical therapist assistants working under the supervision of physical therapists.
2. Demonstrate entry-level competence as physical therapist assistants as evidenced by successful completion of the National Physical Therapy Examination (NPTE) and qualification for state licensure.
3. Identify career development and lifelong learning opportunities as physical therapist assistants in contemporary physical therapy practice.

The program selected the student learning outcomes to be assessed in the first and third semester, Spring and Summer 2022. Assessing the outcomes is being completed to monitor the overall improvement of knowledge and the application of skills from the beginning of the program till the end of the terminal clinical education, prior to graduation. The learning outcomes will assess knowledge and skills required for a physical therapist assistant to pass the National Physical Therapy examination (NPTE) and to be considered for employment as an entry level physical therapist assistant.

The manner which the learning outcomes will be assessed, is through a comprehensive final practical examination at the end of PTAT 2460 and the clinical performance in PTAT 2494 with the mid-term and final assessment of PTAT 2494. The instructor of PTAT 2460 will evaluate the students on knowledge and skills applied with the emphasis of safe practice learned in PTAT 2460. All students must meet at least a satisfactory level score on all critical safety criteria and no more than 2 unsatisfactory marks in other performance criterion. The student's clinical instructor and Academic Coordinator of Clinical Education (ACCE) will evaluate the student in PTAT 2494 during mid-term and at the final assessment of the clinical externship. The student must be at entry level, at the final assessment capable of completing tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collection for patients with simple or complex conditions. This course requires all students to be rated at entry level practice in order meet the standards of final externship. Program faculty ensure that all students are successful in meeting the required skills for safe practice in the first semester at a satisfactory level, and at entry level in the third semester.

**Level of Evaluation for PTAT 2460**

Exceeds Satisfactory

Meets Satisfactory

Below Satisfactory

To successfully pass the final practical examination in PTAT 2460, the student must meet a satisfactory level on all critical safety criteria and no more than 2 unsatisfactory marks in other performance criterion. Program faculty ensure the students are meeting the successful completion of the final practical and are able to continue to practice and improve their skills in a competent and safe manner.

**Level of Evaluation for PTAT 2494**

**Beginning Level** – At this level, performance of essential skills is inconsistent and clinical problem solving is performed in an inefficient manner. Performance reflects little or no experience in application of essential skills with patients.

**Intermediate Level** – the student is proficient with simple tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collection and is developing the ability to consistently perform more complex tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collections.

**Entry Level** – the student is consistently proficient and skilled in simple and complex tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collection.

The Clinical Performance Instrument (CPI) assessment score must be at entry level on all critical safety skills by the completion of the final assessment of PTAT 2494 in order to ensure the student is capable of completing tasks, clinical problem solving, and interventions/data collection for patients with simple or complex conditions.

**Evidence:**

- CPI
- PTAT 2460 Lab Practical
- PTAT, AAS Assessment Tool

**EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING**

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

**Narrative:**

The Physical Therapist Assistant Program currently assesses student and program outcomes based on data from the National Physical Therapy Examination (NPTE), graduate and employer surveys. Additionally, final practical examination for PTAT 2460 and entry level on CPI for PTAT 2494 are utilized for assessment.

The spring semester of 2022, is when the Physical Therapist Assistant Program implemented two key assessment courses. The two courses the program chose are PTAT 2460 Patient Care Skills for the PTA (first semester) and PTAT 2494 Terminal Clinical Education II (third and final semester). Currently, there is not enough data to report a trend or implement any changes. The data from spring and summer 2022 show 100% of the assessment was met for both PTAT 2460 and PTAT 2494.

**Key Assessment Courses**

PTAT 2460 Patient Care Skills for the PTA - This course includes all of the fundamental patient care skills, selected data collection and physical therapy interventions for the physical therapist assistant student. The assessment for this course will be how many students successfully complete the final practical examination with a satisfactory or above satisfactory score.

PTAT 2494 Terminal Clinical Education II - Terminal clinical education experiences consist of the student's supervised clinical practice of previously learned PTA duties and functions in a physical therapy practice setting under the direction of a licensed physical therapist or physical therapist assistant. The assessment for this course is how many students will meet the entry level performance by the final CPI assessment.

**National Physical Therapy Examination (NPTE)**

To become a licensed physical therapist assistant (PTA), graduates must pass the NPTE in order to practice as a PTA. The NPTE is designed to assess the graduate's basic entry-level competence after graduation from an accredited program. This ensures that only those individuals who have the requisite knowledge of physical therapy are licensed in the physical therapy field. The passing standard is a scale score of 600; therefore, any score of 600 or higher is a passing score, and any score below 600 is a failing score. The passing scores established for the National Physical Therapy Examinations (NPTE<sup>®</sup>) reflect the level of performance required to provide minimally safe and

competent physical therapy services by physical therapists and physical therapist assistants. Individuals scoring at or above the passing score have met the performance standard and are eligible for licensure, and individuals scoring below the passing score have not met the performance standard and are not yet eligible for licensure.

The program has overall strong passage rates that meet accreditation standards (85% ultimate pass rate over two years) and are above the mean scale score of the national pass rates. In 2020 and 2022, the program had a significant decline in the first-time pass rate but the ultimate pass rate was at or above 96.9%. In 2021, the program had a first time pass rate of 100%. The summary of most recent assessment results reveal the licensure (NPTE) ultimate pass rate has maintained consistency in the results, although first-time pass rates have decreased.

| <b>NPTE LICENSURE PASS RATES</b> |                             |                           |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>GRADUATION YEAR</b>           | <b>FIRST-TIME PASS RATE</b> | <b>ULTIMATE PASS RATE</b> |
| 2022                             | 80%                         | 100%                      |
| 2021                             | 100%                        | 100%                      |
| 2020                             | 87.5%                       | 96.9%                     |

The official NPTE pass rate report from the Federation of State Boards of Physical Therapy have been uploaded for evidence. The Physical Therapist Assistant Program at Vol State consistently has higher than the national average pass rates. The 2021 graduates NPTE mean scale score of 696.2 is well above the national mean scale score of 645.7 pass rate. Although, the program is very pleased with the ultimate pass rate scores, the program would like to see improvements in the first-time pass rate.

Each year the program director evaluates the NPTE pass rate report. The faculty also reviews the results of a mock practice exam on the same graduates who took the NPTE. Those graduates who did not pass the NPTE first-time, also did not meet the expected score of the mock practice exam. Program faculty have implemented an action plan of a mock practice exams earlier in the program (2<sup>nd</sup> semester) may be beneficial on the first-time pass rates. Typically, the program offers a practice mock examination during the last semester (3<sup>rd</sup> semester) of the program. Faculty have decided to introduce the practice mock examination earlier in the program to best direct the students preparation for passing the NPTE licensure exam on the first attempt.

Stating with the 2022 – 2023 academic year, the Physical Therapist Assistant Program will assess the course and program learning outcomes in its key assessment courses, PTAT 2460 Patient Care Skills for the PTA and PTAT 2494 Terminal Clinical Education II. The program chose those two courses for assessment to provide evidence from the first semester to the third semester that the students can demonstrate kinematic skills necessary for PTA practice and the requisite knowledge of physical therapy to pass the NPTE. The program faculty hope all students can achieve a satisfactory level on the final practical examination and ultimately pass the NPTE. If any areas of weakness are identify on the assessment data, program faculty will look at areas of weakness to improve assessment outcomes.

Evidence:  
NPTE Licensure Pass Rate  
Program Outcomes  
CPI  
PTAT 2460 Rubric

**Evidence:**

- 2019, 2020, 2021 MFT 2 PTA State Board Results
- CPI
- NPTE Licensure Pass Rate
- PTAT 2460 Rubric Comprehensive Final Lab Practical
- Program Outcomes

## **Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information**

### **STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION**

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

#### **Narrative:**

##### **Graduate Surveys**

Graduates surveys completed for students graduating in the spring of 2019, 2020, and 2021 yielded positive results. These surveys are the latest set of surveys available to the program. The average mean score on the overall quality of preparation as an entry-level physical therapist assistant surveys for 2018, 2019, and 2020 revealed a mean score of 4.32 out of 5.00. The lowest section score on the survey was a 4.25 out of 5.00 on the collection of data from charts and patients. The collection of data from charts and patients occurs mostly while students are completing their clinical externships, although it is taught during their first semester while in the program. The faculty will continue to implement and reinforce the learning methods and techniques used.

Feedback received from students on graduate surveys reflected the students' desire to be taught more manual therapy techniques and experience in online documentation platform. Program faculty have incorporated guest speakers to address these two suggested specific topics during the last semester in the program.

##### **Employer Surveys**

Response rate for employers is low, with an average of 38.7% response rate over the three years of employer satisfaction surveys. The employer surveys analysis reveals their overall satisfaction of the graduate mean score is 4.68 out of 5.00. Faculty will work with Institutional Effectiveness, Research, Planning and Assessment to encourage employer's response rate.

Positive comments about the strengths of the program were written and the faculty will continue to implement and reinforce the learning methods and techniques.

Areas for improvement would be clinical reasoning skills, confidence, and time management. The program faculty will continue to address these areas throughout the program, and will continue to incorporate these areas for improvement in the laboratory setting. These areas for improvement should increase over time with the graduates' years of professional clinical experience.

#### **Evidence:**

- 2018 PTA Employer Satisfaction Survey
- 2018 PTA Graduate Satisfaction Survey
- 2019 PTA Employer Satisfaction Survey
- 2019 PTA Graduate Satisfaction Survey
- 2020 PTA Employer Satisfaction Survey
- 2020 PTA Graduate Satisfaction Survey



## **RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA**

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

### **Narrative:**

Enrollment for the Physical Therapist Assistant program has been set at 32 students each year up until the pandemic. The Physical Therapist Assistant program faced many challenges as the pandemic evolved. The program selected 18 students for the 2020 cohort, 19 students for the 2021 cohort and 24 students for the 2022 cohort. The reduction in enrollment was due to the inability to secure clinical placement for 32 students during the pandemic. Currently, clinical placement has improved to be successful in securing placement for 24 students, although the program is not able to meet the clinical placement of the previous years of enrollment of 32 students.

Retention has only been a challenge since the pandemic (Cohort 2021 and 2022). Beginning with cohort 2021, four students withdrew from the program for various reasons. Two students withdrew from the program due to the inability to successfully maintain academic standards of the program and the other two withdrew due to the clinical affiliates' requirements of the COVID-19 vaccine. Retention has been a challenge also for the 2022 cohort. Three students withdrew from the program due to the inability to successfully maintain academic standards of the program. Program faculty are concerned that some applicants are not prepared for the academic rigors of the physical therapist assistant program. This could be due to the changes of the delivery of courses to an online format during the pandemic. Prior to the pandemic, the Physical Therapist Assistant program has not had any enrollment and retention challenges. Overall, the mean average retention rate is 92.9% for the last three years (2019, 2020 and 2021). The Program Director will continue to monitor enrollment and retention rates.

Program marketing is extremely important for the Physical Therapist Assistant Program. From 2017 through 2021 the average number of applicants have been 56. In 2022, the number of applicants dropped to 32. The program contributes the drop in applications due to the COVID pandemic response. Health services utilization including physical therapy dropped precipitously as providers closed their doors to out-patient clinics and patients practicing social distance avoided health facilities. Faculty believe students are questioning their career choice in health care due to the effects of the pandemic. Students may not want to seek a career in health care because of the risks of exposure to COVID, mandating COVID vaccines and securing employment.

Program faculty spend a great deal of time with marketing and education. For many years, the program have hosted an Information Session, held once monthly for those seeking more information about the Physical Therapist Assistant Program. In addition to marketing to VSCC students, program faculty also market to high school students in various ways. Faculty participate annually in 5-10 area high school visits. High school visits give faculty an opportunity to discuss the profession of physical therapy while providing hands-on physical therapy learning activities, led by Physical Therapist Assistant students. The visits not only benefit the program as a marketing tool, but it allows the PTA students to demonstrate their knowledge and skills as they educate high school students. Program faculty have also visited several local high schools to educate on the field of physical therapy for those interested in a health care profession. Students and faculty from 2021 created an educational video about the program and the profession that would benefit a student who may have an interest in the program. These various activities assist program faculty create awareness of the program and profession.

Evidence:  
PTA Success Data  
2022 PTA Fact Sheet

**Evidence:**

- 2022 PTA Fact Sheet
- PTA Success Data

## **Supporting Program Information**

### **FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)**

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

### **CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)**

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

### **CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

### **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could

also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

**Evidence:**

- 2019 PTA Accreditation summary & certificate

## **EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

## **Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback**

### **SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS**

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

**Narrative:**

The Physical Therapist Assistant Program will concentrate on enrollment, retention, NPTE licensure first-time pass rate over the next few years. Overall the program outcomes are very good but they could improve in the area of first-time pass rate. The first-time pass rate averaged over three years (2020, 2021, 2022) is 89.1%.

The area that the program will concentrate on most heavily in the next few years is first-time pass rate on licensure exam (NPTE). The program will require earlier testing on practice mock examination to best direct the students to ensure student success. The program will set a minimum score of the practice mock examinations in order to ensure the student is prepared to pass the NPTE.

### **TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN**

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

**Narrative:**

#### **Student Learning**

Students will score 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE .  
Students will complete a two day onsite licensure exam review course prior to taking the NPTE.

#### **Student Success**

Passage rates on the NPTE. Faculty will evaluate the 1<sup>st</sup> time pass rate on the licensure exam (NPTE) to ensure student success with regards to obtaining a 95% first-time test taker pass rate for 2023 and 2024.

## **DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.**

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

### **Narrative:**

The program faculty have maintained high standards for the Physical Therapist Assistant program. The overall APR was thorough. Achievement of the student learning outcomes will also have positive effects on student success. Securing additional clinical affiliate relationships should be considered in this APR because it will increase the number of clinical opportunities for students, thereby impacting student success.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Director and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. I think the planned initiatives are good, but I agree with the dean's feedback that recruitment of clinical sites is an important initiative for this program to add so that it can return to its previous enrollment levels. Additionally, I encourage the program to explore the recent drop in job and monitor to see if additional initiatives in that area would be helpful.

## **AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback**

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

### **Narrative:**

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

## **PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

### **Narrative:**

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

## **Action Plan Status Reports**

### **YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

### **Narrative:**

|        |
|--------|
| YEAR 2 |
|--------|

|   | Initiative                                                                                           | Achieved Milestones                                                                    | Challenges                                                                                             | Changes if applicable                                                                                                                               | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)                                         |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Students will score 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE PLO 2         | Nine students out of 21, achieve a score of 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination. | Students need to improve study preparation for the practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE. | Increase the number of practice mock examinations prior to taking the NPTE and incorporating various forms of technology to assist with study prep. | With the increased number of practice exams, scores will improve to 600 or above |
| 2 | Students will complete a two day onsite licensure exam review course prior to taking the NPTE. PLO 2 | All students completed a two day onsite licensure review course.                       | All students participated.                                                                             | None                                                                                                                                                | Continue to offer the onsite review course each year.                            |
| 3 |                                                                                                      |                                                                                        |                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                  |
| 4 |                                                                                                      |                                                                                        |                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                  |

### YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

#### Narrative:

| YEAR 3 Progress |                                                                                              |                                                                                         |                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                   |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                 | Initiative                                                                                   | Achieved Milestones                                                                     | Challenges                                                                                            | Performance Indicator Result                                                                                                                        | Initiative Achieved? Yes/No                                                       |
| 1               | Students will score 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE PLO 2 | Seven students out of 20, achieve a score of 600 or 73% on a practice mock examination. | Students need to improve study preparation for the practice mock examination prior to taking the NPTE | Increase the number of practice mock examinations prior to taking the NPTE and incorporating various forms of technology to assist with study prep. | With the increased number of practice exams, scores will improve to 600 or above. |
| 2               | Students will complete a                                                                     | All students completed a                                                                | All students participated.                                                                            | None                                                                                                                                                | Continue to offer the                                                             |

|   |                                                                              |                                          |  |  |                                 |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--|--|---------------------------------|
|   | two- day onsite licensure exam review course prior to taking the NPTE. PLO 2 | two- day onsite licensure review course. |  |  | onsite review course each year. |
| 3 |                                                                              |                                          |  |  |                                 |
| 4 |                                                                              |                                          |  |  |                                 |

| YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | Initiative                                                                                                                                                     | How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?                                                         | Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.                                                                    | How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?                                                                                                     |
| EX.                        | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234            |                                                                                                                                | None                                                                                                                                           | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%                                                               |
| 1                          | Increase the achievement of PLO #2 by ensuring only those who score a 600 or 73% on a practice mock exam will be allowed to take the NPTE prior to graduation. | Eight students were successful in scoring at least a 600 or 73% on a mock practice exam.                                       | Yes, incorporate a resource (Basecamp) as a required assignment to ensure students are preparing for the NPTE while completing their clinical. | The ultimate success rate for the NPTE is 85% for 2024 and 90.5% for 2023, therefore the PTA Program is in compliance with CAPTE.                                    |
| 2                          | Students were successful in completing a 2 day review course.                                                                                                  | 95% of students overall impression of the course was favorable and recommended the course be offered to the next year's class. | Even though the 2 day review course was favorable, the ultimate pass rate has declined since 2022.                                             | Since the ultimate pass rate has declined over the last 2 years, I think incorporating an asynchronous course review for students to complete during their clinical. |
| 3                          |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 4                          |                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                      |

# Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1

Veterinary Assistant CERT

## Reflection and Mission

### PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

#### Narrative:

The last program assessment for the VTA program was in 2019, under the previous system. At that time the program had 3 outcomes.

1. Demonstrate knowledge of office/hospital procedures and communicate in a professional manner
  1. This outcome was assessed in VTA 130: B on Final Exam and B on Client Education paper.
  2. Spring 2019 72% of students achieved a B on the Final but only 50% were able to achieve a B on the Paper.
  3. The plan was to add written assignments to other classes – which happened. Also, to add interactive communication practice in VTA 130. Interactive practice did not happen because of COVID. This is beginning Fall 2022.
2. Recognize and demonstrate nursing procedures appropriate for a veterinary assistant
  1. This outcome was assessed in VTA 120: B on Final Exam and B on Animal Care Rotation rubric.
  2. Fall 2018 92% of students achieved a B on both assessments.
  3. There were no additional plans made for this outcome.
3. Recognize and demonstrate diagnostic procedures appropriate for a veterinary assistant, common to veterinary facilities
  1. This outcome was assessed in VTA 140: B on the Final Exam and B on the skills test rubric.
  2. Spring 2018 86% of students achieved a B on the Final Exam. Only 57% of students achieved a B on the skills test.
  3. The plan was to increase the number of visits to Animal Control in VTA 151 in the Fall of 2020. Also to repeat the VTA 140 skills in VTA 151 in the Fall. Neither happened because of COVID.

### Program Mission Statement

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### Narrative:

The program did not have its own mission statement. One will be drafted and approved Fall 2022. Approvals will take place Fall 2022 at the Advisory Committee Meeting.  
Current Mission Statement Draft:

- The mission of the Veterinary Assistant Program is to enable students to attain gainful employment by providing high quality education and clinical experiences. These services contribute to the college's mission by building partnerships within the community and preparing students for successful careers.

## **Alignment to Institution Mission**

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

### **Narrative:**

Alignment to Institutional Mission

- The mission of the Veterinary Assistant Program is to enable students to attain gainful employment by providing high quality education and clinical experiences.
- These services contribute to the college's mission by building partnerships within the community and preparing students for successful careers.

## **Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment**

### **Curriculum Map**

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

### **Narrative:**

PLO#1 – Demonstrate interpersonal and interprofessional communication skills with the clients and veterinary team. Students must write a client education handout in VTA 151. Target achievement level is 90%. This is at least their second paper to write while in the program.

PLO#2 – Demonstrate knowledge of office and hospital procedures appropriate to the veterinary assistant. Students rotate through several jobs while at animal control as part of VTA 151. The Recorder job is used to assess this outcome. The recorder must use appropriate abbreviations and terminology as they transcribe the medical notes. Target achievement level is 90% or better for every outcome.

PLO#3 – Properly assess and evaluate needs of patients as they relate to animal care. The Assistant job in VTA 151 is used to assess this outcome. The assistant must gather data on the patients, perform grooming of nails and administer prescribed medication. Target achievement level is 90% or better for every outcome.

PLO#4 – Demonstrate ability to assist with common veterinary procedures involving companion animals. The Lab Tech job in VTA 151 is used to assess this outcome. The Lab tech must gather supplies and perform needed tests as directed by the Licensed Technician or Veterinarian. Target achievement level is 90% or better for every outcome.

### **Evidence:**

- VTA Certificate AAS Curriculum Map 2022
- VTA, CERT Assessment Tool

## **EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING**

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.



**Narrative:****Summary of most recent assessment results**

1. PLO#1 was not assessed in AY21-22.
2. PLO#2 – 100% of students successfully demonstrated applied knowledge of Hospital Procedures.
3. PLO#3 – 90% of students successfully demonstrated applied knowledge of Animal Care.
4. PLO#4 - 100% of students successfully demonstrated applied knowledge of Assist with Procedures.

**Analysis of trends**

Students in this course must first pass VTA 140 Clinical Procedures. There is generally quite a bit of attrition between the 2 courses. This level of success is expected with this set of students. Students may perform each of the skills / assessments multiple times during a semester. It is expected that 100% will meet expectations by the end of the semester. Moving the formal assessment to the end of the semester may improve outcomes. There were no results for Communication because those assessments did not get put into VIA.

**Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning**

Looking at only these outcomes it would seem there is not much need to improve. That is not the case. Retention rates need to improve. The Communication SLO must be evaluated after the Fall 2022 class is complete. This may give more information about the needs of this course and the program.

**Evidence:**

- AY2021-2022 VTA TC Assessment Results

**Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information****STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION**

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

**Narrative:**

There are no responses from graduates about the program.

There were only 2 responses to the 2020 Employer Satisfaction survey, none in 2019 and 4 responses in 2018. Looking at all the results, all employers said the students were prepared for the position and their overall satisfaction was satisfied or very satisfied. When evaluating the skills of the graduate, the graduate's ability to work with others was only fair according to half of the employers. This would indicate there is a need to work with our students in this area.

Course evaluations were collected from several of the courses. The majority of students really liked the hands-on portions of the curriculum. One of the few criticisms, students wanted more opportunities to perform those skills.

**Evidence:**

- 2018 VTA TC Employer Survey
- 2019 VTA TC Employer Survey
- 2020 VTA TC Employer Survey
- VTA 100 Student Evaluations 2022
- VTA 140 student evaluations 2022

## **RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA**

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

### **Narrative:**

Looking at headcount, recruitment and enrollment is near capacity, which is set at 24. Many students choose the Vet Assistant program because it fits into their schedule. Most of the classes are late afternoon or evening so that working students can attend the in-person classes. There is also a set of students that choose this program because they did not have the grades for or get accepted into the Vet Tech program.

Retention is poor, at anywhere from 57% to 77%. Part of the poor retention is from COVID and online coursework. That was difficult for this group. Student must pass VTA 140 with a C or better to take 2 of the Fall semester classes, VTA 151 – Veterinary Assistant Seminar and VTA 145 – Assistant Clinical Practicum. Almost all of the students that do pass VTA 140 graduate from the program.

Employment rates are very low according to graduate placement data. How accurate is this data is zero graduates completed the alumni survey? The program needs to survey students before they graduate about placement.

### **Evidence:**

- 2022 VTA TC Fact Sheet

## **Supporting Program Information**

### **FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)**

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

### **CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)**

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

### **CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

### **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

### **EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

## **Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback**

### **SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS**

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

#### **Narrative:**

Since the last program review there have been some positive changes in the program learning outcomes and how they are assessed. There is clear evidence that 90% of students are meeting all of the outcomes that were measured.

The program did not measure PLO#1 last year, but that will be measured AY 22-23. There is very little feedback from graduates or employers. The lack of good feedback limits how the program is assessed. The other serious limitation is the low retention rates. The students completing the PLO assessments have already demonstrated competency in previous classes. Data needs to be gathered on why students

are not successfully passing VTA 140. The recommendations below are based on the findings from this review.

## TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

### Narrative:

|     | <i>Initiative</i>                                                                                                                                   | <i>Objective</i>                                                                                                                                                | <i>Who</i>                            | <i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>                                                                                              | <i>Timeline **</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <i>Baseline Data</i>                                                                                                                      |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ex. | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements | Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty | (1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%.<br>(2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88%<br>(3) Reach 120 views             | AY2023-2024<br>- Develop tutorial<br>- Faculty review of the tutorial.<br>- Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections.<br><br>AY2024-2025<br>- Launch video in the model shell                                                  | (1) 76% pass rate.<br>(2) PLO #1 82% met outcome.                                                                                         |
| 1.  | Improve student learning in the area of interpersonal and interprofessional communication. This is part of PLO #1                                   | To provide students with relevant and consistent practice of interpersonal and interprofessional communication.                                                 | Program Director and VTA faculty      | Increase PLO #1 achievement to 90%<br><br>Increase in employer satisfaction survey for graduates' ability to work with others | AY2022 – 2023<br>Develop assignments that reflect contemporary practice interactions<br>Develop a peer evaluation system for group projects<br><br>AY2023-2024<br>Increase the number of group projects throughout the program | 50% of employers rated the graduate's ability to work with others fair<br><br>There is no other data reflecting working well with others. |
| 2.  | Improve students' skills in assisting with common veterinary                                                                                        | To provide students with relevant and consistent practice with common                                                                                           | Program Director and VTA faculty      | Increase PLO #4 achievement to 100%                                                                                           | AY 2022-2023<br>Develop a list of assistant skills that are                                                                                                                                                                    | 90% success rate for restraint                                                                                                            |

|    |                                                                      |                                 |                                  |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                    |
|----|----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
|    | procedures. This is part of PLO #4.                                  | veterinary procedures.          |                                  | Increase in student clinical rotation evaluations in <i>appropriately handles animals</i><br><br>Increase passage rate of VTA 140 | needed in practice<br>Develop a standard and rubric for each skill<br><br>AY 2023-2024<br>Add a lab to VTA 140, which will increase the amount of time students have to learn each skill<br>Implement skills and rubric changes | Less than 60% pass rate of VTA 140 |
| 3. | Increase retention rate of students between Spring and Fall semester | To increase number of graduates | Program Director and VTA faculty | 75% of students that start the program, complete it<br><br>Increase passage rate of VTA 140 to 75%                                | See improvements to VTA 140<br>AY2023-2024<br>Develop support services for students in VTA 100 and 140.<br><br>AY2024-2025<br>Implement those services                                                                          | 57% retention rate in 2021         |
| 4. |                                                                      |                                 |                                  |                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                    |

### DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

#### Narrative:

With data provided by the Program Director, Dr. K. Hope Wright, I approve this report. The data presented shows a program poised to continue to make great strides and a program with very good supportive data showing good retention, persistence, and graduation data. I approve this review and action plan.

VPAA Feedback: The action plan is thoughtful and is aimed to help more students complete this high-quality program. I appreciate the work of the Director and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. I think the focus on success in the gateway course will have an important effect on program retention and completion rates.

#### AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

**Narrative:**

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

**PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

**Narrative:**

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

**Action Plan Status Reports**

**YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

**Narrative:**

**Recommendation 1**

PLO#1 – Communications: Improve student learning in the area of interpersonal and interprofessional communication.

Performance Indicators

- Increase PLO #1 achievement to 90%
- Increase in employer satisfaction survey for graduates' ability to work with others

Results

- 2023 evaluations for VTA 145 indicate 8 out of 11 students received an excellent on communication skills. The other 3 received a good.
- Fall 2023, 100% of students successfully completed a client communication handout and utilized medical terminology appropriately. There are no employer surveys for this time period.

Modified Timeline

2023-2024

- Add assignments to Economics that reflect contemporary practice interactions
- Add a peer evaluation system to the group projects in VTA 120
- Track professional communication in clinics for VTA 145
- Institute the peer evaluation system

**Recommendation 2**

PLO#4 – Assist with Procedures: Improve students' skills in assisting with common veterinary procedures. This is part of PLO #4.  
Performance Indicators

- Increase PLO #4 achievement to 100%
- Increase in student clinical rotation evaluations in *appropriately handles animals*
- Increase passage rate of VTA 140

#### Results

- 2023 evaluations for VTA 145 indicate 8 out of 11 students received a good to excellent on animal handling skills.
- In 2023, 100% of students successfully restrained a dog or cat during VTA 151.

#### Modified Timeline

- Postpone and re-evaluate need next year: Add a lab to VTA 140, which will increase the amount of time students have to learn each skill

## Recommendation 3

Student Success: Increase retention rate of students between Spring and Fall semester.  
Performance Indicators

- 75% of students that start the program, complete it
- Increase passage rate of VTA 140 to 75%

#### Results

- 2022: 13 students VTA 140 to 8 students in VTA 151 = 61.5% retention
- 2023: 15 students VTA 140 to 7 students in VTA 151 = 46.6% retention
- 2024: 14 students VTA 140 to unknown at this time

There are a number of students every year that have accommodations from the access center. Often those students choose not to go to the access center for testing. The instructors have strongly encouraged those students to take tests there this year. That has helped their test scores. Instructors have also increased the number of hands on activities during this semester.

#### Evidence:

- VTA 151 CLO 22-23
- VTA PLO 22-23

## YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

#### Narrative:

## Recommendation 1

PLO#1 - Communications: Improve student learning in the area of interpersonal and interprofessional communication.

Performance Indicators:

- Increase PLO #1 achievement to 90%
- Increase in employer satisfaction survey for graduates' ability to work with others

#### Results

- 2024 VTA 145: 88.88% of students (8 out of 9) received an excellent or good on communication skills from their clinical rotation site. This is a decrease from 100%.
- 2024 VTA 151: 88.88% of students (8 out of 9) received an A on their research paper as a demonstration of written communication skills. This is a decrease from 100%.
- 2024 VTA 151: 100% of students utilized medical terminology appropriately during the semester. This is from a new set of skills.

At such low numbers, the failure of one student to successfully complete a task radically decreases the overall success rate. 89% achievement in communication is a reasonable success rate.

### Recommendation 2

PLO#4 - Assist with Procedures: Improve students' skills in assisting with common veterinary procedures. This is part of PLO #4.

#### Performance Indicators

- Increase PLO #4 achievement to 100%
- Increase in student clinical rotation evaluations in *appropriately handles animals*
- Increase passage rate of VTA 140

#### Results

- 2024 VTA 145: 77.77% of students received an excellent or good on their animal handling skills from their clinical rotation site. This is a increase from 72.7%.
- 2024 VTA 151: 95.65% of students successfully restrained a dog or cat during lab. This is a decrease from 100%
- 2024 passage rate of VTA 140 was 91.6%. That is an increase from 60%.

There has been a shift in hands on tasks given to the students during VTA 151. Instead of getting only a few opportunities at Animal Control to handle animals, students now spend most of lab time preparing animals for surgery. This has significantly increased their hands on opportunities, which increases their odd of success. This was a great semester with the group in Fall of 2024.

### Recommendation 3

Student Success: Increase retention rate of students between Spring and Fall semester.

#### Performance Indicators

- 75% of students that start the program, complete it
- Increase passage rate of VTA 140 to 75%

#### Results



- 2023: passage rate of VTA 140 was 60% (9 out of 15 students passed with a C or better). Of those, 77% enrolled and successfully completed VTA 151 (7 out of 9). From the start of Fall 2023, 40% graduated December 2023.
- 2024: passage rate of VTA 140 was 91.6% (11 out of 12 students passed with a C or better). Of those, 81.1% enrolled and completed VTA 151 (9 out of 11). From the start of Fall 2024, 33% graduated December 2024.

The instructors have done a great job with increasing the success rate of VTA 140 without compromising quality of education. There is still a serious disconnect between Spring and Fall semesters. Of the 2024 group, 4 did not register for VTA 151 or dropped early on because of personal reasons. Of the ones that completed VTA 151, 1 could not graduate because their overall GPA was not at a 2.0 and 2 still had other classes to take due to failing previous coursework.

**Evidence:**

- 2023 VTA 140
- 2023 VTA 151
- 2024 VTA 140
- 2024 VTA 151
- VTA 151 CLO Report Fall 2024

# **Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1**

Mechatronics Technology AAS

## **Reflection and Mission**

### **PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW**

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

#### **Narrative:**

This is the first APR for the Mechatronics Technology program. However, the program had an accreditation review in Spring 2022 by ATMAE. The program was recommended for accreditation having been found in full compliance with 17 accreditation standards and partial compliance with 2 standards.

The self-study and visiting team report are attached as evidence.

#### **Evidence:**

- ATMAE Self-Study 2022 Final Version
- VolState-Team Report 2022

### **Program Mission Statement**

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### **Narrative:**

No changes to the program mission have been made and none are planned.

### **Alignment to Institution Mission**

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

#### **Narrative:**

The Mechatronics Technology program aligns with the institutional mission by

- preparing students for successful careers by "provide the academic knowledge and practical experience necessary to prepare students for employment as highly skilled mechatronics technicians"
- employing innovative educational programs through "practical" (i.e. lab based) experiences.
- building partnerships with companies that hire Mechatronics graduates through
  - preparing students enter "the workforce quickly with the technical skills that employers demand"
  - having company representative serve on the advisory committees
  - providing WBL (work-based learning) opportunities through local companies
  - having guest speakers from local companies

## **Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment**

## Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

### Narrative:

The 7 outcomes are assessed in the following courses:

- MECH 1330
- MECH 2320
- MECH 2441
- MECH 2425

Assessments are attached as evidence.

### Evidence:

- Control Wiring Assessment v2
- MECH 1330 - Outcomes Assessment
- MECH 2441 PLC Troubleshooting Assessment
- MECH AAS Curriculum Map 2022
- MECH, AASCERT Assessment Tool

## EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

### Narrative:

The Mechatronics program has an exit exam that each student is required to take prior to graduation. This was reported on in the ATMAE self-study. This portion of the report is copied below.

<http://schemas.microsoft.com/office/2004/12/omml>" xmlns="http://www.w3.org/TR/REC-html40">

#### **Mechatronics Exit Exam**

Beginning in Fall semester of 2019, Mechatronics students were required to take an exit exam to measure competency levels for each of the program outcomes. Students were not required to pass the exam as this was to be a measure of their mastery of the program outcomes and provide feedback to the program. The exam is multiple choice and is patterned after the Siemens Mechatronics Systems Certification Program (SMSCP) Level 1 and Level 2 exams. The exam as well as exam analysis reports can be found in Appendix 5.3 – Mechatronics Exit Exam. Due to the COVID pandemic and the campuses being closed to students, Spring 2020 graduates were given an exemption from taking the exam.

Each question was mapped to one or more program outcomes. Some of the outcomes were broken down into subcategories for analysis.

Summary Report

Performance on Program Outcomes and sub-outcomes

| Outcome | Performance |
|---------|-------------|
|---------|-------------|

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| 1. The graduate will have demonstrated a thorough understanding of the electrical components, electric motors, and mechanical components in a mechatronics system.                                                                                                                                                                    | 43% |
| 1a. Electrical components                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 48% |
| 1b. Electric motors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 22% |
| 1c. Mechanical components                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | 46% |
| 1. The graduate will demonstrate a thorough understanding of basic pneumatic, electro pneumatic and hydraulic control circuits in a mechatronics system.                                                                                                                                                                              | 57% |
| 1. The graduate will demonstrate a thorough understanding of basic digital logic and programmable logic controllers (PLCs) in a mechatronics system.                                                                                                                                                                                  | 50% |
| 3a. Digital Logic                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 38% |
| 3b. PLC systems                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 58% |
| 1. The graduate will have demonstrated the ability to use troubleshooting techniques, correct malfunctions, perform systematic preventive maintenance and apply safety rules with respect to electrical components, mechanical components, electric motors, pneumatic and hydraulic controls, and PLCs used in a mechatronics system. | 44% |
| 4a. Electrical troubleshooting                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 49% |
| 4b. Mechanical troubleshooting                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 16% |
| 4c. Motors troubleshooting                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 22% |
| 4d. Pneumatic/hydraulic troubleshooting                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 55% |
| 4e. PLC troubleshooting                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 52% |
| 1. The graduate will have demonstrated the ability to install, implement and modify software tools used in mechatronic systems.                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 51% |
| Overall Performance                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 50% |

#### Analysis of Exit Exam results

- Overall performance on the exam was low with low correlation between exam performance and student GPA. Correlation coefficient = 0.01
- Reasons for poor performance
  1. Exam is too difficult
  2. Students are not motivated to do well on the exam since there is no grade assigned or requirement to pass

#### Possible solutions

- Eliminate the exam as a requirement and rely on in-class graded assessments to measure program outcomes – see below (Vol State Outcomes Assessment Initiative)
- Modify the exam

#### Siemens Level 1 exam

- The Siemens Level 1 exam is given every Fall and Spring semester (except a few semesters due to COVID).
- The exam is optional for students and costs them \$150 to take.
- The exam covers all 4 first-year courses and the score report dis-aggregates the individual courses.
- Over 5 exams the weighted average for each of the first-year courses is (see attached spreadsheet)
  - MECH 1310 - 0.71

- MECH 1320 - 0.60
- MECH 1330 - 0.68
- MECH 1340 - 0.61
- The 2 courses with the lowest weighted averages will be the focus of the continuous improvement.

**Evidence:**

- MECH AAS AY 2022 - 2023 Standards\_and\_Outcomes Report 09-25-2024 144715
- MECH AAS AY 2023 - 20024 Standards\_and\_Outcomes Report 09-25-2024 144938
- Mech 19-20 Item Analysis
- Mech 20-21 Item Analysis
- Siemens Level 1 analysis

## **Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information**

### **STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION**

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

**Narrative:**

Graduate surveys are attached as evidence.

Summary from 2019 and 2020 data

Total number of graduates: 43

- Survey responses: 26 (60%)
- Primary campus
  - 1. Gallatin – 16 (62%)
  - 2. Cookeville – 10 (38%)
- 20/26 rate program as excellent or very good
- 25/26 Strongly agree or generally agree that the program "Helped me acquire the knowledge necessary for a job in the mechatronics field"
- 23/26 Strongly agree or generally agree that the program "Prepared me to utilize technology/software necessary for a job in the mechatronics field"

Regarding program outcomes

1. 25/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program "Gave me a thorough understanding of electrical component, electrical motors, and mechanical components in a mechatronics system"
2. 25/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program " Gave me a thorough understanding of pneumatic and hydraulics in a mechatronics system."
3. 22/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program "Gave me a thorough understanding of PLCs in a mechatronics system"
4. 20/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program "Gave me the ability to install, implement, and modify software tools in a mechatronics system."

5. 24/25 Strongly agreed or generally agreed that the program "Prepared me to work safely around mechatronics systems."

**Evidence:**

- 2019 MECH AAS Employer Survey
- 2019 MECH AAS Graduate Survey
- 2019 MECH Certificate Graduate Survey
- 2020 MECH AAS Employer Survey
- 2020 MECH AAS Graduate Survey
- 2020 MECH Certificate Employer Survey
- 2020 MECH Certificate Graduate Survey

**RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA**

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

**Narrative:**

Enrollment is the biggest challenge to the Mechatronics program at this time. Since COVID (Spring 2020) enrollment has dropped. Enrollment at the Cookeville campus has particularly been affected. There are a few factors that are beyond the control of the program that has contributed to this:

1. In times of low unemployment, career programs tend to suffer as employers are often hiring regardless of credentials.
2. TCAT - Livingston's Industrial Maintenance program that is located in Cookeville and Livingston is pulling from the same pool of students as the Mechatronics program.

Efforts to improve enrollment:

1. A summer boot-camp for Mechatronics and IT was piloted in 2021 in Gallatin. The camp was for HS students. We will attempt to offer this boot-camp again in Gallatin and Cookeville for Summer 2022 pending funding.
2. We have a statewide articulation agreement with TCATs as of Spring 2021. We can promote this agreement to TCAT students so that they can continue their education past the TCAT certificates.

3. Collaborate with TCAT on company recruitments. Invite companies to recruit on campus in our Mechatronics classes. When this happens, we can invite the TCAT students in Cookeville to sit in on the recruitment sessions. This will help familiarize the students with the Vol State Mechatronics program.

**Evidence:**

- 2022 MECH AAS Fact Sheet
- Mechatronics FTE comparison
- Mechatronics Graduates
- Mechatronics enrollment trend

## **Supporting Program Information**

### **FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)**

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

### **CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)**

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

### **CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

### **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

### **EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

# Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback

## SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

### Narrative:

The biggest challenge for the Mechatronics program is enrollment. This is most critical at the Cookeville campus. A multi-faceted approach to increasing enrollment will be required. Some aspects of this approach will be high school visits, dual enrollment, summer "boot camps", and working with employers to train incumbent workers.

Assessing program learning outcomes also needs to be improved. The Mechatronics exit exam is not proving to be a useful tool in this assessment. The more individualized assessments in the classroom may prove to be more useful and effective. The ATMAE visiting team suggested requiring the Siemens Level 1 exam for all graduates. This would require a \$150 payment for each student. However, this may prove to be a better method of assessing the program learning outcomes.

## TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

### Narrative:

|     | <i>Initiative</i>                                                                                                                                   | <i>Objective</i>                                                                                                                                                | <i>Who</i>                            | <i>Performance Indicator(s)*</i>                                                                                  | <i>Timeline **</i>                                                                                                                                                            | <i>Baseline Data</i>                              |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Ex. | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | To provide students with relevant and consistent writing instructional support that will support their successful completion of the XYZ assignment requirements | Program Director and VSCC1234 faculty | (1) Increase of XYZ assignment pass rate to 82%.<br>(2) Increase PLO #1 achievement to 88%<br>(3) Reach 120 views | AY2023-2024<br>- Develop tutorial<br>- Faculty review of the tutorial.<br>- Pilot tutorial in select Spring sections.<br><br>AY2024-2025<br>- Launch video in the model shell | (1) 76% pass rate.<br>(2) PLO #1 82% met outcome. |
| 1.  | Increase the achievement                                                                                                                            | Provide students with                                                                                                                                           | Program chair and                     | (1) Increase the score on                                                                                         | AY 2023-2024                                                                                                                                                                  | (1) Current weighted                              |



|    |                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                      |                           |                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                            |
|----|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    | of PLO #1 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Mechanical Components class. (Student learning)                                  | an online tutorial for the MECH 1320 portion of the Siemens level 1 exam.                                                            | faculty                   | the Mechanical components portion of the Siemens Level 1 exam to 0.65<br><br>(2) Obtain PLO #1 achievement of 85%                                    | - Develop module<br>- Faculty review<br>- Pilot module in MECH 1320<br><br>AY 2024-2025<br>- Launch module in MECH 1320                                                                                | average score for the Mechanical Components portion of the exam is 0.60 over 5 exams.<br><br>(2) No baseline for PLO #2 achievement.                       |
| 2. | Increase the achievement of PLO #3 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs class. (Student learning) | Provide students with an online tutorial for the MECH 1340 portion of the Siemens level 1 exam.                                      | Program chair and faculty | (1) Increase the score on the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs portion of the Siemens Level 1 exam to 0.65<br><br>(2) Obtain PLO #3 achievement of 85%. | AY 2023-2024<br>-Develop module<br>- Pilot module in MECH 1340<br><br>AY 2024-2025<br>-Launch module in MECH 1340                                                                                      | (1) Current weighted average for the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs portion of the exam is 0.61 over 5 exams.<br><br>(2) No baseline for PLO #3 achievement |
| 3. | Increase enrollment in first-year classes at the Cookeville campus. (Student success)                                                                                          | Increase recruiting efforts at the Cookeville campus through high school visits, dual enrollment, boot camps, and employer contacts. | Program chair and faculty | (1) Enrollment in Fall and Spring 1st year classes in Cookeville averages 12 students per class                                                      | AY 2022 - 2024<br>- HS classroom visits<br>- promote dual enrollment to HS students<br>- explore employer contacts for potential incumbent worker training<br><br>AY 2023-2024<br>- Pilot boot camp in | (1) Spring 2022 average enrollment in MECH 1320 and MECH 1330 - 6<br>(2) Fall 2022 average enrollment in MECH 1310 and MECH 1340 - 0 - classes cancelled.  |

|    |  |  |  |  |                |  |
|----|--|--|--|--|----------------|--|
|    |  |  |  |  | Summer<br>2023 |  |
| 4. |  |  |  |  |                |  |

## **DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.**

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

### **Narrative:**

The Mechatronics Program has taken great initiatives in its short lifetime. The program received accreditation from The Associate of Technology, Management, and Applied Engineering (ATMAE) during the Spring 2022 Semester with final approval at their Annual Conference in November 2022. The work detailed in This initial Academic Program Review illustrates the work the program has done to increase its academic rigor, its academic integrity, and its reputation in the community. The program provides for a great pathway for students looking for careers in Applied Engineering and Advanced Manufacturing allowing for a career-ready student upon graduation. The evidence provided from the program shows a young program making great strides toward continuous improvement utilizing data to inform decisions. Moreover, the program recognizes work needed to improve enrollment at our Cookeville Campus. We have begun discussions to towards improving enrollment.

As the Dean of Mathematics and Science, I approve the completed review and action plan outlined by the program and its faculty.

VPAA Feedback: I appreciate the work of the Department Chair and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. The analysis of assessment results is thorough and the selected focus areas for improvement reflect thoughtful and strategic consideration of the results. I agree with the dean's comments applauding the program for its quality and use of data to inform decision for continuous improvement. I also agree that improving enrollment, particularly at Cookeville, is a critical initiative for the program this year. In addition to the increase in recruitment activities, the program may consider curricular changes to better align with regional workforce needs (increased emphasis on robotics?) and to more clearly define the role of our program relative to TCAT programs and 4-year university programs in applied engineering.

## **AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback**

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

### **Narrative:**

The IE&A Officer has reviewed this report and meets the requirements of the template.

## **PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

### **Narrative:**

The APR Presentations were replaced with a peer review. The peer review feedback was shared between authors.

# Action Plan Status Reports

## YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

### Narrative:

| YEAR 2 |                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|        | Initiative                                                                                                                                                                     | Achieved Milestones                                                                                                                   | Challenges                                                                                                   | Changes if applicable                                                                                                                                   | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)                                                                                                                                           |
| EX.    | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234                            | The tutorial video created.<br>Tutorial video presented at the November department meeting.<br>Tutorial video piloted in 10 sections. | Delays in development occurred and additional support from campus media services improved the video quality. | No changes to the timeline.                                                                                                                             | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 78%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 83%                                                                             |
| 1      | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Mechanical Components class. (Student learning)         | eLearn module has not been developed.                                                                                                 | Administering the Siemens exam has become more difficult due to policy changes with Siemens.                 | Vol State will likely drop the Siemens certification program in AY 25-26. We are looking into other external certifications applicable to Mechatronics. | Siemens Level 1 exam data is not useful since only a few students take the exam. The PLO#1 assessment gave an 88% rate of meeting the competency. PLO #1 is assessed in MECH 2320. |
| 2      | Increase the achievement of PLO #3 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs class. (Student learning) | eLearn module has not been developed.                                                                                                 | Administering the Siemens exam has become more difficult due to policy changes with Siemens.                 | Vol State will likely drop the Siemens certification program in AY 25-26. We are looking into other external certifications applicable to Mechatronics. | Siemens Level 1 exam data is not useful since only a few students take the exam. The PLO#3 assessment gave a 72% rate of meeting the competency. PLO #3 is assessed in MECH 2441   |
| 3      | Increase enrollment in first-year classes                                                                                                                                      | The inaugural Summer STEAM                                                                                                            | Outside funding for STEAM                                                                                    | No changes anticipated. The                                                                                                                             | Fall 2023 enrollment in the                                                                                                                                                        |

|   |                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                              |                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                     |
|---|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | at the Cookeville campus. (Student success) | camp was help in 2023. Several HS groups have toured the campus and visited the MECH lab. Cookeville campus recruiting is actively involving Mechatronics in recruiting activity. | camp is required. META funded the 2023 camp. | plan is to continue with the current efforts to grow recruiting and increase dual enrollment. | two 1st year MECH classes is at 12 and 11. This is compared to 2022 when the 1st year classes were cancelled due to low enrollment. |
| 4 |                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                              |                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                     |

### YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

#### Narrative:

| YEAR 3 Progress |                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                             |                                                                                                     |                             |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                 | Initiative                                                                                                                                                             | Achieved Milestones                                                                                                                                                      | Challenges                                                                                  | Performance Indicator Result                                                                        | Initiative Achieved? Yes/No |
| EX.             | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234                    | The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections | None                                                                                        | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86% | YES                         |
| 1               | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Mechanical Components class. (Student learning) | eLearn module was not developed.                                                                                                                                         | Administering the Siemens exam has become more difficult due to policy changes with Siemens | PLO #1 achievement based on the MECH 2320 assessment was 100%.                                      | No                          |
| 2               | Increase the achievement of PLO #3 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Digital Fundamentals and                        | eLearn module was not developed.                                                                                                                                         | Administering the Siemens exam has become more difficult due to policy changes with Siemens | PLO #3 achievement based on the MECH 2441 assessment was 90%.                                       | No                          |

|   |                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                  |                                                                   |     |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----|
|   | PLCs class. (Student learning)                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                  |                                                                   |     |
| 3 | Increase enrollment in first-year classes at the Cookeville campus. (Student success) | Summer STEAM camps were held in 2023 and 2024. Several HS groups have toured the campus and visited the MECH lab. Cookeville campus recruiting is actively involved in Mechatronics recruiting. The charter class of the Putnam County Middle College (PCMC) began Fall 2024 with 9 students enrolled and 2 students choosing Mechatronics as a major. | Continued funding for STEAM camp. Continued recruiting for PCMC. | Fall 2024 enrollment in the two 1st year classes is at 16 and 15. | Yes |
| 4 |                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                  |                                                                   |     |

| YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis |                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                            | Initiative                                                                                                                                                                     | How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?                                                  | Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.                                                               | How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?                                                                |
| EX.                        | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234                            |                                                                                                                         | None                                                                                                                                      | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%                          |
| 1                          | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Mechanical Components class. (Student learning)         | This initiative is designed to help show if students are achieving the standard of PLO #1.                              | We will continue to measure PLO#1 using the current method. We will continue to look for a standard or 3rd party method to verify PLO #1. | Assessments used to verify PLOs need to be required activities that are preferable integrated into a course.                    |
| 2                          | Increase the achievement of PLO #3 by developing an eLearn module and quiz utilizing Siemens sample questions from the Digital Fundamentals and PLCs class. (Student learning) | This initiative is designed to help show if students are achieving the standard of PLO #3.                              | We will continue to measure PLO#3 using the current method. We will continue to look for a standard or 3rd party method to verify PLO #3. | Assessments used to verify PLOs need to be required activities that are preferable integrated into a course.                    |
| 3                          | Increase enrollment in first-year classes at the Cookeville campus. (Student success)                                                                                          | Increasing enrollment in the Cookeville Mechatronics program increases the stability of the program as well as improves | Yes - best practices learned from this effort will continue to be used at the Gallatin and Cookeville campuses to increase student        | The recruiting efforts for the STEAM camp and PCMC have yielded results inside and outside the targeted recruiting demographic. |

|   |  |                                       |                                            |  |
|---|--|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--|
|   |  | opportunity for<br>program graduates. | enrollment in the<br>Mechatronics program. |  |
| 4 |  |                                       |                                            |  |

# **Academic Program Review Cohort C- Cycle 1**

Nursing AAS

## **Reflection and Mission**

### **PREVIOUS ACADEMIC PROGRAM REVIEW**

Reflect on the past APR (if any) and respond to any recommendations that were made at that time. The reviewer should list recommendations, actions taken, and discuss implications or challenges resulting from those actions.

### **Program Mission Statement**

What changes have the program made to the mission statement over the course of this cycle? Why were these changes made? Are any revisions planned?

#### **Narrative:**

The nursing division's mission is to prepare graduates with a foundation for professional nursing through the philosophy of providing the knowledge, skills, and attitudes necessary for students to be eligible to apply to take the National Council Licensure Examination for the Registered Nurse (NCLEX-RN). Students will cover the core concepts that provide the basis for the knowledge, skills, and attitudes that are essential for providing safe nursing care.

### **Alignment to Institution Mission**

How does the mission of the program align with the mission of the institution?

#### **Narrative:**

Revised in 2016, Vol State's mission statement describes the philosophy and purpose of the college. Volunteer State Community College (VSCC) is a public, comprehensive community college offering associate degrees, certificates, continuing education, and service to our constituencies. The College is committed to providing quality innovative educational programs; strengthening community and workforce partnerships; promoting diversity, and cultural awareness, and economic development; inspiring lifelong learning; and preparing students for successful careers, university transfer, and meaningful civic participation in a global society. The VSCC Strategic Plan through 2025 was updated and adopted by the President's Cabinet on June 28<sup>th</sup>, 2021. It focuses on Open Access, Community and Workforce Development, and Completion.

The nursing program mission and philosophy supports the governing organization in fulfilling its core values, mission, and goals. The AASN program added an associate degree offering in nursing to the many programs already offered at Vol State. It has helped provide nursing education to area students to prepare them as successful nurses. It helped strengthen workforce partnerships and is helping the community with access to quality healthcare by delivering more registered nurses to the community. These students are career ready and are also ready to transfer to four-year universities as they choose to do so.

The values, mission, and goals of the Vol State also help support the nursing program. Vol State's commitment to providing quality education programs was a driving force in bringing a nursing program to Vol State. They have provided an accessible program to a community that was in need. Their community partnerships that were already in place due to other health science programs helped give nursing the contacts and clinicals necessary to provide quality education to nursing students.

# Curriculum and Student Learning Outcomes Assessment

## Curriculum Map

Review the Student Learning Outcomes and course(s) where each one is addressed. For each outcome, provide the assessment method and target level of achievement.

### Narrative:

The VSCC AASN program has developed a systemic plan of evaluation. The systemic plan of evaluation is used to assess outcomes and help evaluate areas where improvement is needed. The results allow for faculty and the nurse administrator to determine the need for change. Faculty use evaluation to make curriculum changes geared towards improving outcomes. The systemic evaluation plan is attached in the evidence. The AASN program uses multiple methods to evaluate EPSLOs and PO's.

### Evidence:

- Systematic Plan of Evaluation

## EVIDENCE OF STUDENT LEARNING

Provide evidence of student learning and the program's effectiveness in reaching both program outcomes and course learning outcomes.

Please provide the following:

1. Summary of most recent assessment results.
2. Analysis of trends
3. Ideas for how those results could be used to improve student learning.

### Narrative:

#### Learning Activities and Instructional Methods

Learning activities are selected by the faculty to aid in delivering content while meeting SLOs and EPSLOs. Each activity is selected based their ability to help the student achieve outcomes. A detailed lesson plan is created by each ensure each activity relates and that all outcomes are covers.

Instructional methods vary based on the setting. Instructors use PowerPoint presentations, group activities, hands-on activities, case studies, videos, simulations, and group discussion. They select activities that will allow the students the opportunity to critically think.

#### Evaluation Methods

Evaluation methods are based on each individual activity. They help ensure the student has met the objectives of the assignment as related to the EPSLOs. Each assignment is intended to show the student had achieved the outcome in which the assignment relates.

#### Evaluation of EPSLOs

- ATI RN Comprehensive Predictor: Scores are analyzed in different content areas that relate to each EPSLO. The expected level of achievement (ELA) is a group average of 70% in the corresponding content area.
- Final Clinical Evaluation: The final clinical evaluation evaluates overall student performance in the clinical setting as it relates to the EPSLOs. The ELA is that 100% of students will achieve a satisfactory in all areas of their final clinical evaluation.



- **Final Care Plan:** The final care plan evaluates the student use of the nursing process in the clinical setting as it relates to several of the EPSLOs. The ELA is that 100% of students will achieve a satisfactory on their final care plan.

### **Evaluation of PO's**

- **Exam Pass Rate for NCLEX Certifications:** The annual NCLEX-RN pass rate for the first-time test-takers will be at least 85%.
- **Program Completion Rate:** At least 60% of students will complete the program within 150% of the program length.
- **Program Completion Rate for ACEN:** At least 45% of students will complete the program on-time.
- **Job Placement Rate:** At least 85% percent will be employed as a registered nurse within twelve months post-graduation.

Each EPSLO is paired with an end of course student learning outcome. They are all the same concept, but advance in progression. They are professional behavior, communication, assessment, clinical decision making, caring interventions, teaching and learning, collaboration, and managing care.

### **AASN Evaluation Methods**

| <b>AASN Formative Evaluation Methods</b> |                       |                             |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|
| Classroom                                | Skills lab            | Clinical                    |
| Unit Exams                               | Skills Check-offs     | Care Plans                  |
| Quizzes                                  | Simulations           | Weekly Clinical Evaluations |
| Prep U                                   |                       |                             |
| Math Competency Exams                    |                       |                             |
| Discussion Boards                        |                       |                             |
| Case Studies                             |                       |                             |
| ATI Practice Assessments                 |                       |                             |
| Learning System 3.0                      |                       |                             |
| Professional Communication Assessment    |                       |                             |
| Board of Nursing Paper                   |                       |                             |
| Weekly Journal Entries                   |                       |                             |
| <b>AASN Summative Evaluation Methods</b> |                       |                             |
| Classroom                                | Skills lab            | Clinical                    |
| Final Exams                              | Final Simulations     | Final Clinical Evaluations  |
| ATI Proctored Assessments                | Laboratory Evaluation | Final Care Plans            |
| ATI Comprehensive Predictor              |                       |                             |

### **Student Attainment of Competencies**

Students complete a wide variety of activities to prove attainment of competence throughout the program. Students must submit all assignments, whether awarded points or not, to be awarded a passing grade for the course. Satisfactory performance in the clinical and lab setting are also required to pass a course. Students are required to receive a pass or satisfactory on any pass/fail or satisfactory/unsatisfactory assessments. For evaluation methods which are awarded points, the students must earn a minimum average of 78%.

#### **Quizzes**

Quizzes may be scheduled or unscheduled. They are an opportunity to obtain a baseline of how students are comprehending material.

#### **Exams**

Each course has four-unit exams and a final. Each exam increases in difficulty, increasing in application and analysis questions as students progress through each semester. Exam Soft is in the process of being purchased to administer exams. They are currently given electronically in eLearn. Instructors utilize exam blueprints when creating exams to be reflective of the NCLEX test plan and

ensure an increase in difficulty and application and analysis type questions. It also allows them to link each question to an SLO. At the end of each exam, students are broken into groups to take the exam as a small group. They are able to discuss rationales and it enhances the learning process. Students are also given ATI exams in each course, except for NRSNG 1720, and a comprehensive ATI exam at the end of the program. They also follow the NCLEX test plan guidelines.

#### **Skills Evaluation**

Skills check-offs are utilized in the lab to evaluate competence. Standardized check-off rubrics from a current skills book are used in order to be objective, consistent, and up to date with current practice.

Additionally, students receive a lab evaluation at the end of each lab which they must earn a satisfactory on.

#### **Clinical Evaluation**

Each student receives a clinical evaluation. If not satisfactory at the mid-term, they receive a written evaluation outlining the need to improve. If satisfactory performance is noted, they will receive the evaluation only at the end of the semester. The instructor provides feedback through counseling forms if a student is at risk for meeting outcomes week by week. This helps the student understand areas of opportunity in a timely manner, as well as address any issues that may need to be addressed before another clinical. The clinical evaluations are then shared with the course lead in order to make them aware of any deficiencies noted with an individual student or within the groups. Clinical evaluations are progressive in expectations as students advance in the classroom, learn more advanced skills in the lab, and gain independence in the clinical setting.

#### **Lab Evaluation**

Each student receives a lab evaluation at the end of the semester. Any deficiencies during the semester are noted with a counseling form. The lab evaluation ties to the SLO's. Students must earn a satisfactory to pass the course.

#### **Case Studies**

Case Studies are a way for students to build upon a clinical scenario. There are multiple avenues for them to show what they know, do not know, and where they may need to improve.

#### **Evidence:**

- 2020 NCLEX
- 2021 NCLEX
- SEP - Updated for Job Placement Collection of Data

## **Qualitative and Quantitative Program Information**

### **STUDENT, GRADUATE, AND ALUMNI SATISFACTION**

Use student and graduate surveys, course evaluations, and any other appropriate evidence needed to explore the qualitative satisfaction results from students and graduates to provide information to the items below.

Discuss student, graduate, alumni perceptions of the program, faculty, career projection, and any other program recommendations given "during this survey".

Summarize any noted themes, trends, areas for improvement, identified strengths, and implications for the program for both students and alumni.

#### **Narrative:**

Survey results are from cohorts graduating in 2020 and 2021. These students entered the program the year it was brand new and lacked leadership for almost 10 months. They also attended during the peak of COVID, often times, when labs and clinicals were not available.

To improve, instructors were placed at both campuses so no students had to receive instruction via video.

More simulations have been added to the lab. Instructors are encouraged to bring more active learning into the classroom.

Additional faculty and lab coordinator positions have been a strength.

**Evidence:**

- 2020 Nursing Employer Survey
- 2020 Nursing Graduate Survey
- 2021 Nursing Graduate Survey

**RECRUITMENT, ENROLLMENT, RETENTION, AND GRADUATION: FACT BOOK DATA**

Attach screenshots from the Fact Book of the areas below.

1. Headcounts
2. FTE Comparison
3. Student Primary Location
4. Retention Statistics
5. Graduation Statistics
6. Demographics

Using the Fact Book data listed below, analyze the follow:

Recruitment  
Enrollment  
Retention  
Graduation

The reviewer could discuss marketing and recruitment efforts in the community and local high schools; analyze enrollment, retention, and graduation trends; and discuss potential reasons, strengths, plans for improvement, and any other implications deemed appropriate.

**Narrative:**

Nursing admission has increased on the Gallatin campus each year. The Livingston campus increased two years in a row, then had a decrease. The GPA requirement was researched and adjusted to help with this. Students are recruited through virtual information sessions, social media, and other methods.

**Evidence:**

- 2022 Nursing Fact Sheet

**Supporting Program Information**

**FACULTY USAGE AND DEVELOPMENT (OPTIONAL)**

Review faculty teaching loads, adjunct to full time ratios, faculty development opportunities, faculty end of course evaluations, faculty surveys, and any other

evidence deemed appropriate. The reviewer could discuss the impact of teaching, the ratio of adjunct to full time staffing, end of course evaluations relative to faculty, and any noted themes identified from the review.

### **CLASS OFFERINGS (OPTIONAL)**

Address scheduling effectiveness and space utilization. The reviewer could review faculty to student ratios at each location and online and discuss the impact relative to faculty and student success.

### **CO-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss co-curricular activities available for students in the program. These might include clubs, internships or other Work Based Learning opportunities, service learning, guest speakers, or any other activities designed to enhance student experience in the program.

### **INDUSTRY TRENDS AND INNOVATIONS (OPTIONAL)**

Examine the program demand within the labor market including local, regional, and/or national. The reviewer could examine information from industry advisory boards and information gathered from credible industry sources as well as from external accrediting bodies. The reviewer could also discuss any existing or emerging trends within the field as they relate to your program and employment of your student's post-graduation as well as the outlook for the field in the next 5 years. This summary could also identify best practices, trends, and innovation in the field and discuss implications for the program.

### **EMPLOYMENT AND TRANSFER FORECASTS (OPTIONAL)**

Discuss where students go after graduation and what is being done to enhance the likelihood of success or assist students in reaching those goals. The reviewer could discuss employment outlook, obtainment, curriculum alignment for transfers, and the employment demands of the industries where students will work.

## **Recommendations Action Plan, Review, and Feedback**

### **SUMMARY AND ANALYSIS**

The reviewer should discuss what went right, what went wrong, and the implications of those results.

#### **Narrative:**

Many things have gone right for the AASN program. The program has had overall growth, has met all program outcomes each year, has received full approval from the TN Board of Nursing, and is on the path to accreditation by ACEN, expected in April/May 2023. The faculty have grown and continue to develop to help graduate successful nurses to enter the workforce upon successfully completing the NCLEX.

There is always room for improvement. The faculty will continue to evaluate each course each semester to find areas to improve in and make them better.

Overall, the AASN program has been very successful.

## **TWO YEAR RECOMMENDATION ACTION PLAN**

Discuss the next steps for the program by providing a program action plan for the next two academic years. Recommendations must include at least two actions focused on student learning and one action focused on student success. The program action plan must include a timeline for each recommendation.

Feedback and approval will be provided. Refer to the APR timeline for approval deadlines.

### **Narrative:**

Goal: Hire a lab coordinator exclusive to the Livingston campus.

Rationale: This will help provide full-time support for nursing students on the Livingston campus. It will also provide more consistent faculty dedication to course coverage, specifically lecture. This should ultimately help improve student satisfaction and outcomes.

Timeline: Post job in 11/2022, hire faculty member to start position in 05/2023.

Goal: Implement ExamSoft for nursing exams in Spring 2023.

Rationale: This will help provide students an opportunity to experience Next Gen NCLEX testing styles that will go live for NCLEX in April 2023. They will be able to familiarize themselves with question types to be more successful with the Next Gen NCLEX.

Timeline: Implement ExamSoft by start of Spring semester 2023.

Goal: Implement course summaries to be completed by faculty at the end of each course.

Rationale: The course summary will be a place for faculty to document their course outcomes, evaluate them, and make suggestions for change. Changes will be analyzed to see if they were beneficial. The document will bring more accountability to the faculty member to find deficiencies in activities thought to meet outcomes and improve them.

Timeline: First implementation to be 12/2022. Reevaluation of changes will occur the next time each course is taught, one year later.

## **DEAN(S) APPROVAL AND FEEDBACK.**

The Dean(s) will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan.

### **Narrative:**

I have reviewed this report for content, accuracy, and quality and it has my support in all areas.

VPAA feedback: I appreciate the work of the Dean and faculty in reflecting on their program and creating initiatives to make it even stronger. The program has had tremendous success in growth, retention, and quality (as shown by NCLEX scores and other measures), which is especially notable as a new program that navigated the pandemic in its first few years. I'd like to see the initiatives reframed to focus more on student learning (with the action/adoption being a strategy for reaching the

improvement in student learning). It would also be good for the faculty to find a specific area or two of student learning based to focus improvement initiatives on. While the overall level of achievement is very high, there may be relative areas of weakness that could be improved.

### **AVPAA & VPAA Review and Feedback**

The Vice President of Academic Affairs and Assistant Vice President of Academic Affairs will provide feedback and approval on the completed review and action plan. VPAA and AVPAA should consider institutional planning and budgetary details when providing their review.

#### **Narrative:**

This position is no longer active. The APR author works directly with the Academic Assessment Officer throughout the process.

### **PRESENTATION FEEDBACK**

The APR will be presented to a group of peers. Feedback retrieved from the presentation will be summarized and included.

#### **Narrative:**

APR Cohort C conducted a Peer Review rather than a presentation.

The Logistic APR was reviewed by the Mechatronic, A.A.S. APR author.

## **Action Plan Status Reports**

### **YEAR 2 ACTION PLAN REVIEW**

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. If any changes are planned due to the results, those should be discussed and an updated action plan should be included in the narrative or attached as evidence.

#### **Narrative:**

| YEAR 2 |                                                            |                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                |                       |                                                                                             |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|        | Initiative                                                 | Achieved Milestones                                                                                         | Challenges                                                                                                                                                     | Changes if applicable | Progress Toward Performance Indicator(s)                                                    |
| 1      | Hire a lab coordinator exclusive to the Livingston campus. | A nursing lab coordinator was hired and began working exclusively for the Livingston campus in May of 2023. | There was not a large applicant pool, but the person who was hired was a quality candidate. She did not have her MSN, but did start a program prior to hire to | No changes            | The goal was met. A lab coordinator was hired for the Livingston campus by the target date. |

|   |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |            |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                               | meet the position requirement set forth by the TN nursing board.                                                                                                                                                                      |            |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 2 | Implement ExamSoft for nursing exams in Spring 2023. PLO 4                       | Examsoft was contracted in December 2022 and went live for nursing exams in January of 2023.                                                                  | Setup was challenging with the need being on numerous devices on two different campuses. Examsoft updates remain a challenge on some devices. While they get done, it is not an ideal process given the need for IT admins to update. | No changes | The goal was met. Students easily learned and utilized the software beginning in the Spring 2023 semester. Faculty are better able to administer exams in an NCLEX format and track their data. |
| 3 | Implement course summaries to be completed by faculty at the end of each course. | The course summary was developed in the fall of 2022 and presented in the December 2022 faculty meeting. It was then used the following spring 2023 semester. | There were no challenges to the process.                                                                                                                                                                                              | No changes | The goal was met. The course summary was initiated by the goal date and summarizes course outcomes, strengths, and weaknesses.                                                                  |
| 4 |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |            |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

### YEAR 3 ACTION PLAN REVIEW

The reviewer should review progress on action plan over the past year. Discussion should include challenges and successes. The reviewer should discuss the actions future and continuous in the program.

#### Narrative:

| YEAR 3 Progress |                                                      |                                                     |            |                                                        |                             |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
|                 | Initiative                                           | Achieved Milestones                                 | Challenges | Performance Indicator Result                           | Initiative Achieved? Yes/No |
| EX.             | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and | The tutorial video was launched in the model shell. | None       | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80% | YES                         |

|   |                                                                                                |                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 | Full-time faculty were also encouraged to use the new tool<br><br>The tutorial video was launched in a total of 24 sections |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86% |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1 | Hire a lab coordinator exclusive to the Livingston campus.                                     | A nursing lab coordinator was hired and began working exclusively for the Livingston campus in May of 2023.                 | There was not a large applicant pool, but the person who was hired was a quality candidate. She did not have her MSN, but did start a program prior to hire to meet the position requirement set forth by the TN nursing board. | No changes                                   | The goal was met. A lab coordinator was hired for the Livingston campus by the target date.                                                                                                     |
| 2 | Implement ExamSoft for nursing exams in Spring 2023.                                           | Examsoft was contracted in December 2022 and went live for nursing exams in January of 2023.                                | Setup was challenging with the need being on numerous devices on two different campuses. Examsoft updates remain a challenge on some devices. While they get done, it                                                           | No changes                                   | The goal was met. Students easily learned and utilized the software beginning in the Spring 2023 semester. Faculty are better able to administer exams in an NCLEX format and track their data. |



|   |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                 |            |                                                                                                                                |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                               | is not an ideal process given the need for IT admins to update. |            |                                                                                                                                |
| 3 | Implement course summaries to be completed by faculty at the end of each course. | The course summary was developed in the fall of 2022 and presented in the December 2022 faculty meeting. It was then used the following spring 2023 semester. | There were no challenges to the process.                        | No changes | The goal was met. The course summary was initiated by the goal date and summarizes course outcomes, strengths, and weaknesses. |
| 4 |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                 |            |                                                                                                                                |

#### YEAR 3 Initiative Analysis

|     | Initiative                                                                                                                                          | How has this initiative supported student learning or student success?                                                                                                                                                                                         | Will there be any further action taken on this initiative? If yes, explain.                        | How will this initiative inform program decisions in the future?                                                         |
|-----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EX. | Increase the achievement of PLO #1 by developing and implementing an online tutorial resource to complement teaching the XYZ assignment in VSCC1234 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | None                                                                                               | The assignment success rate for pilot sections was 80%<br>PLO #1 achievement of pilot sections was 86%                   |
| 1   | Hire a lab coordinator exclusive to the Livingston campus.                                                                                          | This role has provided support for lab practice, tutoring, mentoring, more face to face instructor time, and more in comprehensive lab experiences. All of these things help students improve their knowledge and skills which align with the course outcomes. | No. The lab coordinator role should remain filled and continue the duties per the job description. | The lab coordinator offers feedback on a regular basis and changes for improvement will be made in the lab as necessary. |
| 2   | Implement ExamSoft for                                                                                                                              | The software has allowed students to experience Next                                                                                                                                                                                                           | No. Examsoft is installed and                                                                      | Data from exams can show the                                                                                             |

|   |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                     |                                                                                                        |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | nursing exams in Spring 2023.                                                    | Gen NCLEX style questions which help them prepare for the licensure exam. These questions give them the experience they need to know how to answer the questions. Showign competence in exams helps cover the different learning outcomes set forth in the course.                               | the program will continue use.                                                      | program where we are meeting outcomes and where we are not. Decisions that are made are based on data. |
| 3 | Implement course summaries to be completed by faculty at the end of each course. | Course summaries allow the faculty to gave a summary of the class performance on learning outcomes, overall grades, what went well, what did not, what should stay the same and what needs to change. These changes are made with the students in mind to help achieve stuent learning outcomes. | No. The course summary is in place and will continue to be used as it currently is. | The course summaries allow faculty to reflect on hcnages that need to be made.                         |
| 4 |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                     |                                                                                                        |